

GOVERNMENT OF ALBERTA



Advanced Education

Annual Report

2024-25

Alberta 

Advanced Education, Government of Alberta | Advanced Education 2024-2025 Annual Report

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Preface

The Public Accounts of Alberta are prepared in accordance with the *Financial Administration Act* and the *Sustainable Fiscal Planning and Reporting Act*. The Public Accounts consist of the annual report of the Government of Alberta and the annual reports of each ministry.

The 2024-25 Annual Report reflects the 2024-27 Ministry business plans, the Government of Alberta Strategic Plan, as well as the ministry's activities and accomplishments during the 2024-25 fiscal year, which ended on March 31, 2025.

The Annual Report of the Government of Alberta contains *Budget 2024* Key Results, the audited Consolidated Financial Statements and Performance Results, which compares actual performance results to desired results set out in the government's strategic plan.

This annual report of the Ministry of Advanced Education contains the Minister's Accountability Statement, the ministry's Financial Information and Results Analysis, a comparison of actual performance results to desired results set out in the Ministry Business Plan. This ministry annual report also includes:

- other financial information as required by the *Financial Administration Act* and *Sustainable Fiscal Planning and Reporting Act*, as separate reports, to the extent that the ministry has anything to report.

All Ministry Annual Reports should be considered along with the Government of Alberta Annual Report to provide a complete overview of government's commitment to openness, accountability, and fiscal transparency.

Minister's Accountability Statement

The ministry's annual report for the year ended March 31, 2025, was prepared under my direction in accordance with the *Sustainable Fiscal Planning and Reporting Act* and the government's accounting policies. All the government's policy decisions as at June 3, 2025, with material economic or fiscal implications of which I am aware have been considered in the preparation of this report.

Original signed by

Myles McDougall

Minister of Advanced Education



Message from the Minister

Under my predecessor as Minister of Advanced Education, the Honourable Rajan Sawhney, the ministry continued to build strong relationships with our partners in the post-secondary community, industry, labour, the non-profit sector, and other areas of government in 2024-25.

As in previous years, the Alberta 2030 strategy remained our guide in 2024-25 in helping students to pursue rewarding careers in a world and workforce where change seems to be the only constant. Alberta's government addressed those changing needs with significant investments that will enhance Alberta's world class learning environments.

Budget 2024 maintained a stable base of funding, managed affordability for students, and continued support for high-demand programs. There was increased funding for skilled trades and apprenticeship education, and modernization of key apprenticeship programs, to help meet the needs of industry, and help Alberta students make the most of available opportunities.

An important part of our work and how we prepare for the future growth of the student population is through capital expenditures. In 2024-25, Advanced Education announced investments of \$360.5 million for capital projects over the three-year budget cycle. These crucial capital project investments included funding for MacEwan University's new School of Business, the NAIT Advanced Skills Centre, the W.J. Elliott Expansion and Renewal project at Olds College, the CIM-TAC East Campus Expansion project at Red Deer Polytechnic, the Multidisciplinary Hub at the University of Calgary, the Rural Medical Education Training Centre at the University of Lethbridge, and the launch and expansion of the Bachelor of Aviation Management program at Mount Royal University.

Inflationary pressures and the rising cost of living remained challenges last year. A cap of two per cent on tuition increases, passed in *Budget 2023*, came into effect for the 2024-25 academic year. In 2024-25, Advanced Education invested nearly \$1.1 billion in student aid: \$905 million for student loans to assist 108,100 students, \$63 million in grants to support 18,100 students, and \$101 million in scholarships and awards to support 49,200 students.

Continued investment in programs to support accessibility and affordability in 2024-25 helped vulnerable Albertans develop job-ready skills to build rewarding careers. The Community Adult Learning Program, which provides literacy and foundational learning to Albertans received \$21.1 million in *Budget 2024*.

Alberta's apprenticeship registration in 2024-25 approached an all-time high, with more than 72,000 registered apprentices. This demanded a shared focus between apprenticeship education promotion and delivery of classroom seats and programs. Last year, the ministry provided \$76 million through the Apprenticeship Learning Grant to 11 public post-secondary institutions to fund a total of 28,250 apprenticeship seats across Alberta.

Innovative steps to boost the profile of the skilled trades and apprenticeship education under the Trades and Apprenticeship Promotion Plan saw the appointment of 12 skilled trades and apprenticeship "ambassadors" aged 18 to 31. These engaging individuals promoted their educational and career pathways to Alberta youth at live events and in online videos.

An advertising campaign called #WouldntTradeIt engaged with Albertans through video, radio, online and public transit advertising, social media, and cultural community displays. The highly successful campaign

logged more than 24 million digital media impressions, and approximately 57 million radio and out-of-home impressions in the Fall of 2024.

In April 2024, Advanced Education provided one year of funding valued at \$350,000 to the International Union of Operating Engineers to deliver apprenticeship training for mobile crane operators. This pilot was the first time a union training centre received funding for apprenticeship training. In addition, a \$900,000 investment was announced for the TELUS Spark Science Centre in Calgary to create exploration spaces for young people to discover a career in the trades. Ultimately, as of March 31, 2025, there were 69,267 individuals registered in 72,857 apprenticeships, representing an increase of 14 per cent in 12 months.

In April 2024, Advanced Education and Alberta Health announced the establishment of new Rural Medical Education Program Training Centres in Lethbridge and Grande Prairie. These new training centres will also function as multi-disciplinary teaching clinics, to improve access to physicians for Albertans in rural and remote areas.

In June 2024, Lethbridge College was redesignated as a polytechnic institution. Under its new brand and mandate, Lethbridge Polytechnic will offer new and revamped certificate programs beginning in the Fall of 2025. Lethbridge Polytechnic joins Medicine Hat College, Red Crow College and the University of Lethbridge in an enhanced array of post-secondary institutions in southern Alberta. For students, this broader spectrum of learning opportunities in the region will reduce the necessity for long-distance travel and relocation.

Growth in Alberta's private career college sector since 2019 brought increases in enrolment and financial assistance applications—and a concerning increase in student complaints. Advanced Education performed compliance inspections in 2024-25 with the aim of holding the sector accountable to legislative and licensing obligations. In early 2025, the ministry launched a new online Private Career College Registry to increase transparency on compliance issues and to allow students to compare programs across the sector.

Early in 2024, the Government of Canada announced changes to the international student program that placed a new national cap on the number of international study permits. Advanced Education staff worked diligently to ensure Alberta was the first jurisdiction to develop and implement a process to issue newly required Provincial Attestation Letters.

The financial pressure exerted on post-secondary institutions by the federal government's international student policy changes led Advanced Education to convene an Expert Panel on Post-Secondary System Funding and Alberta's Competitiveness. Under the guidance of Dr. Jack Mintz, the panel will help to inform future decision-making for the post-secondary system. In early 2025, the panel began examining funding allocations, federal policy impacts, administrative and regulatory burdens, and the overall competitiveness of Alberta's post-secondary system. The panel's mandate is to issue a report in the summer of 2025 with recommendations on funding mechanisms that will enable post-secondary institutions to achieve maximum effectiveness and position the system to meet future challenges.

Original signed by

Myles McDougall

Minister of Advanced Education

Management's Responsibility for Reporting

The Ministry of Advanced Education includes:

- The Department of Advanced Education,
- Public Post-secondary Institutions,
- Alberta Board of Skilled Trades,
- Campus Alberta Quality Council,
- Land Agent Advisory Committee,
- Minister's Advisory Council on Higher Education and Skills,
- Premier's Council on Skills,
- Skilled Trades Youth Ambassadors, and
- Expert Panel on Post-Secondary Institution Funding and Alberta's Competitiveness

The executives of the individual entities within the ministry have the primary responsibility and accountability for the respective entities. Collectively, the executives ensure the ministry complies with all relevant legislation, regulations, and policies.

Ministry business plans, annual reports, performance results, and the supporting management information are integral to the government's fiscal and strategic plan, annual report, quarterly reports, and other financial and performance reporting.

Responsibility for the integrity and objectivity of the accompanying ministry financial information and performance results for the ministry rests with the Minister of Advanced Education. Under the direction of the Minister, I oversee the preparation of the ministry's annual report, which includes the financial information, performance results on all objectives and initiatives identified in the Ministry Business Plan, and performance results for all ministry-supported commitments that were included in the 2024-27 Government of Alberta Strategic Plan. The financial information and performance results, out of necessity, include amounts that are based on estimates and judgments. The financial information is prepared using the government's stated accounting policies, which are based on Canadian public sector accounting standards. The performance measures are prepared in accordance with the following criteria:

- Reliable – information used in applying performance measure methodologies agrees with the underlying source data for the current and prior years' results.
- Understandable – the performance measure methodologies and results are presented clearly.
- Comparable – the methodologies for performance measure preparation are applied consistently for the current and prior years' results.
- Complete – outcomes, performance measures and related targets match those included in the ministry's *Budget 2024*.

As Deputy Minister, in addition to program responsibilities, I am responsible for the ministry's financial administration and reporting functions. The ministry maintains systems of financial management and internal control which give consideration to costs, benefits, and risks that are designed to:

- provide reasonable assurance that transactions are properly authorized, executed in accordance with prescribed legislation and regulations, and properly recorded so as to maintain accountability of public money,
- provide information to manage and report on performance,
- safeguard the assets and properties of the province under ministry administration,
- provide Executive Council, the President of Treasury Board and Minister of Finance, and the Minister of Advanced Education the information needed to fulfill their responsibilities, and

- facilitate preparation of Ministry business plans and annual reports required under the *Sustainable Fiscal Planning and Reporting Act*.

In fulfilling my responsibilities for the ministry, I have relied, as necessary, on the executives of the individual entities within the ministry.

Original signed by

Shannon Marchand

Deputy Minister of Advanced Education

June 3, 2025

Results Analysis

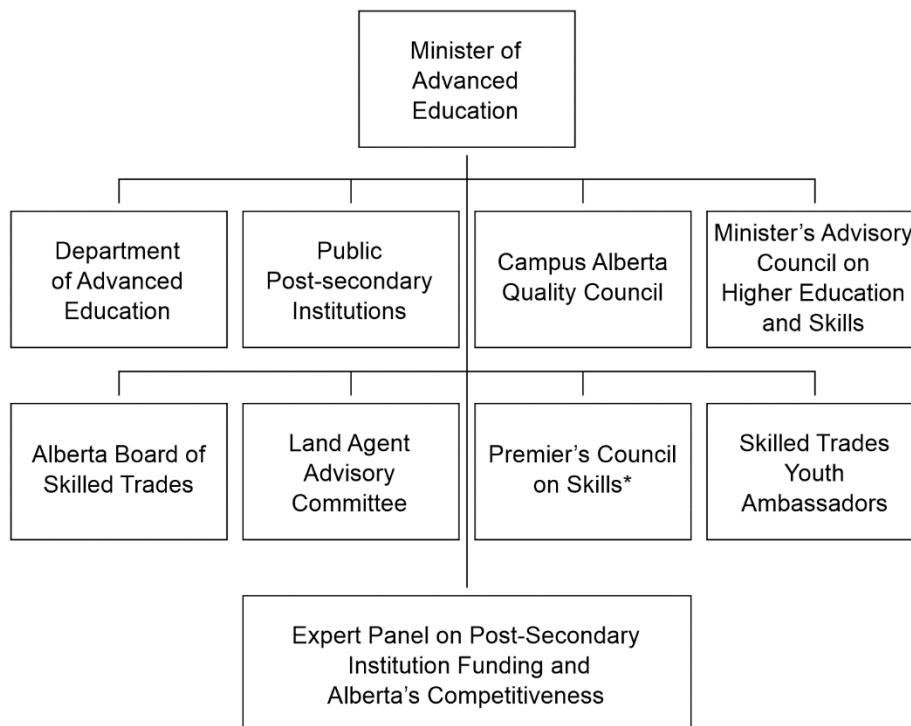
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Ministry Overview

Ministry Mandate

The Ministry of Advanced Education is responsible for empowering Albertans through an adult learning system and professional regulatory environment that support an innovative and prosperous Alberta. The ministry works closely with public post-secondary institutions, private providers, and community learning providers to support adult learning, provide educational opportunities, and enhance the adult learning system. To support affordability, the ministry provides financial supports to Albertans who are pursuing post-secondary learning opportunities. It also delivers programs and policies ensuring Alberta remains a destination of choice for skilled professionals, and a leader in apprenticeship education and trades certification. Guided by the Alberta 2030: Building Skills for Jobs strategy, Advanced Education's investment in people, infrastructure, and research capacity enables the post-secondary sector to drive job creation, innovation, and economic diversification. The ministry is also committed to removing barriers to employment for highly skilled Canadian-certified professional workers in regulated occupations, and Albertans with foreign credentials. It collaborates with partner ministries and stakeholders on initiatives to encourage economic diversification, and grow the province's talent pipeline with the skills, knowledge, and competencies to support a prosperous society.

Organizational Structure



* The Premier's Council on Skills is accountable to the Premier through the Minister of Advanced Education.

Operational Overview

Five divisions within the ministry carry out the work of the department:

Programs, Engagement and Innovation

The Programs, Engagement and Innovation division positions the department strategically for informed decision-making, implementation, and program delivery. The division builds and maintains relationships with key stakeholders including industry and employers, post-secondary institutions, Indigenous learning providers, and student groups. The division designs and implements key initiatives such as targeted enrolment expansion of post-secondary programs to meet workforce needs, work-integrated learning, micro-credentials, the International Education Strategy, and enhancing student supports on campus. The division works with Indigenous communities and learning providers to strengthen opportunities and supports for Indigenous learners. This division provides oversight of efficient and effective program approval functions to enable publicly funded post secondary institutions to meet student and labour-market demand. The division drives digital strategy and continuous improvement of department information technology systems and leads system innovations for programs and operations in support of learner access and pathways.

Private Career Colleges and Student Aid

The Private Career Colleges and Student Aid division is responsible for licensing private career colleges in Alberta and ensuring compliance with both the *Private Vocational Training Act* and Private Vocational Training Regulation. The division works closely with private career colleges to gather annual report data for key performance indicators and conducts site visits and reviews to evaluate compliance. It also manages the student complaints process and ensures adequate student protections are in place.

The division provides financial supports to students attending post-secondary programming to support affordability and accessibility of post-secondary education for Albertans. It provides financial supports in the form of student loans, grants, scholarships, awards, and bursaries. The division develops and delivers provincial funding supports and administers the Canada Student Financial Assistance Program on behalf of the Government of Canada.

The division supports private career college compliance reviews and audits, student aid compliance, suspected fraud identification and review, designations of programs and institutions, and repayment rate tracking.

Skilled Trades and Professions

The Skilled Trades and Professions division works to ensure Albertans can participate in adult learning opportunities by providing financial assistance and supports to those who qualify to attend approved foundational learning and skills development programs, and by supporting providers to deliver community programming. The division also oversees strategic initiatives such as the expansion of the apprenticeship learning model, grant management of program partners, and modelling, monitoring, and reporting on apprenticeship education seats. The division provides programs and policies for apprenticeship education and trades certification in Alberta and supports to the Alberta Board of Skilled Trades. The division also develops apprenticeship standards with industry and provides support services to apprentices and employers. These supports include exam development and delivery, qualification review, and certification. The division identifies fair and transparent registration practices for regulated professions, designated occupations, and trades through the Fairness for Newcomers Office. The division is responsible for implementation of and compliance with domestic trade agreements and Alberta's labour mobility legislation, including pan-Canadian collaboration to streamline processes, and reduce barriers to credential recognition and registration for professionals coming to work in Alberta. The division also supports professional regulatory organizations and professional associations seeking to become professional regulatory organizations, as well as the recruitment, training, and support to public members serving on these organizations.

Strategic and Business Services

The Strategic and Business Services division provides leadership and coordination for all aspects of the policy development cycle, intergovernmental relations, and governance and legislative services, including providing secretariat support to skills advisory councils, and the Expert Panel on Post-Secondary Institution Funding and Alberta's Competitiveness. The division is responsible for the collection, governance, and analysis of post-secondary system data, measurement of system performance and outcomes, as well as research and analysis to support decision-making by government and stakeholders. The division delivers the ministry's corporate services functions, which include coordinating Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy requests, accommodations and facilities management, emergency management and business continuity planning, as well as the development of the ministry's business plan, annual report, and enterprise risk management processes.

Financial Services

The Financial Services division provides strategic management and decision-making oversight of the finance functions of the ministry and post-secondary system. This includes the development of budgets and forecasts, payments and reconciliations, and financial reporting, including the consolidation of 21 public post-secondary institutions. In addition, the division manages the ministry's capital planning for public post-secondary institutions, working with stakeholders to maximize the value of capital investment and maintenance budgets.

The division supports increased access to post-secondary education through facilitating federal support for French language policy and programming and managing operating grants and interprovincial agreements to share capacity for health care programming among provinces. Through multiple mechanisms, including Investment Management Agreements with public post-secondary institutions, financial analysis, and policy and system management, the division works to achieve the ministry's goals, while managing risk and fostering relationships with stakeholders.

Advisory Boards, Councils, and Authorities

Campus Alberta Quality Council

The Campus Alberta Quality Council is an arms-length quality assurance agency that reviews and recommends Alberta degree programs to the Minister of Advanced Education for approval. The Campus Alberta Quality Council also monitors degree programs to ensure they continue to meet its standards.

Minister's Advisory Council on Higher Education and Skills

The Minister's Advisory Council on Higher Education and Skills is responsible for advising the minister about the direction of Alberta's post-secondary system, including metrics for measuring performance, long-term strategic goals, and any other matters as requested by the Minister of Advanced Education.

Alberta Board of Skilled Trades

The Alberta Board of Skilled Trades advises the minister on the direction of Alberta's designated trades certification system. The board's responsibilities include promoting the designated trades and the value of certification, consulting with industry on the standards and requirements for certification, which activities within designated trades should only be performed by individuals who meet specific requirements, and what those requirements should be (restricted activities). The board also makes recommendations to government on which professions should be designated as trades in Alberta, and competencies that apprentices should learn through apprenticeship education programs. It establishes details of designated trades, through board orders, including the undertakings and activities that fall within a trade, the standards and requirements for certification, out-of-province certifications recognized as equivalent to Alberta's, and education or training outside of apprenticeship education programs that meets some of the requirements for certification.

Land Agent Advisory Committee

The Land Agent Advisory Committee provides recommendations to the Minister of Advanced Education or Registrar of Land Agents on matters related to land agent licensing, including qualifications of applicants for licences, standards of conduct for land agents, and other matters requested by the Minister or the Registrar.

Premier's Council on Skills

The Premier's Council on Skills helps facilitate input from select strategic industries and provides advice to the Premier through the Minister of Advanced Education regarding the alignment of current and planned future programming in Alberta's adult learning system with industry needs. This work helps more students develop the job-ready skills they need to be successful in Alberta's evolving economy.

Skilled Trades Youth Ambassadors

The Skilled Trades Youth Ambassadors provide a direct pathway for collaboration between Alberta's government and young adult apprentices of Alberta. This advisory council informs Alberta government decisions by identifying challenges and opportunities for Alberta's youth in skilled trades. Ambassadors support the Minister of Advanced Education in championing skilled trades and apprenticeships.

Expert Panel on Post-Secondary Institution Funding and Alberta's Competitiveness

The Expert Panel on Post-Secondary Institution Funding and Alberta's Competitiveness was established in December 2024 to look at current and alternate post-secondary institution (PSI) funding mechanisms, impacts of federal immigration policies on Alberta's PSIs, the costs of the administrative and regulatory burden on PSIs, and the overall competitiveness of Alberta's post-secondary education system.

Post-secondary Institutions by Institution Type

Public Post-secondary Institutions

Comprehensive Academic Research Universities	Athabasca University University of Alberta University of Calgary University of Lethbridge
Undergraduate Universities	Alberta University of the Arts MacEwan University Mount Royal University
Polytechnic Institutions	Lethbridge Polytechnic Northern Alberta Institute of Technology Northwestern Polytechnic Red Deer Polytechnic Southern Alberta Institute of Technology
Comprehensive Community Colleges	Bow Valley College Keyano College Lakeland College Medicine Hat College NorQuest College Northern Lakes College Olds College Portage College
Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity	Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity

Other Post-secondary Institutions

Independent Academic Institutions	Ambrose University Burman University Concordia University of Edmonton MaKami College St. Mary's University The King's University
First Nations Colleges	Maskwacis Cultural College Old Sun Community College Red Crow Community College University nuhelot'ine thaiyots'ı nistameyimâkanak Blue Quills Yellowhead Tribal College

Key Highlights

The Ministry of Advanced Education focused on accomplishing two outcomes identified in the 2024-27 Ministry Business Plan:

- Outcome 1:** Albertans have the education and skills required to secure rewarding careers in the current and future labour market to support a thriving economy and society
- Outcome 2:** Alberta's high-quality adult learning system and professional regulatory environment attract, develop, and retain a skilled and talented workforce

Key highlights and results achieved by the Ministry of Advanced Education in 2024-25 include:

Outcome 1: Albertans have the education and skills required to secure rewarding careers in the current and future labour market to support a thriving economy and society

- Provided \$2.1 billion in operational funding for post-secondary institutions to deliver educational programs through the Operating and Program Support Grants.
- Provided \$76 million in 2024-25 through the Apprenticeship Learning Grant to 11 public post-secondary institutions, supplementing the Base Operating Grant to fund a total of 28,250 apprenticeship classroom instruction seats across Alberta ([page 27](#))
- Invested approximately \$1.1 billion to help Alberta students access post-secondary education. This includes approximately \$905 million in student loans to help 108,100 students, while approximately \$63 million in grants supported 18,100 students, and approximately \$101 million in scholarships and awards to 49,200 students. ([page 42](#))
- Investing approximately \$376 million over four years (2023 to 2027) to increase the number of graduates from Alberta's medical schools by 60 each year through new Rural Medical Education Program Training Centres in Grande Prairie and Lethbridge. ([page 32](#))
- Invested \$3.1 million in 2024-25 to support institutions to expand seats in mental-health related programs; this included year one funding of nearly \$2 million as part of a three-year initiative, in addition to over \$1.1 million in one-time funding. ([page 34](#))
- Provided \$70 million in 2024-25 for Targeted Enrolment Expansion funding to support 2,080 new enrolments in funded programs. ([page 31](#))
- Provided Mount Royal University with \$1.2 million in operational funding to support the development, launch, and expansion of its Bachelor of Aviation Management program. Additionally, Advanced Education invested \$590,000 to the Air Access Bursary to support approximately 59 students in pilot training programs. ([page 32](#))
- Invested \$1.1 million on a paid media campaign that ran from September 6 to November 17, 2024, to raise awareness on trades and apprenticeship programs and encourage more people to enter apprenticeship and the skilled trades. ([page 23](#))
- Invested \$116.7 million in capital projects to create modern learning environments, and \$133.1 million for capital maintenance and renewal needs to ensure existing structures are safe and operating efficiently. ([page 34](#))
- Established the Expert Panel on Post-Secondary Institution Funding and Alberta's Competitiveness to look at current and alternate post-secondary institution funding mechanisms, impacts of federal immigration policies on Alberta's institutions, the costs of the administrative and regulatory burden on institutions, and the overall competitiveness of Alberta's post-secondary education system. ([page 18](#))

Outcome 2: Alberta’s high-quality adult learning system and professional regulatory environment attract, develop, and retain a skilled and talented workforce

- Worked with the Southern Alberta Institute of Technology to establish the Alberta Bureau for International Education as a board-governed, not-for-profit organization that will work in partnership with Advanced Education and post-secondary institutions to continue growing Alberta’s international education sector. [\(page 53\)](#)
- Implemented the approach to managing the national cap on international student applications in Alberta, as well as a process for issuing Provincial Attestation Letters for all prospective international students. [\(page 56\)](#)
- Provided over \$5 million to continue to support seat creation in new and existing bridging programs to assist internationally educated nurses with obtaining a nursing license to practice in Alberta’s health care system. [\(page 54\)](#)
- Passed the *Professional Governance Act* to consolidate and streamline Advanced Education’s professional governance legislation from nine separate acts into one, ensuring consistency in the regulation of professions, while remaining responsive to the unique needs and operations of each professional regulatory organization. [\(page 50\)](#)
- Hosted the annual Premier’s Summit on Fairness for Newcomers to bring together stakeholders from across Alberta to discuss actions to support newcomer success and drive economic growth. [\(page 52\)](#)
- Hosted the Promising Practices for Alberta Regulatory Bodies event which took place in Edmonton. During the annual conference, regulatory bodies in Alberta shared innovative ideas and best practices, particularly around streamlining registration processes. [\(page 51\)](#)

The Ministry of Advanced Education remains committed to regulatory approaches and program delivery that reduces unnecessary government oversight and emphasizes outcomes, to improve access to government services, attract investment, support innovation and competitiveness, and grow Alberta businesses.

Discussion and Analysis of Results

Actions that support the priorities of the Government of Alberta Strategic Plan

Key Priority One: Maintaining Alberta's Advantage

Objective Two: Connecting Albertans to jobs

The following results contributed to key priority one, objective two of the Government of Alberta Strategic Plan:

- Alberta 2030: Building Skills for Jobs strategy ([page 17](#))
- *Skilled Trades and Apprenticeship Education Act* ([page 25](#))
- Air Access Expansion ([page 32](#))
- Targeted Enrolment Expansion ([page 31](#))
- Alberta at Work ([page 30](#))
- Work-Integrated Learning ([page 30](#))
- Apprenticeship Expansion Grant ([page 26](#))

Objective Three: Strengthening economic activity and attracting investment

The following results contributed to key priority one, objective three of the Government of Alberta Strategic Plan:

- Micro-credentials and Intellectual Property Commercialization ([page 20](#))

Key Priority Two: Supporting Albertans

Objective One: Supporting a refocussed, effective health care system

The following results contributed to key priority two, objective one of the Government of Alberta Strategic Plan:

- Physician Expansion ([page 32](#))
- Internationally Educated Nurses ([page 54](#))
- Registration pathways for Internationally Educated Nurses ([page 55](#))

Objective Three: Providing high-quality education and opportunities for skill development

The following results contributed to key priority two, objective three of the Government of Alberta Strategic Plan:

- Alberta Student Aid ([page 42](#))
- Mental Health Professions Enrolment Expansion ([page 34](#))
- Post-Secondary Institutions Capital Projects ([page 34](#))

Outcome One: Albertans have the education and skills required to secure rewarding careers in the current and future labour market to support a thriving economy and society

Key Objectives

- 1.1 Implement initiatives under the Alberta 2030: Building Skills for Jobs strategy to transform the adult learning system and focus on providing the high-quality education, skills and training needed for Alberta’s future.**

Alberta 2030: Building Skills for Jobs

The Alberta 2030: Building Skills for Jobs strategy was released in April 2021 and sets the direction for Alberta’s higher education system to 2030. The strategy aims to transform the adult learning system to focus on providing the high-quality education, skills, and training needed for Alberta’s future. It is built around six goals with clearly defined flagship initiatives to guide the post-secondary system in its vital role of advancing Alberta’s prosperity by creating jobs, diversifying and building the economy, developing, attracting and retaining talent, and building partnerships between institutions and industry.

The Alberta 2030 strategy goals:

1. **Improve Access and Student Experience:** Ensure all Albertans have access to high-quality post-secondary opportunities, and that the student experience is coordinated and integrated.
2. **Develop Skills for Jobs:** Ensure every student has the skills, knowledge, and competencies to enjoy fulfilling lives and careers, and that they have greater transparency around labour market outcomes.
3. **Support Innovation and Commercialization:** Contribute to Alberta’s innovation capacity by supporting post-secondary research, and strengthening its commercialization potential to create new knowledge, develop future skills, and diversify the economy.
4. **Strengthen Internationalization:** Become a leading destination for top talent to drive the growth of skills, ideas, and innovations, locally and globally.
5. **Improve Sustainability and Affordability:** Provide institutions greater flexibility to generate own-source revenue and strengthen student aid.
6. **Strengthen System Governance:** Modernize governance of the system to increase collaboration and drive outcomes.

Implementation of the Alberta 2030 strategy is occurring in phases, with significant investments and systems improvements made in 2024-25 to help achieve its vision and goals. Key actions in 2024-25 included the following:

- Invested \$3.1 million in 2024 to expand training opportunities for mental health professional spaces in Alberta’s post-secondary institutions. This investment supported 12 institutions in creating 761 new seats in high-demand mental health programs and ensuring consistent high-quality services to communities across the province, while preparing a new generation of mental health professionals. [\(page 34\)](#)
- As part of *Budget 2024*, supported the development of skills and talent in the medical sector to address physician labour market shortages, particularly in rural areas. [\(page 32\)](#)
- Provided significant investment in building new learning spaces and expanding the number of programs and seats in higher education. [\(page 34\)](#)
- Improved affordability for Alberta’s students by capping tuition increases for domestic students at two per cent at most public post-secondary institutions, starting in the 2024-25 academic year. [\(page 18\)](#)

- Established the Expert Panel on Post-Secondary Institution Funding and Alberta’s Competitiveness to review and evaluate post-secondary funding to ensure it is used efficiently and effectively. (page 18)
- Developed international education marketing materials used at signature events to encourage international students to enrol at Alberta’s post-secondary institutions. (page 53)

In 2024-25, Alberta continued to address skilled workforce shortages in critical sectors including health care, skilled trades, and technology, requiring strategic investments in targeted enrolment expansion and international credential recognition. To address challenges with affordability and inflation, Advanced Education also prioritized initiatives supporting Goal 5 of the Alberta 2030 strategy to improve sustainability and affordability, such as capping tuition increases for domestic students at two per cent and enhancing student aid programs.

Cap on Domestic Tuition Increase

To enhance affordability for post-secondary students, and support Goal 5 of the Alberta 2030 strategy to improve sustainability and affordability, government implemented a cap on tuition increases through amendments to the *Post-secondary Learning Act*. As of the 2024-25 academic year, tuition increases for domestic students in all public institutions, except for the Banff Centre, were capped at two per cent annually. In 2024-25, tuition increased by an average of 1.9 per cent at Alberta’s public post-secondary institutions, which was substantially less than the five per cent average increase for the 2023-24 academic year. Despite the cap, Alberta tuition remains comparable to the national average. Based on data from Statistics Canada, the average tuition for a domestic student in an undergraduate degree program in Alberta was \$374 above the national average, while tuition for a domestic student in a graduate degree program in Alberta was \$1,054 below the national average.

Average Tuition Figures, 2024-25 Academic Year

Program Type	Average Alberta Tuition	Average National Tuition
Domestic Undergraduate Degree	\$7,734	\$7,360
Domestic Graduate Degree	\$6,608	\$7,662
International Undergraduate Degree	\$33,435	\$40,114
International Graduate Degree	\$16,118	\$23,233

The implementation of the two per cent tuition cap was directly influenced by societal factors, particularly the financial pressures faced by students due to rising inflation in food and housing costs. The decision reflects a balance between addressing students’ affordability concerns, and acknowledging the financial stability needs of institutions, which rely on tuition revenue. Balancing affordability for domestic students with the revenue needs of post-secondary institutions presents an ongoing challenge.

Expert Panel on Post-Secondary Institution Funding and Alberta’s Competitiveness

In December 2024, the Expert Panel on Post-Secondary Institution Funding and Alberta’s Competitiveness was established to look at current and alternate post-secondary institution funding mechanisms, impacts of federal immigration policies on Alberta’s post-secondary institutions, the costs of the administrative and regulatory burden on post-secondary institutions, and the overall competitiveness of Alberta’s post-secondary

education system. The panel will provide a report to the Minister in Fall 2025 with recommendations and insights to help inform future decision-making regarding Alberta's post-secondary system.

Investment Management Agreements

Investment Management Agreements are required under the *Post-secondary Learning Act* and are the primary accountability instrument to implement performance-based funding at post-secondary institutions in Alberta. The agreements also support the Alberta 2030 strategy by incentivizing post-secondary institutions to expand work-integrated learning opportunities, increase domestic enrolment, and advance innovation and research commercialization. In 2024-25, the ministry continued to implement Investment Management Agreements with 27 post-secondary institutions into the final year of the agreement's three-year term (2022 to 2025).

Each year, Advanced Education assesses performance results against the targets set out in each post-secondary institution's agreement. If a post-secondary institution's results fall outside the established target band, its Base Operating Grant may be reduced in a subsequent fiscal year. The results for the 2023-24 year were assessed, and all post-secondary institutions were notified of their performance metric outcomes. Most post-secondary institutions achieved performance metric results within their approved target ranges, apart from two institutions which had domestic enrolment results are below the pre-determined target ranges. As a result, the 2025-26 Base Operating Grant for these two institutions will be reduced by approximately \$15,000 each. The ministry will continue to review the metric results annually to assess progress toward the Alberta 2030 strategy goals and determine whether funding adjustments are necessary.

Transfer System Improvements

The Alberta Transfer System is comprised of formal networks of post-secondary institutions, stakeholders, and government that collaborates to recognize learners' mobility pathways and prior learning through a framework of system governance, data, and tools. The Alberta Transfer System improvements support Goal 1 of the Alberta 2030 strategy to improving access and student experience. Learners benefit from greater access to transfer and pathways data and information to support and inform their post-secondary decision making.

Transfer Credit Awarded

Transfer Credit Awarded is the number of transfer credits awarded to students by member institutions (in the Alberta Transfer System) for courses, blocks of courses, or credentials that students previously completed at other institutions. It aims to address provincial data gaps in the transfer system by demonstrating what credit students received, and pathways they accessed, when they moved to another institution. The latest provincial data collection and results from 33 Alberta Transfer System member institutions indicated close to 500,000 transfer credits were awarded to over 16,750 students in 2022-23. This data includes transfer and prior learning assessment, and recognition credit awarded to learners in Alberta, with results helping to identify system data gaps and inform learner access to pathways.

Transfer Alberta Search Tool

The Transfer Alberta Search Tool is an online portal that allows learners to search institutions' course and program transfer decisions and high school to post-secondary courses for admissions and transfer. In 2024-25, the Transfer Alberta Search Tool included over 80,500 unique transfer decisions by Alberta Transfer System post-secondary member institutions. Additionally, over 134,000 learners/users are accessing this data through over 1.3 million page views annually. Apprenticeship education program credential transfer decisions were also added to the search tool for the first time in 2024-25, supporting learner access to 64 transfer pathways for transfer credit.

Provincial Committees

Provincial committees are institution-led committees in specific subject areas (e.g., English, Dual Credit) that collaborate with Advanced Education to foster post-secondary learner pathways and mobility for learners (e.g., admissions and transfer). In 2024-25, the Apprenticeship Education Articulation Committee was launched fostering apprenticeship education learner pathways and mobility in the transfer system. This committee will support stakeholder collaboration, communication, and information sharing within the skilled trades and apprenticeship education system in Alberta. In 2024-25, Advanced Education also supported the expansion of stakeholder collaboration and provincial transfer system committees, such as Affiliated Committee status for the Military Veteran & Family Connected Campus Consortium: Alberta Network. This collaboration helps to support future development of post-secondary military credential pathways and credit recognition.

Micro-credentials and Intellectual Property Commercialization

Intellectual property is essential for Alberta's competitive edge and economic diversification, supporting Goal 3 of the Alberta 2030 strategy to strengthen innovation and commercialization. In April 2023, Advanced Education published the Final Report of the Research Commercialization Working Group (RCWG) which recommended actions to increase research commercialization for post-secondary institutions and innovators. PricewaterhouseCoopers was contracted to review Alberta's intellectual property ecosystem and key learnings from leading domestic and international jurisdictions. This review will inform the development of an IP Commercialization and Monetization Framework.

In 2023-24, Advanced Education and the Ministry of Technology and Innovation launched a call for proposals in support of intellectual property micro-credential programs created by post-secondary institutions. Five successful proposals were selected to receive a total of \$1 million in grant funding, including the University of Alberta (three proposals), Athabasca University (one proposal), and Olds College (one proposal). In 2024-25, successful recipients of this funding collaborated with partner post-secondary institutions and industry partners to develop the micro-credential programs. These micro-credential programs will provide Alberta learners access to five new courses across various intellectual property commercialization topics, including Awareness of Agricultural Technology in IP Commercialization, IP for the New Innovator, IP Strategy and Management, IP Forward Mindset – Recognition and Commercialization, and IP Protection – Patentable and Non-Patentable Material.

Alberta's approach to enhancing intellectual property commercialization aims to meet stakeholders' needs and advance Alberta's global position in the new, knowledge-based economy. The grant funding also encourages collaborations between post-secondary institutions and industry, ensuring a wide range of perspectives are incorporated, minimizing duplication of efforts, aligning outcomes with real-world challenges, and lead to future joint initiatives.

Private Career College Oversight

Since 2019, there has been significant growth in Alberta's private career college sector, with unusually high increases in student complaints, student enrolment, and financial assistance applications at some new private career colleges. In 2024-25, the ministry took action to protect students by conducting compliance inspections of these private career colleges and holding them accountable to legislative requirements and licensing obligations.

The ministry conducted compliance reviews at 19 private career colleges identified as high risk, resulting in the issuance of stop orders of 14 schools (no new students can be enrolled), suspension of one school's program licences (stopping all training and enrolment), and the cancellation of one school's program licences (the school can no longer provide vocational training in Alberta). In addition, four private career colleges had their designations for student financial assistance revoked due to non-compliance.

To further control rapid growth in student financial assistance at private career colleges, the Alberta Student Aid Program implemented several new policies, including:

- limiting student financial assistance for online programs,
- introducing an enrollment growth cap for all private career colleges, and
- restricting provincial funding for students who attend private career colleges outside of Alberta.

To increase transparency and provide the public with better access to information, the ministry launched a new Private Career College Registry, which lists all licensed private vocational programs, their cost, duration, and location. The registry also lists the current licensing status of each program: as either active, stop ordered, or suspended. This new registry allows prospective students to compare programs and make informed choices about their education, reducing the influence of educational recruiters and marketers.

A variety of improvements modernized the private vocational licensing system including the release of a new online tool that streamlines the application process for existing licensees and improves application quality. The ministry also transitioned to e-Services from paper cheques for licensee payments to enhance financial oversight and launched a new automated reporting tool to track private career colleges’ financial securities more effectively, which are collected to protect student tuition.

French Language Programming for Post-secondary Level

Advanced Education, in collaboration with the Ministry of Education, coordinates federal funding to enhance French-language education for both French minority-language (FML) and French second-language learners (FSL), covering early childhood services to post-secondary education. The Protocol for Agreements for Minority-Language Education and Second-Language Instruction from 2024-25 to 2027-28 was ratified in November 2024 and lays the groundwork for ongoing federal-provincial collaboration. The ministry is a signatory to the Canada-Alberta Agreement on Minority-Language Education and Second-Language Instruction from 2024-25 to 2027-28. This agreement was ratified in March 2025, and formalizes the continued support and funding.

The federal contribution represents flow-through funding, which is matched, at a minimum, by Alberta post-secondary institutions.

Program Funding, 2024-25

Provincial Contribution	Federal Contribution	Total Contribution
\$8.133 million	\$7.570 million	\$15.703 million

Infrastructure Funding, 2024-25

Provincial Contribution	Federal Contribution	Total Contribution
\$1.430 million	\$1.375 million	\$2.805 million

This initiative, supported by federal funding and contributions from participating post-secondary institutions, has contributed to greater inclusivity and flexibility in Alberta’s education system. It has also expanded opportunities for Albertans to study in French, particularly through the growth of online and hybrid learning options, resulting in increased access to French-language education, regardless of location. Additionally, it has fostered the recruitment and retention of French teachers through bursaries and financial supports, and enhanced professional development for educators, further strengthening Alberta’s Francophone culture and identity. In 2023-24 (latest data available), the regular program funding provided to post-secondary

institutions supported recruitment, bursaries, program updates, and professional development resulting in maintained enrolment of over 2,200 students, 1,062 bursaries awarded, 21 FML and 29 FSL programs offered, 42 FML and 93 FSL professional development programs delivered, and 244 publications, of which 236 were in French.

Through additional federal funding matched by the University of Alberta, the Campus Saint-Jean Stabilization and Reinforcement project increased language instructors to 86 (67 full-time equivalent positions), expanded French courses to 229, and raised practicum supervision by the Practicum Office to 26 per cent. Over the last fiscal year, the Growing Capacity to Meet Teacher Demand project achieved a 100 per cent program completion rate. Through infrastructure funding, Campus Saint-Jean was enhanced by providing modern infrastructure in the form of digitally equipped classrooms, including the conversion of a section of the library into two new high-tech classrooms, allowing them to reach learners beyond the physical campus. This improvement fostered accessibility, interdisciplinary learning, and technological capacity. The infrastructure funding will also create space efficiencies at Campus Saint-Jean which is expected to be completed by February 2026.

Advanced Education will provide ongoing stakeholder support and chair the Official Languages in Education Programs Post-Secondary Provincial Advisory Committee which advises on the direction of official language programs to promote the vitality of Francophone education and French second-language programming in Alberta. The committee is comprised of proportional representation from diverse geographical regions, including Francophone regional authorities and second-language school authorities, rural and urban school authorities, public and separate school authorities, and appropriate government departments.

Real Property Governance Act

The *Real Property Governance Act*, which consolidates real property information of departments and amalgamated entities into a centralized inventory system with the Ministry of Infrastructure, received Royal Assent in May 2024. This Act will ensure that land and building sales across government are handled in a uniform manner. The Ministry of Infrastructure retains the first right of refusal on post-secondary institutions' land disposition, subject to final regulations which are under development.

Provincial Priorities Act

The *Provincial Priorities Act* empowers the Government of Alberta to counter federal overreach by requiring provincial entities to obtain approval before entering, amending, extending or renewing agreements with the federal government. This legislation, which was proclaimed in February 2025, ensures federal funding is aligned with provincial priorities and not undermining the province's jurisdiction.

In 2024-25, Advanced Education engaged post-secondary institutions to inform the development of regulations under the Act that ensures Alberta's post-secondary institutions maintain access to research and other funding from the federal government, while safeguarding Alberta's interests. All agreements between federal entities and Alberta's public post-secondary institutions are subject to the Act, and will be reported to the provincial government, with the most agreements exempted by regulation from prior provincial approval. The Act and regulation came into force on April 1, 2025.

1.2 Expand and enhance a modern, flexible, and efficient skilled trades certification and apprenticeship education system in Alberta that meets the evolving needs of the economy.

Trades and Apprenticeship Promotion

In 2024-25, Advanced Education continued to advocate and champion opportunities in apprenticeship programs in the skilled trades through a variety of initiatives. Attention focused on the K-12 education system to ensure, as early as junior high, this education track has parity of esteem as a desirable education pathway that will lead to a highly rewarding career.

In May 2024, the ministry appointed 12 youth ambassadors aged 18 to 31 in skilled trades and apprenticeships to promote the apprenticeship educational and trades career pathways as highly desirable opportunities for Alberta youth. The Ambassadors participated in 29 events between May 22, 2024, to March 31, 2025. As part of this appointment, the ambassadors were also featured in eight videos promoting the skilled trades that were published on the YourAlberta YouTube account, as well as the Government of Alberta website.

In June 2024, the ministry also refreshed the look and feel of the tradesecrets.alberta.ca website that provides comprehensive information to guide visitors through the apprenticeship education and skilled trades certification system in Alberta. The website received 5.9 million page views from 964,225 unique visitors between April 1, 2024, and March 26, 2025.

In September 2024, Advanced Education launched a successful advertising campaign called #WouldntTradeIt. The campaign included several initiatives to encourage Albertans to learn more about apprenticeship education and the skilled trades, including search engine marketing, social media ads, video ads, radio ads, online displays, ethnocultural displays, and transit ads. The campaign's impact exceeded expectations, with ads viewed or displayed more than 24 million times between September 6, 2024, and November 17, 2024. Eighty-five per cent of individuals surveyed indicated the ads made them feel positive about trades and apprenticeship education. Advanced Education also supported celebrations surrounding Apprenticeship Day, at 11 post-secondary institutions, to recognize and celebrate the value of apprenticeship education, and the contributions of apprentices to Alberta. Additionally, the ministry hosted information booths and delivered presentations at events such as the 2024 Calgary Stampede, Edmonton K-Days, and teachers' conventions across the province. During these events, ministry representatives had over 2,000 meaningful conversations with educators and the public.

In September 2024, the ministry launched the Youth Skills Network (YSN) as a way for young Albertans ages 14 to 29 to receive information about apprenticeship education and the skilled trades. YSN also allows young Albertans to provide feedback on the direction of apprenticeship education from their unique perspective. As of March 27, 2025, there were 112 members of the YSN. Advanced Education also provided \$882,000 to Calgary TELUS Spark to support the first two phases of its BLUprint (Build+Learn+You) skilled trades exploration program. Between June and September 2024, 23,389 guests participated in phase one and two programming.

High School Apprenticeship Programs and Scholarships

In 2024-25, Advanced Education awarded approximately \$1 million in High School Apprentice and High School Apprentice Bright Futures scholarships to nearly 950 students. The High School Apprenticeship program recognizes the accomplishments of Alberta high school students completing the Registered Apprenticeship Program (RAP) or the Career and Technology Studies pathway. The goal of the program is to encourage more students to explore trades education as a path to well-paying professional jobs that will provide financial stability and help meet future labour market demands. Many students participating in the

program complete their technical training sooner, and become certified journeypersons faster, because of their participation in the trades while in high school.

Allowing students to explore trades careers while “earning and learning” towards their future careers starting in high school, sets students up for success as they enter post-secondary technical programs. Many high schools in the province currently participate in the RAP program, and as the trades continue to be promoted in Alberta, student awareness and participation in the RAP program will hopefully increase.

Apprenticeship Education Program Updates

Advanced Education reestablished updates to apprenticeship education programs with the modernization of the first and second periods of the electrician program which launched in August 2024, with updates to the third and fourth periods set for implementation in August 2025.

The government has allotted \$20 million annually to update apprenticeship education programs in Alberta. This money is used to update content in apprenticeship programs, purchase shop/lab equipment for trainers to deliver the new content, upgrade facilities, develop new curriculum and train instructors to deliver the new content. The long-term goal is to update programs representing 97.5 per cent of all registered apprentices by 2031.

Trade Pathways

The Alberta Construction Association’s (ACA) Trade Pathways program aims to develop both unemployed young Albertans, and those from underrepresented groups, into apprentices and strengthen capacity in the construction industry. The program targets unemployed youth workers to successfully build the skills needed to permanently attach to the construction industry as a career, enabling more young Albertans to enter construction-related apprenticeships, so that construction industry employers to experience fewer labour shortages. In March 2022, Advanced Education provided \$3.2 million to support the ACA’s Trade Pathways pilot program that has surpassed its initial targets. In April 2023, Alberta’s government entered into a new grant agreement with the ACA for an additional \$3 million over three years to expand the programs beyond Edmonton, and into other regions of the province.

As of March 31, 2025, Trade Pathways has enrolled 243 participants in the Edmonton region and 123 participants from other regions in the province. As labour market demand increases, the pool of employers participating in the Trade Pathways program has grown from nine to 34 employers. The placement completion rate continues at approximately 65 per cent, with 93 per cent of those hired permanently. Efforts to recruit from marginalized and underrepresented groups are ongoing despite barriers such as construction employers’ workforce fluctuations based on successful project bids. New trainees from underrepresented groups lack sufficient training and experience from a single project to safely and productively attach to the construction labour force, placing them at risk of unemployment. The Trade Pathway program seeks to overcome this barrier by transferring trainees among a group of committed employers to ensure they are kept employed throughout the program and can develop skills and experience on multiple projects to allow them to successfully enter apprenticeship.

Youth Apprenticeship Connections Program

The Youth Apprenticeship Connections Program (YACP) pilot was developed collaboratively by the Ministries of Children and Family Services and Advanced Education to deliver career exploration and apprenticeship specialist coaching for youth in care and young adults formerly in care. The program provides participants with exposure to over 50 designated trades in Alberta, offering career development opportunities, coaching, and work experience. The goal is to help participants complete pre-apprenticeship programs and/or their first period of apprenticeship education.

Launched on March 1, 2024, in Edmonton, Calgary, and central Alberta, the program enrolled 129 youths in the first eight months. The program introduced innovative initiatives, including workshops addressing barriers like mentorship and resilience, and successfully placed youth in pre-apprenticeship programs through regional outreach. As of March 31, 2025, 78 participants were actively engaged in the program, with 68 engaged in skill-building activities, including foundational workshops, trades exploration, and industry-specific information sessions. Four participants have successfully registered as apprentices with blue books in hand and employer support.

The program's hands-on approach has not only strengthened client relationships but also effectively removed barriers to participation by delivering services directly to those in need. Advanced Education has committed to providing an additional \$1.5 million to the program in 2025-26, while Children and Family Services is working with Prospect Human Services Society to expand the current services provided in the Edmonton-Calgary corridor to participants across Alberta.

Implement and realize the *Skilled Trades and Apprenticeship Education Act*

The *Skilled Trades and Apprenticeship Education Act* (STAEA) came into force in 2022, enabling industries, skilled trades professions, post-secondary institutions, and government to better respond to emerging needs of the labour market. Implementation of the Act is a multi-year initiative that continued in the 2024-25 fiscal year and will continue in the coming years.

Apprenticeship Learning Model Expansion

The apprenticeship learning model, where learners receive at least 51 per cent of their education through on-the-job mentorship, is an educational approach applicable under both STAEA, where the government issues the credential, or through the *Post-secondary Learning Act* (PSLA), where a post-secondary institution issues the credential. As a flagship initiative in the Alberta 2030 strategy, expanding the apprenticeship learning model ensures students gain the skills, knowledge, and competencies needed for fulfilling lives and careers. This model assists Alberta-based organizations in meeting their talent development needs, and addresses workforce demands, especially in rapidly evolving industries. While historically linked to skilled trades, apprenticeship education now supports broader job creation and economic diversification by providing employers with a skilled workforce. Supporting Goal 2 of the Alberta 2030 strategy, this expansion focuses on developing skills for jobs and ensuring students are equipped for success at every stage of life.

Education credentials and post-apprenticeship pathways

The STAEA recognizes apprenticeship education as a form of post-secondary education, allowing for government-issued education credentials to be granted to apprentices upon successful completion of their program. Education credentials and the development of post-apprenticeship pathways validate apprenticeship education as a valid form of post-secondary education and provide increased opportunities for learners to continue their education and training beyond apprenticeship.

In 2024-25, Advanced Education worked with post-secondary institutions to encourage the development of new transfer pathways from apprenticeship education into other post-secondary programs. Based on the concept of prior learning recognition, transfer pathways give learners credit towards post-secondary programs based on education and experience gained in their past, including during an apprenticeship education program. In March 2025, the Apprenticeship Education Articulation Committee, as part of the Alberta Council on Admissions and Transfers (ACAT), was formed. The inaugural meeting was attended by representatives from 15 different post-secondary institutions who discussed actions needed for institutions to create more transfer credit pathways for apprenticeship program graduates. Additional Apprenticeship Education Articulation Committee meetings will be scheduled in 2025-26.

Throughout 2024-25, Advanced Education also raised awareness with stakeholders in Alberta's K-12 and post-secondary system of STAEA education credentials to address the misperception that apprenticeship education and the skilled trades are not considered equal to other forms of post-secondary education and occupations.

Apprenticeship Expansion Grants

In March 2022, Advanced Education issued 14 grants totaling \$6.4 million to nine post-secondary institutions to develop and deliver certificate and diploma programs utilizing the apprenticeship learning model. These grant-funded programs span various sectors, including early childhood education, hospitality and tourism, computer sciences and technology, and agricultural sales. Most programs developed with this funding were launched in the 2022-23 and 2023-24 academic years and are currently operational, with institutions submitting progress and final reports to the ministry on schedule.

In May 2024, Advanced Education held a second information-sharing session discussing the challenges and benefits of apprenticeship-style programs in non-traditional trades. Key challenges included securing enough on-the-job work placements, and some industries resisted offering paid placements and mentorship. Institutions also indicated that program redesigns and timeline adjustments were necessary, and that successful implementation hinges on strong collaboration between post-secondary institutions and industry, shifting employers' mindset towards an educational partnership. Despite the challenges, this initiative has successfully increased work-integrated learning opportunities for students, improved industry access to educated workers, and enhanced awareness of the apprenticeship learning model across Alberta's industries. As some grants conclude in March 2025, post-secondary institutions have the capacity to continue delivering their established apprenticeship-style programs using existing funding arrangements. Looking ahead, Advanced Education will continue to apply the lessons learned to guide the further expansion of the apprenticeship learning model in Alberta.

Industry Pathways

Launched in February 2023, the Industry Pathways initiative facilitates the expansion of apprenticeship education into new occupations under STAEA. It allows industries to explore the creation of new apprenticeship education programs, industry training programs and designated trades.

Since its inception, the initiative has garnered interest from over 25 occupations seeking information on potentially adopting the apprenticeship model. In 2024-25, Advanced Education held over 30 working group meetings with diverse industries such as commercial truck driving, community disability support, cybersecurity, aviation and arborists. Additionally, two information sessions were conducted in Fall 2024 targeting Alberta's IT industries to promote awareness of the opportunities available through Industry Pathways. To support industry engagement, Advanced Education retained two contractors. The first contract identified occupations suitable for new program development under STAEA was completed in March 2025. The second contract provides comprehensive support to industry representatives navigating the Industry Pathways process, with the aim to increase the adoption of the apprenticeship model under STAEA and is in place until March 2027. A total of \$955,891 was invested in these contracts during the 2024-25 fiscal year. Supporting materials, including the program application and public information sheets, were also updated in 2024-25 for enhanced clarity and efficiency.

The Industry Pathways Initiative provides valuable new access points to post-secondary education and workforce development for Alberta's industries, ultimately producing apprenticeship graduates equipped with practical, job-ready skills. In 2025-26 the ministry anticipates moving towards implementation of the first new industry training program and designated trade.

Apprenticeship Learning Grant

Apprenticeship education and skilled trades have a strong linkage to Alberta's economy. As the economy strengthens, apprentice enrolment and demand for classroom education increases. Additionally, Alberta is facing a skilled trades shortage as more workers are reaching the age of retirement. Alberta is currently close to an all-time high with more than 72,000 registered apprentices. This has resulted in significant pressure on seats and program delivery activities. In 2024-25, the ministry provided \$76 million through the Apprenticeship Learning Grant (ALG) to 11 public post-secondary institutions, supplementing the Base Operating Grant to fund a total of 28,250 apprenticeship classroom instruction seats across Alberta.

The Apprenticeship Learning Grant funding is instrumental in supporting the delivery of quality apprenticeship training and providing apprentices the chance to progress and complete their education. Allocation of ALG funding relies heavily on evidenced-based evaluation of seat demand. Post-secondary institutions have the flexibility to adjust seats across programs within the academic year to best meet demand.

In April 2024, Advanced Education announced a pilot program with the International Union of Operating Engineers (IUOE) Local 955's Training Trust Fund to deliver Crane and Hoisting Equipment Operator training. The pilot program was an opportunity for the government to test the use of alternate training providers. As a part of the \$76 million Apprenticeship Learning Grant, the ministry provided \$350,000 to IUOE to deliver four intakes of Crane and Hoisting Equipment Operator training for 32 students. In 2024-25, three cohorts were delivered with a 100 per cent fill rate. A fourth cohort is scheduled for May 2025 and is already full. This was the ministry's first time funding a union; therefore, policies and processes were developed to provide adequate oversight and accountability and the ministry worked closely with the IUOE to implement the pilot program.

In 2025-26, Advanced Education will continue to meet demand for apprenticeship education program seats through the Apprenticeship Learning Grant and Base Operating Grant. The ministry will also provide \$5 million in funding for union training centres to deliver recognized apprenticeship training.

Apprenticeship Partnerships

Advanced Education has long-standing partnerships with, and is the core funder for, CAREERS, Women Building Futures, and Skills Canada Alberta. These are key partners in promoting and building awareness of the opportunities in apprenticeship education and the skilled trades. The work of these partners results in youth, women, and Indigenous Albertans having increased awareness of, and access to, apprenticeship education and rewarding jobs in the skilled trades. Increased labour market demand highlights the need for continued work with partner organizations to promote and attract Albertans to the skilled trades.

CAREERS

CAREERS is an industry-led, not-for-profit foundation with a mission to bring together industry, schools, government, and communities to guide youth into successful career paths. Advanced Education, through the Core Funding Grant, provided CAREERS with \$22.5 million from 2023 to 2026 to support core programming. For the Alberta at Work Apprenticeships Partnerships Grant (2022 to 25), Advanced Education provided CAREERS with \$1.26 million for its High School Integration project. In 2024-25, CAREERS connected with more than 518 schools, and with over 2,529 employers to arrange more than 4,512 paid internships for high school students interested in a career in the skilled trades and other professions. CAREERS also engaged with Indigenous communities to reach youths in rural areas of the province. The Young Women in Trades and Technologies camps also gained wide-spread media attention for their popularity and contributed to the growth of internships for women to 1,222 of the total 4512, making up over 25 per cent of paid internships.

Women Building Futures

Women Building Futures is a non-profit organization that works to foster economic security for women facing barriers to entry in a workforce where they are traditionally underrepresented. Women Building Futures connects unemployed women and gender diverse individuals, as well as those working multiple jobs to make ends meet, with higher-paying careers in trades, trucking, and high-demand fields. In 2024-25, Advanced Education supported Women Building Futures with funding, including:

- \$3.0 million in core grant funding.
- \$1.1 million for the Women Ready to Work program to expand activities supporting youth engagement, industry supported programs, and to deliver the Career Advancement Scholarship.
- Through their Student Impact Fund, which Advanced Education provided with \$3 million in funding in 2022-23, Women Building Futures also continued to address financial barriers for students whose income excluded them from accessing foundational learning; this program will operate until 2025.

As of July 31, 2024, 9,074 women were registered as apprentices in Alberta, a 24 per cent increase from 2023-24. Women account for 13 per cent of the total apprentices registered, a proportion that has been increasing modestly but consistently over the past decade. Of the women registered as apprentices, 36 per cent are registered in the hairstylist apprenticeship program, 11 per cent are electrician apprentices and nine per cent are welder apprentices (a 60 per cent increase).

In 2024, Women Building Futures also incorporated emerging energy career pathing awareness and education into all existing Journey to Trades cohorts, resulting in approximately 118 women receiving education on this topic, and to prepare them to begin careers that support Alberta's energy industry. Alberta at Work funding of \$840,000 is allocated through Advanced Education over three years to support this work, with \$400,000 provided in 2024-25. In 2024-25, 66 per cent of graduates received financial assistance to complete their job-training through this organization, while 97 per cent of students graduated from the 18 programs delivered in Alberta during the year, totaling 270 women. Of the 270 graduates, 72 per cent found work within six months of graduation.

Skills Canada Alberta

Skills Canada Alberta promotes excellence in trades and technology careers through skills competitions, hands-on programs for students, and resources for educators. Through the Core Funding Grant, Advanced Education provided \$6.9 million in 2023 over three years to Skills Canada Alberta to support core programming. In 2024-25, Skills Canada Alberta programs reached over 44,000 students in Alberta to position skilled trades and technology careers as first choice career options for youth in the province. The organization leads participation in the Skills Canada National Competition to demonstrate Alberta's trades talent on the national and world stage. In 2024, 664 high school students and apprentices participated in the Provincial Skills Canada Competition, with 62 winners from that group then competing as Team Alberta at the Skills Canada National Competition in Winnipeg, earning 11 gold, 14 silver and 11 bronze medals. Six young Albertans competed as members of Team Canada at the WorldSkills Competition in Lyon, France in September 2024, earning a bronze medal in welding, and a Medallion of Excellence in baking. The next WorldSkills Competition is September 2026 in Shanghai, China. Additionally, in 2024, Advanced Education made investments to support more than 20,000 students from over 500 schools to participate in the Try-A-Trade® Takeout program, and 3,900 junior high students from 132 schools to participate in Skills Exploration Days.

Alberta at Work apprenticeship partnerships

Advanced Education allocated \$15 million over three fiscal years (2022-23 to 2024-25) to support apprenticeship partnerships with nine other partner organizations that promote awareness of the skilled

trades professions and encourage apprenticeship registrations. The one time-grants were provided to the following organizations:

- Alberta Ironworkers Apprenticeship and Training Trust Fund,
- Calgary Catholic Immigration Society (Pre-Employment Pipe-Trades Training program),
- Christian Labour Association of Canada,
- Electrical Industry Training Centres of Alberta,
- Lethbridge College – Centre for Trades (STEM program),
- Momentum Community Economic Development Society,
- The Educational Partnership Foundation (Indigenous partnerships),
- Northern Alberta Institute of Technology, and
- Southern Alberta Institute of Technology.

Alberta at Work apprenticeship grant recipients have successfully recruited vulnerable and/or underrepresented students to their pre-apprenticeship/pre-employment training programs and raised awareness of opportunities in apprenticeship education and the skilled trades. Key activities completed during the year to reach these achievements included:

- Delivering pre-apprenticeship/pre-employment training programs,
- Education and promotion of the trades as valuable career paths via targeted marketing campaigns, student and parent presentations, in-class presentations, conferences, and career events,
- Refinement and delivery of school activity kits to bring trades into K-6 classrooms,
- Targeting vulnerable or underrepresented Albertans, and providing unique supports needed to navigate apprenticeship education, and
- Gathering industry and labour market intelligence to inform programs and services.

Alberta Board of Skilled Trades

The Alberta Board of Skilled Trades (ABST) ensures that the standards and certification for Alberta's skilled trades professions are maintained to the highest level of quality and safety, and that Alberta's tradespeople have the necessary skills to ensure safety, competency, and compliance with industry requirements in each trade. In 2024-25, the ABST amended the Designated Trades' Activities and Certification Requirements Order regarding the Alberta Building Code and Department of National Defense credentials, as well as for the industrial construction crew supervisor, boilermaker, electrician, and ironworker trades. The ABST made recommendations to the Minister for legislative changes to designate the industrial electrician trades and designate the petroleum services trades.

In 2024-25, the My Skilled Trades Network grew to over 1,260 members through ABST's industry consultation mechanism. Members collectively participated in over 36 trades-related consultation projects with government (apprenticeship exams, Red Seal, international credential recognition, and trade designation work). The ABST members also represented the board during multiple government events and promotional opportunities, including Trades and Apprenticeship Promotion Plan industry engagements, industry annual general meetings, Apprentice and Industry Training Awards of Excellence, the Premier's Summit for Newcomers, and other Apprenticeship Day activities around the province. Members also met with the Skilled Trades Youth Ambassadors at multiple points throughout the fiscal year to discuss issues facing youth entering trades careers. Additionally, they met with the Premier's Council on Skills to discuss attraction, retention, career paths, and succession planning in the trades.

The expertise and leadership demonstrated through the board is crucial to ensuring Alberta continues to be a world leader in industry standards and advocacy. Industry involvement and buy-in is critical to the success of Alberta's apprenticeship education programs and skilled trades professions. Going forward, the ABST will

continue to raise awareness about the importance of skilled trades in Alberta, and work in collaboration with Advanced Education, industry stakeholders, and educational institutions to ensure Alberta meets economic and skilled labour demands in our province.

1.3 Strengthen the alignment of post-secondary programs to employment and expand innovative learning opportunities, such as work-integrated learning, to meet Albertans' skills development needs and support labour market demand.

Alberta at Work

Alberta at Work (AAW) is a multi-year cross-government initiative that supports Albertans to develop new skills and grow their career. The initiative includes a range of investments to support education and career pathways that respond to labour shortages in key sectors, and address barriers to labour force participation for underrepresented groups. In 2024-25, Advanced Education committed \$73.4 million to support AAW initiatives. The seven initiatives led by Advanced Education include:

- **Micro-credential Programs** helps Albertans re-skill and upskill to meet the needs of an ever-changing economy by creating innovative shorter-term and specialized programs in areas of high labour market demand. [\(page 20\)](#)
- **Work-integrated Learning Expansion** expands the Work-integrated Learning Industry Voucher program to provide post-secondary students and recent graduates with more opportunities to gain work experience in their area of study [\(page 30\)](#)
- **New Beginnings Bursary** supports low-income students studying in programs that align with priority economic sectors. [\(page 44\)](#)
- The **Indigenous Training Strategy** focuses on addressing barriers to studies for underrepresented learners by expanding access to post-secondary programming and wrap-around supports for Indigenous learners. [\(page 35\)](#)
- **Targeted Enrolment Expansion** creates new seats in high demand post-secondary programs that support priority industry sectors and have high workforce and student demand. [\(page 31\)](#)
- **Apprenticeship Learning Model Expansion** expands the apprenticeship learning model in existing high-demand apprenticeship programs while also supporting the development of new apprenticeship programs. [\(page 25\)](#)
- **Apprenticeship Partners Investment** expands apprenticeship opportunities through new and existing partnerships. [\(page 27\)](#)

Work-Integrated Learning

The Work-Integrated Learning Industry Voucher program provides a grant to industry associations to allocate funds to one or more industry employers to support paid work-integrated learning placements for learners. The program provides post-secondary students and recent graduates an opportunity to have work experiences in their area of study while learning or just after graduation. This helps increase both their chances of getting a job sooner, related to their interests and credentials, and of having higher median income upon graduation. The primary objectives of the program are to increase student and industry participation in paid work-integrated learning, increase collaboration between government and Alberta industry associations, and strengthen relationships between industry associations, employers, and post-secondary institutions. Overall, the program will help ensure students are well equipped with the skills needed to contribute to Alberta's economy.

In 2023-24, the three original industry associations, from the 2021 pilot, met their annual work-integrated learning placement targets, and in some cases exceeded their annual targets, as those programs are well established, and awareness among employer partners is strong. The final annual progress report was

submitted on May 31, 2024, indicating the successful delivery of the following number of work-integrated learning placements in 2023-24:

- Alberta Construction Association – 161 placements,
- BioAlberta – 89 placements, and
- Technology Alberta – 228 placements.

In 2024-25, roughly \$1.2 million in Alberta at Work funding was provided to three expansion industry associations to create up to 210 new work-integrated learning placements. The three expansion industry associations delivered 161 placements in 2024, with progress reports submitted to Advanced Education between December 2024 and January 2025. Advanced Education did not issue a call for proposals seeking new industry associations to participate in the Work-Integrated Learning Industry Voucher Program in 2024-25.

In May 2025, the ministry announced a \$15 million investment over three years in the Mitacs Internship program to provide valuable internship opportunities for post-secondary students and recent graduates in the province's priority growth areas such as research and development, innovation, and science. This \$15 million in provincial funding, combined with federal and industry funding, will allow the Mitacs Internship Program to offer more than 3,000 Albertan student internships. Internships also help industry partners achieve their innovation potential, respond to current business challenges and grow their competitive advantage.

2024-25 Expansion Industry Association Funding and Placements

Expansion Industry Association	Funding Allocated	Placements Delivered
Alberta Food Processors Association	\$517,500	63
Alberta Hospitality Association	\$488,750	69
Archaeological Society of Alberta	\$201,250	29
Total	\$1,207,500	161

Targeted Enrolment Expansion

Advanced Education implemented the Targeted Enrolment Expansion (TEE) program to help address Alberta's workforce needs by increasing spaces in post-secondary programs aligned with high-demand fields needing more working professionals. These high-demand economic sectors include, but are not limited to, health care, business, aviation, engineering, technology, film production, early childhood education, and veterinary medicine. The TEE program supports Goal 1 of the Alberta 2030 strategy to improve access and student experience.

There are currently two rounds of the TEE program, and during each round, seat expansions occur over three years. As part of the first round of funding from 2022 to 2025, TEE entered its third year with the total amount of \$70 million provided in 2024-25. While the TEE grant year runs from July 2024 to June 2025, quarterly reporting from participating institutions indicates there are approximately 2,080 new enrolments in funded programs in 2024-25, which is 72 per cent of the combined target of about 2,900. While quarterly reporting indicates strong results in 2024-25, some funded programs may fall short of meeting their seat expansion targets. Where institutions were already struggling to meet targets in previous grant years, Advanced Education has approved a small number of requests to redirect funding to programs with higher student demand.

Institutional reporting midway through the program indicates that many of the participating institutions are on track to meet their enrolment expansion targets in 2024-25, despite the condensed lead time to roll out

seats in the first year of TEE in 2022. With seat expansions occurring over three years, it is too early to determine the full impact of the program. Results for the first round of TEE will be available after the 2025-26 grant year. Advanced Education will closely monitor the progress of the first round of the TEE program, and work with institutions to support them in reaching their overall seat expansion targets.

Air Access Expansion

The Air Access Expansion strategy seeks to expand the enrolment in aviation related programming in Alberta through the creation of new aviation related programs or increasing seats within current aviation related programs. In Fall 2022, the Government of Alberta and WestJet signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) in recognition of skilled labour challenges facing the aviation sector in Alberta. The MOU is intended to increase diversification and growth in Alberta's aerospace, aviation, and logistics sectors. This expansion will increase seats within aviation-related programming at Mount Royal University (MRU), increasing learners' access to aviation programs and careers in the field. It will also help strengthen the aviation industry in the province, especially for Alberta-based aviation companies such as WestJet. This aims to boost the economy, and lead to further flight options and better service quality within the aviation sector for those living in Alberta and Western Canada.

Bachelor of Aviation Management program

Advanced Education provided Mount Royal University with \$1.5 million in operational funding in 2024-25 as part of a \$6 million investment over three years (2023 to 2026) to support the development, launch, and expansion of its Bachelor of Aviation Management program. In 2024-25, 80 new seats were created, 40 of which were through MRU's Aviation Diploma program, and 40 through MRU's newly created Bachelor of Aviation Management program. The new program will have an annual intake of 40 students per year over three years (2024 to 2027). In 2025-26, MRU will receive \$950,000 in operational funding.

Air Access Bursary

In 2024-25, Advanced Education invested \$590,000 in the Air Access Bursary to support approximately 59 students in pilot training programs. This bursary makes it easier for Albertans to access pilot training while supporting Alberta's labour market needs and industry demand. In 2024-25, the bursary was offered through a grant agreement with MRU to provide up to \$10,000 in financial support to eligible students in pilot training for the 2024-25 academic year, with reporting available after July 31, 2025. For 2025-26, approximately \$1.7 million is budgeted for the bursary which is expected to support up to 170 students in pilot training programs at MRU. Advanced Education will continue to support aviation programming in the province to ensure the sector remains supported by well-trained professionals.

Physician Expansion

Advanced Education, in partnership with the Ministry of Health and post-secondary institutions, is investing approximately \$376 million over four years (2023 to 2027) to increase the number of graduates from Alberta's medical schools by 60 each year through new Rural Medical Education Program Training Centres in Grande Prairie and Lethbridge. This includes \$43.2 million to the University of Lethbridge to construct a Rural Medical Education Training Centre to deliver undergraduate medical training and provide more opportunities to train doctors in a smaller community, and operational funding to increase the number of seats in Doctor of Medicine programs. To achieve this, the University of Alberta (U of A) is partnering with Northwestern Polytechnic to deliver undergraduate medical education through a training centre in Grande Prairie, and the University of Calgary (U of C) is partnering with the University of Lethbridge to establish a centre in Lethbridge. The new Rural Medical Education Program Training Centres will each produce 30 medical graduates per year when fully operational, with each general practitioner able to care for approximately 1,200 patients a year, giving rural populations better access to a doctor, closer to home.

In 2023-24, the first year of the initiative and latest data available, both the U of A and the U of C each successfully met their target of 10 additional seats. The U of C exceeded the target and created 34 seats, for a total of 44 additional seats. At full implementation, there will be 120 additional undergraduate medical seats: 120 new seats at the U of A's Rural Medical Education Training Centre, and 90 new seats at the U of C's Centre. Results for the 2024-25 term will be available in August 2025.

Micro-credentials

Micro-credentials are a new and innovative type of program in Alberta's post-secondary system that allows learners to upskill, reskill, and pivot in their careers more quickly than through traditional credentials. Micro-credentials may be taken as stand-alone courses or stacked together towards a traditional certificate or diploma. Many of the programs offered as micro-credentials do not have traditional credentials associated with them. Micro-credential programs provide individuals with an opportunity to have their skills recognized. Advanced Education supported post-secondary institutions to offer micro-credentials through a pilot program, creating new types of post-secondary opportunities in innovative areas that respond to rapidly evolving industry needs. Institutions have now gained experience offering micro-credential programs and are better equipped to develop and offer such programming in the future.

The final reporting for the first round of the pilot program was released on May 31, 2024. Results indicated there were a total of 4,822 students enrolled in a micro-credential program, with 3,567 (or 74 per cent) completing the program as of the reporting deadline. As of the reporting deadline, out of the 56 micro-credential programs funded under the first round of the pilot project, 49 were being offered, six had been discontinued, and one was still in development.

In 2024-25, several post-secondary institutions continued to face challenges developing and launching their micro-credential programs due to issues recruiting appropriate subject matter experts, and in some cases, struggling to find qualified instructors. Some institutions requested extending their grant terms for another year to allow for additional time to launch their programs. Institutions also continued to report that a lack of a framework for micro-credential programs complicated program development. Advanced Education is exploring a micro-credential framework that will provide guidelines and definitions to Alberta's post-secondary system.

Mitacs Globalink Program

The Mitacs Globalink program is a two-way mobility program that provides Alberta students with the opportunity to research abroad, and students from partner countries with opportunities to pursue academic research in Alberta. The program also supports bilateral research collaborations between academic institutions and industry partners, both in Canada and abroad, to attract top talent to drive the growth of skills, ideas, and innovations, locally and globally.

As of October 2024, the ministry's investment of \$350,000 funded 48 internships and 59 awards. Most internships were in technology and innovation, energy, and agriculture and forestry sectors, with participants coming from India, United Kingdom, Mexico, Colombia, France, and Ukraine. For the awards program, there were a total of 28 Alberta students who studied internationally, and 31 students who came to Alberta. The inbound participants to Alberta were from Ukraine, France, Germany, and India, with most of the awards in the technology and innovation, and energy sectors.

Throughout its agreement, from October 2021 to September 2024, Mitacs leveraged Advanced Education's contribution of over \$1.3 million into an over \$2.7 million investment for Alberta, including over \$1 million from the federal government, \$264,636 from international partners, and \$125,000 from university partners.

Mental Health Professions Enrolment Expansion

The Mental Health Professions Enrolment Expansion initiative is supporting post-secondary institutions across the province to create new seats in programs related to in-demand mental health professions such as psychiatric nurses, psychologists, social workers, child and youth care experts, and addiction counsellors. Expanding mental health profession programs will increase the number of mental health professionals practicing in Alberta, with the aim of improving access to mental health care across the province.

In 2024-25, Advanced Education invested \$3.1 million to support institutions to expand seats in mental-health related programs, which included \$2 million in year one funding, and \$1.1 million in one-time funding. As the Mental Health Professions Enrolment Expansion initiative was newly launched in 2024-25, the ministry will not receive results until August 31, 2025, for the first annual reporting period.

Going forward, Advanced Education will closely monitor the progress of the Mental Health Professions Enrolment Expansion initiative and support institutions to reach their expansion targets in funded programs.

Post-Secondary Institutions Capital Projects

Advanced Education provides capital investments in the post-secondary system to expand student capacity and enhance learning environments that contribute to a strong foundation of graduates that help build the future. Each year, Alberta's public post-secondary institutions provide capital plans and capital submissions to outline their infrastructure needs. The provincial capital plan helps determine which projects will be approved, and how funding will be allocated for those projects. Once a post-secondary capital project is approved, Advanced Education works with the public post-secondary institution and the Ministry of Infrastructure to monitor the progress of each project.

In 2024-25, Advanced Education announced investments of \$360.5 million for capital projects over the three-year budget cycle. This included \$116.7 million in 2024-25 to help create modern learning environments, and \$133.1 million for capital maintenance and renewal needs to ensure existing structures are safe and operating efficiently, while mitigating the deferred maintenance across the system.

Capital projects approved in 2024-25 focused on expansion in high-demand post-secondary programs such as science, technology, engineering, and math (STEM), trades, and health care, and are as follows:

- \$125 million in funding over four years for the development of MacEwan University's new School of Business to accommodate up to an additional 7,500 students in business and STEM fields,
- \$43 million to NAIT for the Advanced Skills Centre planning to expand training capacity in the trades,
- \$63 million to Olds College for the W.J. Elliott Expansion and Renewal project to renovate and expand student spaces,
- \$12.9 million to Red Deer Polytechnic for the CIM-TAC East Campus Expansion to create purpose-built space to help businesses conduct applied research,
- \$215 million to the University of Calgary for the construction of the Multidisciplinary Hub to increase student capacity by over 1,000 spaces in STEM programs,
- \$43.2 million to the University of Lethbridge for the Rural Medical Education Training Centre to offer a Doctor of Medicine program and provide more opportunities to train doctors in a smaller community,
- \$2.3 million for the launch and expansion of the Bachelor of Aviation Management program at Mount Royal University, and
- Investing \$11.3 million over two years in 2024 for a state-of-the-art power engineering lab at Northwestern Polytechnic to create an additional 60 seats.

Polytechnic Transitions

Alberta has a differentiated system of publicly funded post-secondary institutions that is designed to foster learning opportunities to meet the needs of learners in all regions of the province. On June 20, 2024, Lethbridge College, a public post-secondary institution designated as a comprehensive community college under the *Post-secondary Learning Act*, was redesignated as a polytechnic institution under the PSLA through an Order in Council, effective September 3, 2024. This redesignation was an initiative to increase access to polytechnic education and a broader spectrum of learning opportunities in southern Alberta. In October 2024, Lethbridge Polytechnic completed its rebranding, and now offers two new certificate programs, and one revamped certificate for the Fall 2025 semester. These include General Arts and Science – A’paitapisksinimaattsaa (Weasel People Education), General Arts and Science – Kinesiology, and Medical Office Assistant and Unit Clerk.

Lethbridge Polytechnic’s redesignation from a comprehensive community college removed their regional steward role, leaving the Lethbridge region without a regional steward. However, southern Alberta, including the Lethbridge and Medicine Hat regions, now has a polytechnic institution, comprehensive community college, First Nations college, and university: Lethbridge Polytechnic, Medicine Hat College, Red Crow College, and the University of Lethbridge, respectively. This array of post-secondary institutions allows students to choose from various forms of post-secondary education locally, potentially eliminating the need for long-distance travel or relocation.

1.4 Strengthen the participation of adult learners from diverse, under-represented, and vulnerable populations in educational programs.

Alberta At Work – Indigenous Training Strategy

As part of the Indigenous Training Strategy, a component of Alberta at Work, Advanced Education is investing a total of \$8.8 million over four years (2022 to 2026), with the goal of supporting Indigenous learning and workforce development initiatives. In 2024-25, nearly \$1.9 million in funding was allocated to Trade Winds to Success and the Indigenous Learning Grant to provide targeted support and resources aligned with the strategic priorities of Alberta at Work, and Goal 1 of the Alberta 2030 strategy to improve access and student experience. Indigenous Learning Grant recipients report common measures in interim reports that are submitted at the end of September annually. As a result, Advanced Education currently only has results for 2023-24 and will receive 2024-25 results in Fall 2025.

Trade Winds to Success Grants

The Trade Winds to Success Training Society is an Indigenous-led non-profit organization that receives Advanced Education grant funding to provide pre-apprenticeship training and support to Indigenous students through a network of Indigenous partners, unions, and employers. The society supports underrepresented populations and Indigenous people in Alberta secure employment and achieve journey person status. In 2023-24 (latest data available) the Trade Winds to Success Grants results included:

- Seven union training programs,
- Four residential construction programs,
- Five outreach programs,
- 200 students started training,
- 109 students completed training, and 59 students still in training,
- 76 graduates gained employment in the trades, and
- Seven Eco-Smart homes were built.

Grant funding agreements in place between the society and Advanced Education include:

- A three-year agreement that began in 2022, with an end date of March 31, 2025, to provide the society with \$750,000 for its Commercial and Industrial Pre-Apprenticeship Program, \$250,000 of which was allocated in 2024-25.
- A three-year agreement (2024 to 2027) for approximately \$1.5 million to support the society's administrative operations and allow for the delivery of programs such as the Residential Construction for Indigenous people, \$258,340 of which was provided in 2024-25.

Indigenous Learning Grant

Advanced Education, through the Alberta at Work funds, provided over \$1.6 million of investments to address shortages in high-demand post-secondary programs, and in wrap-around services for Indigenous students through the Indigenous Learning Grant. The goal of the program is to tackle systemic barriers to accessing post-secondary education for Indigenous students, and to provide effective support throughout their educational journey. Eligible institutions for the Indigenous Learning Grant encompass 26 publicly funded post-secondary institutions, and five First Nations Colleges. Through the Indigenous Learning Grant, institutions can expand enrolment into high-demand programs and develop or expand Indigenous-specific wrap-around supports for Indigenous learners. In 2023-24, the grant supported the creation of over 308 new seats in public post-secondary institutions, independent academic institutions, and First Nations Colleges. The grant also provided 321 individual financial coaching sessions, 54 academic coaching sessions, 900 hours of STEM tutoring, hiring of 10 full-time staff, and 12 seats held for Indigenous students at public post-secondary institutions and independent academic institutions. In 2024-25, the ministry distributed over \$1.1 million to public post-secondary institutions and independent academic institutions and \$500,000 to First Nations Colleges for the Indigenous Learning Grant.

Indigenous Program Grants

Growth and development within Indigenous communities are driving increased demand for local training and education initiatives. Community-based programs are critical for enhancing Indigenous student participation and completion rates, while also providing culturally safe learning environments. Advanced Education is dedicated to fostering mutually beneficial relationships with Indigenous adult post-secondary education providers. These partnerships aim to assist providers to develop and offer a broad spectrum of educational activities and initiatives which ultimately serve to increase the success of Indigenous adult learners through multiple pathways into, and dedicated supports throughout, adult education for Indigenous adult learners. Advanced Education currently only has results for 2023-24 and will receive 2024-25 results in Summer 2025.

First Nations Colleges Grant

In 2024-25, Advanced Education allocated \$3.2 million in annual funding to First Nations Colleges, through the First Nations Colleges Grant to support a wide variety of programs focused on the inclusion and success of Indigenous learners. The First Nations Colleges Grant is a program grant aimed at supporting the enactment and implementation of a diverse range of activities executed by First Nations Colleges that enhance foundational skills, increase access to higher education and training opportunities, and improve both retention and learning outcomes for Indigenous learners.

Through the First Nations Colleges Grant, First Nations Colleges can invest funding in any number of initiatives that support ongoing operations, foundational learning, and programming. In 2023-24 (latest data available), the grant supported the creation of over 1,013 seats, 296 in foundational learning programs, eight full-time faculty and staff positions, and student access to learning services, including library resources. Advanced Education has committed to ongoing funding of Indigenous-specific program grants, including a \$500,000 increased allocation for the First Nations Colleges Grant specifically designated for First Nations Colleges in the next fiscal year.

Indigenous Post-secondary Mental Health Grant

The Indigenous Post-secondary Student Mental Health Grant is a program grant aimed at supporting an array of non-clinical culturally responsive mental health and well-being initiatives for Indigenous learners enrolled at First Nations Colleges. Through the Indigenous Post-secondary Student Mental Health Grant, students can access non-clinical culturally responsive mental health services and programming on First Nations Colleges campuses. In 2023-24 (the latest data available), the grant supported the delivery of over 642 non-clinical mental health counselling appointments, and 108 mental health and well-being programs or events. In 2024-25, the ministry provided \$400,000 in grant fundings that were distributed equally across the five First Nations Colleges.

Indigenous Initiatives Grant

The Indigenous Initiatives Grant provided nearly \$1.3 million in funding to local Indigenous adult and post-secondary education learning providers to support the development and delivery of workforce learning programs. These programs are specifically designed to align with and advance both the ministry's and grant recipient's key strategic priorities, while also enhancing employment skills and access to learning within Indigenous communities. First Nations Colleges, Metis Settlements, Indigenous Adult Learning Providers, and Rupertsland Institute are eligible for the Indigenous Initiatives Grant. Through the Indigenous Initiatives Grant, recipients can offer workforce development and employment skills programming for Indigenous learners. In 2023-24 (the latest data available), the grant supported the creation and offering of over 485 seats in 18 unique learning programs, and 65 scholarships for Indigenous post-secondary students.

In 2024-25, \$500,000 was distributed equally across the five First Nations Colleges, \$290,000 was distributed equally across the four Indigenous Adult Learning Providers, and \$306,250 was distributed equally across seven Métis Settlements. Advanced Education also distributed \$150,000 to Rupertsland Institute.

Maskwacis Cultural College Emergency Relief Grant

The Maskwacis Cultural College Emergency Response Grant of \$40,000 was provided by the ministry to support strategic planning, and asset protection, among other emergency response needs following the forced closure of their campus due to damages to the building from a severe storm. Results of the Maskwacis Cultural College Emergency Response Grant will be available in Summer 2025.

First Nations Agreements

The three provincial agreements between the Government of Alberta, and First Nation Tribal and Treaty organizations ensures a productive working relationship based on areas of mutual interest, collaboration and cooperation. The Agreements provide a formal framework for continued collaboration by bringing elected officials, Chiefs and Councils together to support meaningful discussion, share information, and explore issues of mutual concern. In 2024-25, Advanced Education provided \$250,000 to support the Confederacy of Treaty Six First Nations Relationship Agreement Education Table and the Stoney Nakoda-Tsuut'ina Tribal Council Protocol Agreement Education Table. The Blackfoot Confederacy-Government of Alberta Protocol Agreement did not receive money in 2024-25 as their funding cycle falls on alternating years from the other two agreements. Through the Protocol and Relationship Agreement Grants, recipients can invest in initiatives that support the attainment of key issues identified in individual Education Table Work Plans. Details on the results achieved through the Provincial Agreement Grants will not be available until September 2025 and January 2026.

Students with Disabilities Grant Program

Under the *Alberta Human Rights Act*, Alberta's post-secondary institutions are required to provide accommodation in the form of resources and supports to students with disabilities. Advanced Education

provides an annual Students with Disabilities Grant of over \$11.2 million to 26 publicly funded post-secondary institutions to enhance their capacity to provide services, supports, and accommodations for students with disabilities seeking assistance. This grant complements the grant funding available for students with disabilities through Alberta Student Aid and plays an important role in providing access to adult learning opportunities.

In 2023-24 (the latest data available), the Students with Disabilities Grant helped 26 publicly funded post-secondary institutions accommodate 21,750 students with disabilities across the province, representing a nine per cent increase from the previous year. Advanced Education recognizes that there has been an increase in the number of students self-identifying as needing disability supports, as well as in the number of students assessed as having multiple disabling conditions. These increases have led to higher costs to institutions in providing accommodations to students with disabilities.

Going forward, the ministry plans to continue its long-term commitment to help students with disabilities receive the accommodations and supports they need. The grant program runs from July 1 to June 30, with final reports for the 2024-25 term expected to be submitted to the ministry by August 31, 2025.

Post-secondary Student Mental Health Grant

The Post-secondary Student Mental Health Grant recognizes that promoting student mental health and supporting programs and services that respond to learner mental health concerns strengthens the participation of adult learners from diverse, underrepresented, and vulnerable populations in post-secondary education programs. The grant provides Alberta's 26 publicly funded post-secondary institutions with \$8 million annually to support the delivery of non-clinical mental health programs and services. Annual allocations to institutions vary from \$80,000 to approximately \$1.1 million, based on factors such as campus location and institutional size, to provide institutions with funding predictability and stability to ensure service continuity for learners. The grant funds a broad range of initiatives within this non-clinical mandate, including, but not limited to, counselling, peer support programs, on-campus mental health awareness, and promotion campaigns, developing campus mental health strategies, and training for faculty, staff, and students on topics such as suicide prevention.

The 2024-25 Post-secondary Student Mental Health Grant interim reports are due to Advanced Education on August 31, 2025. In 2023-24 (the latest data available), the grant supported the delivery of over 60,000 non-clinical mental health or addictions counselling appointments, continuing to surpass pre-COVID-19 pandemic levels, when approximately 55,000 appointments were typically delivered each year. The grant also supported the delivery of mental health formal training and skills development activities to over 15,000 staff and students. In 2024-25, the grant was renewed for another three-year term (2024 to 2027) through updates to the program's guidelines and reporting templates, including the incorporation of student feedback to ensure the program is responsive to student priorities and concerns.

In addition, Advanced Education provides \$300,000 annually to the Canadian Mental Health Association Alberta Division and Centre for Suicide Prevention to support the operation of the Healthy Campus Alberta (HCA) community of practice that supports institutional capacity to develop programs and services that effectively respond to learner mental health needs by serving as a provincial hub for collaboration and learning. Results from the Healthy Campus Alberta Impact Survey include that 89 per cent of respondents found information related to student mental health through HCA and were able to transfer what they heard at HCA events to their work environment. Further, 86 per cent of respondents indicated that they made useful contacts through HCA, and 81 per cent of respondents indicated that they used resources on the HCA website that assisted them in their role.

Addressing Gender-based Violence

The Government of Alberta remains committed to increasing awareness of consent and healthy relationships and addressing gender-based violence in all its forms. In 2023, the Minister of Arts, Culture and Status of Women signed the National Action Plan to End Gender-Based Violence and successfully negotiated a four-year funding agreement with the federal government. As part of this agreement, in 2024-25, Advanced Education received over \$1 million and dispersed it to all 26 publicly funded post-secondary institutions and five First Nations Colleges. The federal funding will be used to bolster sexual and gender-based violence awareness and prevention activities and implement survivor-centric reporting tools and processes. In March 2025, Advanced Education provided an additional \$950,000 to publicly funded post-secondary institutions, and \$100,000 to four First Nations Colleges, to support sexual and gender-based violence prevention training and awareness events and campaigns.

Alberta's post-secondary institutions continue to meaningfully raise awareness of consent, sexual violence, and how to support those who may have experienced sexual violence by increasing awareness campaigns, events, and training opportunities for students, staff, and faculty. This was demonstrated by the 16 training events delivered at institutions with 8,445 learners, staff, and faculty participating in 79 sexual and gender-based violence prevention and support training programs and opportunities. With the support of Advanced Education, First Nations Colleges are also implementing sexual and gender-based violence prevention training and awareness events and campaigns. The first six weeks of the academic semester are usually considered a high-risk time for sexual violence; therefore, September is a particularly critical time to raise awareness of consent. In September 2024, the ministry declared the third week of September as Consent Awareness Week in perpetuity through the *Special Days Act*. This marks every September as an opportunity to focus on the importance of consent while students are heading back to campus. These prevention efforts, along with survivor-centric reporting tools, create safer environments for post-secondary students.

The first National Action Plan to End Gender-Based Violence report was due in April 2024, which did not provide institutions who had received initial funding in February 2024 with sufficient time to launch activities to report on. Sixteen of 26 institutions had reported spending funds by April 1, 2024. Advanced Education extended the grant for 2023-24 funds to February 28, 2026, to allow institutions more time to initiate activities. The final report for 2023-24 National Action Plan to End Gender-Based Violence funds is due to the ministry April 1, 2025, and reporting for 2024-25 is due in April 2026. Going forward, Advanced Education will also collaborate with other ministries and government partners to implement the Government of Alberta's 10-year Strategy to End Gender-Based Violence, which was announced in May 2025.

Foundational Learning Assistance

Foundational Learning Assistance creates access to adult learning opportunities that support upskilling and re-skilling for jobs with labour market demand through two main categories of programming—foundational learning and skills development. Foundational learning programs build full-time and part-time students' foundational competencies to pursue further education, or to find employment. These include academic upgrading (Grades 10-12), adult basic education (Grades 1-9), and English as an Additional Language. Skills development programs provide full-time occupationally focused training opportunities that enable students to get a job and substantially improve their employment situation, adapt to changing labour market conditions, or gain skills to sustain employment. These include integrated foundational pathways, pre-apprenticeship programs, and transitional vocational programs.

Eligible Albertans can receive funding to assist with living costs, tuition, books, supplies, and childcare while attending approved programs. Tuition and fees are paid directly to the approved educational institution, while monthly living allowances, books, and supplies are paid directly to the student. Approved educational institutions participating in the program include public post-secondary institutions, private providers,

community providers, First Nations Colleges, Indigenous learning providers, and public and other school boards recognized by the Ministry of Education.

In 2024-25, Foundational Learning Assistance supported nearly 6,900 Albertans attending foundational learning and skills development programs. Foundational Learning Assistance also executed a two-year extension to a pilot project with Momentum Community Economic Development Society for its Tech Training for Women program, a 20-week research and innovation skills training initiative designed to provide opportunities for women to upskill and reskill to gain entry level employment opportunities or continue their formal training within the technology sector.

Foundational Learning Assistance also underwent a program review that resulted in three iterative updates to the Foundational Learning Assistance Policy Manual throughout the 2024-25 fiscal year. Updates focused on ensuring the program was serving the right population and providing the right level of funding support to ensure effective program outcomes, including:

- Refining the types of other exceptional expenses that can be claimed,
- Clarifying the approval process for academic upgrading at high schools,
- Refining the types of skills development programs that can be approved,
- Increasing the part-time income threshold, and
- Introducing standardized tuition refund parameters.

With the iterative policy updates implemented there was an approximate nine per cent reduction in the average cost per student in the 2024-25 fiscal year. The ministry will continue to monitor to identify any trends. Foundational Learning Assistance may be provided to students 16 to 19 years of age who are completing their High School Education, and are also pregnant, or a single parent, or living independently due to a significant breakdown in the student's relationship with their parents or guardians. In 2024-25, the program saw the highest number of high school students in the program's history with approximately 2,100 students supported by Foundational Learning Assistance, an increase of nine per cent from the prior year. This continued increase may still be due to increased demands as some students fell behind in their learning due to COVID-19 health restrictions, and the reduction of in-person learning at educational institutions that delivered Foundational Learning Assistance funded foundational learning and skills development programming.

Advanced Education's Foundational Learning Assistance budget was originally approved at \$116.9 million in 2024-25 but was later reduced to \$82.2 million due to federal Labour Market Transfer Agreements funding cuts of \$70.8 million. This significant federal reduction was challenging for program providers. In 2024-25, Advanced Education spent \$75.6 million through the Foundational Learning Assistance program to support nearly 6,900 Albertans attending foundational learning and skills development programs. This expenditure was less than the \$82.2 million budgeted, due to the decrease in the average cost per student over the course of the fiscal year from successive policy updates. The program ultimately was able to serve the same number of students expected under the originally approved budget.

The primary measure of success for the Foundational Learning Assistance programs is further education or employment of participating students. The overall provincial standard for students accepted into and starting foundational learning and skills development programs is that 70 per cent of students become employed or advance to further education within 90 days of program completion. Most recent data indicates that 73 per cent of those who complete the program of study secured employment or advanced to further education within 90 days.

Community Adult Learning Program

The Community Adult Learning Program (CALP) provides foundational learning opportunities in the areas of literacy, numeracy, English language learning, and basic digital skills, as well as education for adults who do

not yet have the skills required to transition into academic upgrading (Grades 10-12), other learning opportunities, or employment. CALP supports Albertans who often face multiple barriers to learning and have complex needs such as mental illness, physical challenges, learning disabilities, and low socio-economic status. While the CALP programming does not lead to formal credentials, given its informal, part-time, and learner-centred approach, it plays a key role in preparing individuals for the workforce and for further learning, including high school equivalency programs. CALP programs are delivered across the province by 80 community-based providers, collectively reaching more than 220 communities. In 2024-25, Advanced Education provided \$21.1 million of grant funding to the program. This included \$13.1 million distributed amongst 80 community providers, \$6.1 million provided to three granting councils located in Edmonton, Calgary and Red Deer, and \$1.7 million for two professional development providers. This funding supported operations during the 2024-25 program year (July 1, 2024, to June 30, 2025).

During the 2023-24 program year (the latest data available), CALP supported approximately 19,620 adult learners through 37,288 learning opportunities, totaling 154,060 hours of instruction, a 30 per cent increase from the previous year. Of these learners, more than 950 self-identified as Indigenous, and more than 6,100 were newcomers to Canada. Ninety-two per cent of learners reported increased self-confidence in literacy and foundational learning as a result of their participation. Similarly, 92 per cent of learners reported applying the skills they gained through CALP, reinforcing their learning, and significantly increasing the likelihood of long-term foundational skill retention.

Meeting the substantial increase in demand for services within existing budget constraints presented significant challenges for providers, especially in larger urban centres where pressures on service delivery are most acute. The reduction to the 2024-25 Foundational Learning Assistance budget, due to federal Labour Market Transfer Agreement cuts, further increased demand on CALP with more foundational learners seeking alternative programming.

Ethnocultural Grants

In 2024-25, Advanced Education provided \$250,000 each to the Canadian Arab Friendship Association, Alberta Somali Community Centre, and Nigerian Canadian Association of Calgary, as part of a three-year grant agreement (2023 to 2026) with an overall investment of \$2.25 million. The central focus of this programming is to improve access for newcomers to employment, training, translation services, and language instruction.

Helmets to Hardhats Skilled Pathway Program

The Helmets to Hardhats Skilled Pathway Program provides military and veteran community members with services to integrate into civilian careers with a focus on opportunities in the skilled trades' unionized construction sector. Participants who complete the program are eligible to become members of a local Alberta trade union with the intent of becoming an apprentice in one of Alberta's skilled trades.

In November 2024, Advanced Education announced new grant funding of \$300,000 over two years (2024-25 and 2025-26) to Helmets to Hardhats. The 18-month pilot is projected to support 50 participants across 25 unionized organizations in Alberta. Participants are expected to enter construction safety certification and supervisory training, to equip them for job-site readiness, with 40 participants intended to enter apprenticeship programs.

Advanced Education is committed to supporting military and veteran community members to gain education and experience in the trades and pursue rewarding careers. In 2025-26, Advanced Education will provide the remaining \$150,000 of funding to Helmets to Hardhats through the grant agreement.

1.5 Ensure government's investments in student financial supports are responsive to the post-secondary education and skills needs of Albertans and the labour market.

Alberta Student Aid

Alberta Student Aid supports access to affordable post-secondary education for Albertans. It achieves this by providing financial assistance through both repayable loans and non-repayable grants, scholarships and awards. It also offers debt management programs to help student loan borrowers successfully repay their loans. The ministry also administers the Canada Student Financial Assistance Program (CSFAP) on behalf of the federal government. Advanced Education works to ensure Alberta's student loans are responsive to changes in demand driven by population changes, demographics, student enrollment trends, and the economy.

In 2024-25, Advanced Education invested approximately \$1.1 billion to help Alberta students access post-secondary education. This included approximately \$905 million in student loans to help 108,100 students, while approximately \$63 million in grants supported 18,100 students, and approximately \$101 million in scholarships and awards supported 49,200 students.

In Spring 2024, the CSFAP updated the shelter cost allowance used to determine financial need on student aid applications. The previous formula for estimating student housing costs had not been updated since 1998. The new formula uses the modified average Canada Mortgage and Housing Corporation vacant unit rental rates. For the 2024-25 academic year, Alberta aligned with CSFAP to modernize the shelter cost allowance on Alberta student aid applications to better reflect the actual rental housing costs faced by most post-secondary students.

Effective January 1, 2024, Alberta Student Aid introduced a 10 per cent cap on student aid funding growth at private career colleges. This means that only a 10 per cent annual increase in the number of students accessing Alberta Student Aid is permitted, based on the previous student aid funding year (August 1 through July 31). This cap applies specifically to students receiving financial aid, not overall enrollment.

Several new or reinstated academic progress policies were also put in place to help students apply for appropriate funding program for their academic course load, complete programs in a timely manner, avoid excessive loan debt, and prepare for the workforce. The new and reinstated policies also increase accountability, protect taxpayer dollars, maintain CSFAP alignment, and introduce safeguards and quality assurance measures to support the integrity of programs.

Alberta Student Aid

	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25
Financial Amounts			
Alberta student loans	\$1,058 million	\$1,091 million	\$905 million
Alberta student grants	\$64 million	\$89 million	\$63 million
Scholarships and Awards	\$97 million	\$100 million	\$101 million
Total student aid	\$1,219 million	\$1,280 million	\$1,069 million
Students Supported			
Alberta student loans	124,500	123,200	108,100
Alberta student grants	15,600	21,300	18,100
Scholarships and awards	47,100	48,400	49,200
Total number of students supported*	187,200	192,900	175,400

* Students who received more than one type of student aid may be counted more than once.

Post-secondary students are facing affordability pressures due to the increased cost of living, making it more difficult for some to repay student loans. To support clients who are struggling to repay, Student Aid provides the Repayment Assistance Plan which helps eligible borrowers keep their loans in good standing. According to the 2022 Student Aid survey of all Alberta student loan borrowers (latest data available), 73 per cent of student loan borrowers attending post-secondary at that time agreed they felt confident about their ability to repay their loans after study. Based on historical averages, it is expected that 90 per cent of Alberta student loans will be repaid.

Alberta Student Grant

The Alberta Student Grant (ASG) supports access to higher learning for lower-income student loan borrowers who are not eligible for the federal Canada Student Grant for Full-Time Students. The ASG supports students in one-year certificate programs, graduate studies, and apprenticeships in high-demand trades occupations in Alberta. It can be used to help a student cover the cost of tuition, fees, books or supplies and living costs. It also contributes to the achievement of Goal 5 of the Alberta 2030 strategy to improve sustainability and affordability.

There has been an increase in demand for the following programs eligible for ASG: one-year programs including Open Studies and University Transfer programs, apprenticeship education programs under the *Skilled Trades and Apprenticeship Education Act*, and graduate level programs. Due to high demand in 2024-25, an additional \$4.7 million was allocated as part of the Third Quarter Fiscal Update to address cost pressures in this program. As ASG is administered as a “demand driven” program rather than on a “first come, first served” basis, forecasting and budgeting for the program is often difficult. In 2024-25, a third-party contractor completed a review of the eligibility, forecasting methodologies and budget requirements for the ASG, and provided recommendations to support the program’s future predictability and sustainability.

Since the grant was introduced in 2020, it has helped Albertans access the education they need to build rewarding careers. Advanced Education remains committed to supporting affordability and has increased the budget for the ASG to \$59.4 million in 2025-26 to support an estimated 17,400 students.

New Beginnings Bursary

The New Beginnings Bursary is a non-repayable support for low-income students enrolled in qualified, high-demand programs in sectors that support Alberta labour market needs and industry demand. The bursary increases access to post-secondary education for those facing financial constraints. It can help pay for tuition, fees, books, supplies and living costs to make it easier for Albertans to access the specialized training they need to build successful careers and join the workforce. In October 2024, Advanced Education disbursed \$5 million to 1,000 students in qualified programs of study. The New Beginnings Bursary will continue in 2025-26, with a \$5 million budget.

Alberta Heritage Scholarship Amendment Regulation

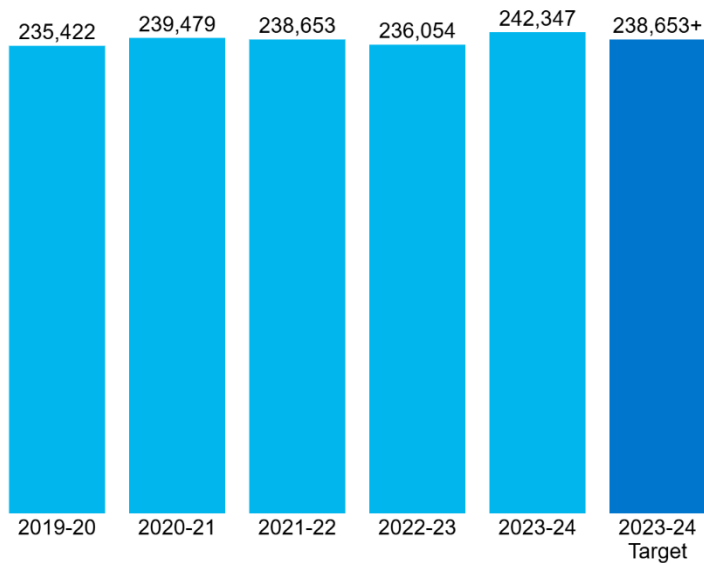
In 2024-25, the Alberta Heritage Scholarship Regulation (AHSR) was amended to ensure consistency in how the Alberta Heritage Scholarship Fund (AHSF) spending is managed. The amendment increases spending flexibility and removes the need for regular changes to the regulation to increase the spending cap, while still protecting the health of the fund. The amendment also included the addition of a clarifying definition of “program of study” that aligns with the definition in the Student Financial Assistance Regulation. The amended regulation was approved by Cabinet in February 2025 and came into effect April 1, 2025.

Scholarships drawn from the AHSF are demand driven, meaning every learner who meets the eligibility requirements receives the scholarship. Demand is generally powered by factors such as population growth, post-secondary enrolment, and eligibility changes. Growth in the fund and demand for scholarships is expected to continue. Going forward, the amendments will allow Advanced Education to spend up to 4.5 per cent of the market value of the fund for AHSF funded scholarships and awards without further regulatory amendments. In 2025-26, \$59.5 million is budgeted for Alberta Heritage Scholarships.

Performance Metrics

Performance Measure 1.a

Total domestic learners enrolled in approved programs offered by Alberta's publicly funded post-secondary institutions



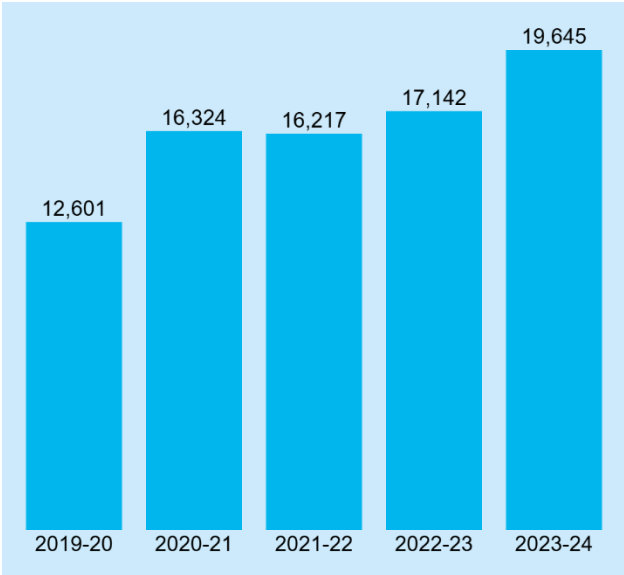
This measure shows the total number of unique domestic learners enrolled in approved programs offered by publicly funded post-secondary institutions in Alberta by academic year. Results also include apprentices enrolled in the classroom instruction portion of their apprenticeship program at a publicly funded post-secondary institution. This measure helps the department identify shifts in enrolment patterns among domestic learners attending publicly funded post-secondary institutions and monitor capacity of the post-secondary system. It also demonstrates the ministry's continued commitment to ensuring accessibility for domestic learners.

Results Analysis

In the 2023-24 academic year (latest data available), more than 242,300 unique domestic learners enrolled in approved programs at Alberta's publicly funded post-secondary institutions. This exceeded the 2022-23 total of 236,054 learners by nearly 6,300, an increase of 2.7 per cent.

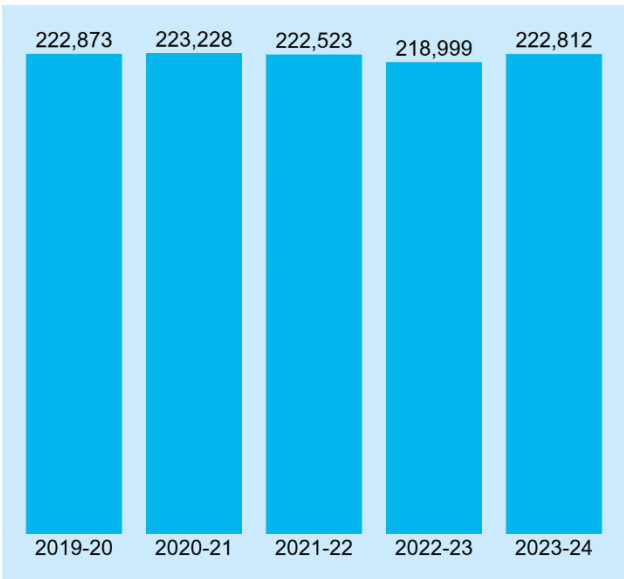
In 2023-24, the top fields of study that domestic learners enrolled in were languages, social sciences, arts, and humanities (29 per cent), followed by health sciences (18 per cent), physical, natural, and applied sciences (17 per cent), and business (13 per cent). The majority (83 per cent) of domestic learners enrolled in credential programs, including degree programs (53 per cent), diploma programs (15 per cent), and certificate programs (15 per cent). Among non-credential programs, 61 per cent of domestic learners enrolled in either open studies or university transfer programming while the remaining enrolled in other programs, such as academic upgrading, adult basic education, etc. Total domestic enrolments include apprenticeship and non-apprenticeship enrolments.

Apprenticeship Domestic Enrolment Headcount



Between 2019-20 and 2023-24, the apprenticeship enrolment headcount generally showed an upward trend (from approximately 12,600 to more than 19,600, a total increase of 56 per cent), and returned to pre-pandemic levels in 2023-24. The low level of enrolment in 2019-20 was likely attributed to the onset of the COVID-19 pandemic, when two rounds of intake for apprentice in-class learning were suspended for all relevant post-secondary institutions. The intake resumed in the following years, which likely resulted in the gradual increase in apprenticeship enrolment.

Non-Apprenticeship Domestic Enrolment Headcount



The enrolment headcount among non-apprenticeship domestic learners has remained relatively stable since 2019-20, with 2022-23 showing a 1.6 per cent decline, and then a bounce back 1.7 per cent increase in 2023-24.

The overall increase in domestic enrolment in the 2023-24 academic year could be attributed to the Targeted Enrolment Expansion program, and investments announced in *Budget 2024*. The Targeted Enrolment

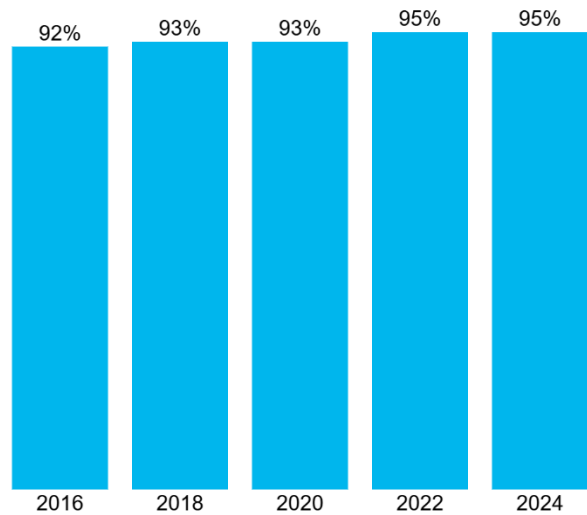
Expansion program started in 2022 and invests in new seats in high-demand programs at Alberta's post-secondary institutions. The goal of the initiative is to create more opportunities in post-secondary programs whose graduates have the skills and training that employers need in Alberta's priority economic sectors. *Budget 2024* funded enrolment growth and provided more support for students with specialized needs. It also increased support for choice in education and expanded apprenticeships. See sections on targeted enrolment expansion and mental health professions enrolment expansion for more information.

Notes

- For a more detailed breakdown of results, see Headcount Enrolment within the Alberta Post-secondary Education System. <https://open.alberta.ca/opendata/system-wide-headcount-enrolment-within-the-alberta-post-secondary-education-system>
- The sum of total apprenticeship domestic enrolment headcount plus non-apprenticeship domestic enrolment headcount may be larger than the total domestic headcount, as some learners may have been enrolled in an apprenticeship and non-apprenticeship program in the same reporting year.
- In 2022-23, some learners from Ukraine who had expedited visas were incorrectly reported with a "Permanent Resident" legal status; this over-reported, by approximately 500, the number of domestic learners in English as a Second Language programming during that year. Starting from 2023-24, these learners have been correctly reported under "other visa" and therefore included within the international learner demographic.
- In the 2022-23 Advanced Education Annual Report, apprentices were within scope of the former Ministry of Skilled Trades and Professions.

Performance Indicator 1.b

Percentage of post-secondary graduates who report being employed approximately two years after graduation (biennial survey)



This indicator describes the employment rate of recent graduates from Alberta’s publicly funded post-secondary institutions who are not enrolled as full-time students. Tracking employment rates of recent post-secondary graduates provides insights into whether Alberta’s post-secondary education is supporting graduates to achieve labour market outcomes.

Results Analysis

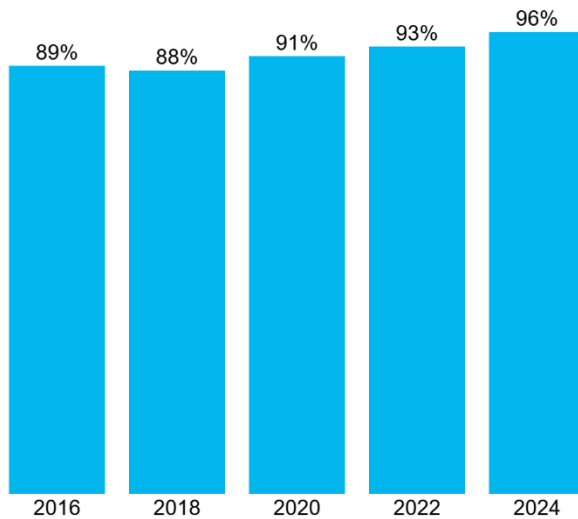
In 2024, 95 per cent of recent post-secondary graduates (Class of 2021-22) in the labour force reported that they were employed at the time of the survey. This result remains the same as the result from the 2022 survey.

In 2024, graduates from most fields of study had employment rates higher than 90 per cent. Specifically, graduates who studied education as well as health and related fields had the highest employment rate (98 per cent), whereas those who studied mathematics, computer and information sciences had the lowest employment rate (89 per cent). Employment rates also varied by credential. Graduates with a master’s degree reported the highest employment rate at 96 per cent, followed closely by those with a doctoral degree or diploma (95 per cent for both). Graduates with an applied or bachelor’s degree had an employment rate of 94 per cent, the same rate as those with a certificate.

Results for this metric may have been influenced by the economy and labour market conditions during the time when graduates were looking for work. An economic recession may result in a lower employment rate among post-secondary graduates. For example, the low result in 2016 may have been influenced by the economic downturn in that year.

Note

- For a more detailed breakdown of results, see Section 6.1 of Results of the Graduate Outcomes Survey and Employment Success Survey for Publicly-Funded Post-Secondary Institutions, Class of 2021/2022. <https://open.alberta.ca/publications/results-of-gos-and-ess-publicly-funded-post-secondary-institutions-class-of-2021-2022>

Performance Indicator 1.c**Percentage of apprenticeship graduates who report being employed (biennial survey)**

This metric describes the proportion of recent apprenticeship graduates in the labour force who are employed between five and 18 months after graduation. Alberta's apprenticeship education combines on-the-job learning through mentorship and formal classroom instruction that is usually provided at a post-secondary institution. Tracking employment rates of recent apprenticeship graduates provides insights into whether Alberta's apprenticeship education is supporting graduates to achieve labour market outcomes.

Results Analysis

In 2024, 96 per cent of recent apprenticeship graduates in the labour force reported that they were employed at the time of the survey. This result is higher than all results observed over the previous four reporting cycles, and the increases are statistically significant at a 95 per cent confidence interval. Employment rates of apprenticeship graduates are highly influenced by the economy.

Note

- For a detailed breakdown of results, see the 2024 Apprenticeship Education Survey Summary Report. <https://open.alberta.ca/publications/apprenticeship-education-survey-summary-report>

Outcome Two: Alberta's high-quality adult learning system and professional regulatory environment attract, develop, and retain a skilled and talented workforce

Key Objectives

2.1 Strengthen and streamline the professional regulatory environment to reduce timelines and barriers to registration within professional occupations to attract and retain a skilled workforce in Alberta while maintaining a high standard of quality.

Professional Governance Act

The *Professional Governance Act* (PGA) was introduced as Bill 40 in the legislative assembly on March 11, 2025, and passed third reading on May 8, 2025. The PGA will consolidate and streamline Advanced Education's professional governance legislation from nine separate acts into one, and modernize professional legislation, emphasizing good governance and consistency, while remaining responsive to the unique needs and operations of each professional regulatory organization.

In 2024-25, Advanced Education consulted with its professional regulatory organizations on the content of the proposed bill. The ministry hosted a technical briefing when the PGA was introduced, as well as follow-up question-and-answer sessions to support understanding, and to gather comments. By streamlining professional governance, the *Professional Governance Act* would hold all professional regulatory organizations to the same high standard of practice, including the requirement to protect public interest. This ensures professional regulatory organizations, and their respective regulated professionals, conduct themselves in a way that does not harm the public.

The ministry continues to meet with its professional regulatory organizations as a collective group on Bill 40 to inform the development of corresponding regulations. The ministry will also set up individual meetings with each professional regulatory organization in 2025-26 to gather feedback, and ensure the new legislation accurately reflects the unique needs of each organization and the professions they regulate. Professional regulatory organizations have expressed concern over the time and costs required to implement changes associated with the new legislation. In response, the planned proclamation date was extended to June 2026. Advanced Education developed a bylaw template for professional regulatory organizations that will be shared upon passing of the PGA. One professional regulatory organization indicated that the bylaw template represented a savings of approximately \$40,000 in staff time and legal fees. The ministry is also developing supporting documents for the code of conduct and ethics, practice standards and guidelines, as well as the complaints process.

Land Agent Licensing

A land agent is a person who negotiates for, or acquires a surface interest in, land on behalf of the person's employer, as an agent on behalf of another person, or on the person's own behalf. In Alberta, a land agent must have a licence; without an active licence, you cannot engage in the activities of a land agent, advertise, or represent yourself as a land agent, or act in a manner that leads a reasonable person to think you are a land agent.

As a regulator, land agent licensing ensures that individuals who want to perform the duties of interim or permanent land agents meet the entry-to-practice standards for the occupation, as set out in the *Land Agent Licensing Act* and the Land Agents Licensing Regulation. It also ensures that those continuing to practice maintain their continuing competence. The Land Agent Advisory Committee provides recommendations to the Minister of Advanced Education or Registrar of Land Agents on matters related to land agent licensing, including qualifications of applicants for licences, standards of conduct for land agents, and other matters requested by the Minister or the Registrar. In 2024-25, the Land Agent Licensing Office issued 58 new

licences, and renewed 306 land agent licences. The current standard processing time for licensing is 20 working days for renewals, and 30 working days for new licences. In 2024-25, the ministry surpassed the standard with an average of 8.5 working days to process a renewal, and 14 working days to process a new licence application.

In 2024-25, the Land Agent Licensing Office began engaging with land agents and post-secondary institutions on the creation of new land agent licensing examinations based on the revision of the Reference Manual for Alberta Land Agents that took place in the previous year. In 2023-24, Advanced Education also waived the requirement to complete the Registrar's Course as a condition on interim land agent licences until a new course was developed. This removed the barrier of interim land agents who were waiting to complete the course prior to applying to become permanent land agents. Advanced Education continues to seek an education option to replace the Registrar's Course.

Advanced Education is committed to maintaining program standards and compliance, while reducing unnecessary barriers in the occupation. It will continue to streamline its policies, and processes to reduce administrative burdens for licensed land agents and applicants and will work to ensure its materials and exams are reflective of current practice.

Fairness for Newcomers Office

The Fairness for Newcomers Office works with Alberta regulatory bodies to ensure that registration processes align with the *Fair Registration Practices Act*. The Act is an oversight legislation that requires Alberta regulatory bodies to carry out registration practices that are transparent, objective, impartial, and procedurally fair. The legislation also ensures qualified applicants who require a licence or certificate to practice in a regulated profession or trade in Alberta can have their credentials recognized in a timely manner to fully participate in Alberta's economy.

In June 2024, Bill 203 came into force establishing the Foreign Credential Advisory Committee, with the mandate to review legislation that governs the recognition of foreign credentials in Alberta, evaluate the process in place in other jurisdictions in Canada, and make recommendations to the Minister. The ministry has four appointed representatives on the Foreign Credential Advisory Committee and is supporting the Ministry of Immigration and Multiculturalism by delivering Fairness for Newcomers Office presentations in response to information requested by the committee, providing technical briefings regarding the *Fair Registration Practices Act*, and inviting the committee to the 2024 Promising Practices event.

Promising Practices for Alberta Regulatory Bodies

Advanced Education spent approximately \$9,900 toward the annual Promising Practices for Alberta Regulatory Bodies event held on October 2, 2024, in Edmonton, Alberta. This event included working with the Ministry of Technology and Innovation to provide information on possible uses of artificial intelligence to improve and speed up registration processes and application assessments. This was in direct response to requests received from regulators. At the event, several Alberta regulatory bodies shared how they implemented and enhanced registration practices in their organizations and continue to build on credentialing and other registration process enhancements.

Through engagements with regulatory bodies, the ministry will continue to monitor challenges and explore opportunities to streamline processes for registration in Alberta, for both internationally trained and domestic applicants.

Premier’s Summit on Fairness for Newcomers

The Premier’s Summit on Fairness for Newcomers brings together stakeholders from across Alberta to discuss actions to support newcomer success and drive economic growth. The summit held on October 16, 2024, at an approximate cost of \$111,000, with the theme “Celebrating Trades and Professions in Alberta” was attended by approximately 400 invitees. The invitation was expanded to include more diverse community organizations, immigrant-serving organizations, trade unions, post-secondary institutions, regulatory bodies, employers, trade associations, rural communities, and others.

The event consisted of three panels exploring the summit’s theme. A Newcomer Experience Panel featured newcomers sharing stories and reflections on how they built successful careers in Alberta. A Trades Union Panel provided information on supports for newcomers interested in the trades, and featured success stories. A Business Best Practices Panel featured employers and industry sharing best practices for attracting, retaining and supporting newcomers in the workplace. The summit also included networking sessions that provided participants with opportunities to increase their awareness of the various supports available from Alberta’s Polytechnic institutions, immigrant serving organizations, and the Government of Alberta.

Labour Mobility Act

The *Labour Mobility Act* and Labour Mobility Regulation came into force on April 6, 2023. The Act helps highly skilled Canadian certified professional certify easily and quickly in Alberta by streamlining documentation requirements and implementing legislated timelines for registration decisions. The Act also ensures that a certified worker currently registered in another Canadian jurisdiction can apply to an Alberta regulator that regulates the same occupation without having to meet additional education, assessment, training, or experience requirements. Alberta is also a signatory to two domestic trade agreements: the Canadian Free Trade Agreement (CFTA) between the federal government and all provinces and territories, and the New West Partnership Trade Agreement (NWPTA) between British Columbia, Alberta, Saskatchewan, and Manitoba. Alberta has labour mobility obligations under both trade agreements that the province must abide by.

Alberta’s *Labour Mobility Act* sets out legislated timelines for Alberta regulatory bodies to make registration decisions and reduces administrative burdens for applicants by prohibiting the reassessing of education, training, and/or work experience of an already certified professional seeking to register. It also limits the documentation Alberta regulatory bodies can request of labour mobility applicants. Alberta’s Labour Mobility Coordinator works with Alberta regulatory bodies to ensure compliance with legislation and represents Alberta on the Labour Mobility Working Group.

Since the introduction of the Act, the Labour Mobility Coordinator has received an increase in inquiries from already certified out-of-province workers looking to work in Alberta. The data collected through the Alberta Labour Mobility Survey provides a snapshot of labour mobility within a given year and enables the ministry to make evidence-based policy decisions. The 2022 Alberta Labour Mobility Survey Report was compiled after surveying all Alberta regulatory bodies on the number of out-of-province certified workers transferring to Alberta, and regulatory body average processing times for applications. The average processing time for certified out-of-province applicants from submission of a complete application to receiving certification/registration is seven business days, which is well within service standards. The survey results also found that 25 per cent of all new domestic applications (first-time applicants and out-of-province applicants) for all regulated occupations in Alberta were from out-of-province certified individuals transferring to Alberta.

Percentage of Out-of-Province Certified Workers Applying for Certification in Alberta

2018	2019	2020	2021	2022
21%	21%	30%	26%	25%

Domestic Trade Agreements

In 2024-25, Alberta's participation in domestic trade agreements saw continuing efforts on numerous fronts, including updating legitimate objectives, surveying Alberta's regulatory bodies, participation in the Pan-Canadian Labour Mobility Working Group, and addressing complaints from out-of-province workers seeking recognition in Alberta, or Alberta workers transferring out-of-province. Tariffs imposed by the United States have enhanced the focus on labour mobility, and expedited efforts between the federal, provincial, and territorial governments to reduce impediments for already certified Canadian workers seeking to have their credentials recognized. In a meeting on March 4, 2025, the First Ministers agreed to build on the foundational work of the Committee on Internal Trade to reduce barriers to internal trade and labour mobility across the country.

Advanced Education continued to participate in the Pan-Canadian Labour Mobility Working Group in 2024-25. The ministry presented information to the working group on digital certification developed to facilitate the recognition of non-Red Seal Certificates of Qualification for tradespersons in Alberta. The ministry also presented information on Alberta's labour mobility legislative requirements.

Advanced Education will continue to monitor Alberta regulatory body compliance with the *Labour Mobility Act* and administer the labour mobility survey to monitor trends. Alberta will continue to be a leader in labour mobility through its efforts in supporting federal, provincial, and territorial activities under the Pan-Canadian Labour Mobility Working Group, such as providing expertise and advice on implementation of service standards and exploring options to implement new tools for digital certification.

2.2 Attract qualified international students who remain in Alberta and contribute to the economy and society.

International Education Strategy

Alberta's International Education Strategy for Post-Secondary Education was approved by Cabinet in February 2020, with an ongoing annual budget of \$1.5 million for its implementation. The strategy provides strategic direction to the province's post-secondary system on international education, and creates a blueprint for attracting, retaining, and developing global talent. This helps Alberta achieve economic priorities by encouraging economic diversification, facilitating trade and investment attraction, and expanding market access for exporting Alberta goods and services. International education also allows post-secondary institutions to generate revenue by exporting education services to corporate, international, and multi-national clients.

Advanced Education worked with the Southern Alberta Institute of Technology (SAIT) to establish the Alberta Bureau for International Education (ABIE) as a board-governed, not-for-profit organization that will work in partnership with Advanced Education and post-secondary institutions to continue growing Alberta's international education sector. In October 2024, Advanced Education, SAIT, and ABIE executed a tripartite grant agreement for \$1.2 million to support ABIE's activities in 2024-25.

In March 2023, Advanced Education partnered with the University of Calgary to deliver a key action under the International Education Strategy by developing an online toolkit of resources to support post-secondary institutions in developing and administering their own study abroad programs, and to continue investing in international education programs that align with key markets. This toolkit will help build capacity in Alberta's post-secondary system, particularly at smaller and rural institutions, and support institutions in building more international learning opportunities for Alberta students. The University of Calgary expects to finalize the project in 2025.

In collaboration with EduCanada and the Government of Canada, the ministry also provided \$17,100 in 2024-25 to fund a booth at the National Association of Foreign Student Advisers (NAFSA) 2024:

Association of International Educators Conference in New Orleans, USA, to profile Alberta post-secondary institutions at the world's largest gathering of international education professionals. Advanced Education also supported Alberta post-secondary institutions in the European Association for International Education (EAIE) in Toulouse, France, in Fall 2024.

In September 2024, Minister Sawhney travelled to Ireland, Germany, and France to meet with post-secondary institutions, government leaders and industry organizations to learn from their experiences and promote Alberta as a world leader in post-secondary education, skilled trades, and research and innovation. In addition to EAIE, Minister Sawhney also attended the WorldSkills Competition in Lyon, France.

Advanced Education will continue to develop international branding and outreach activities and work closely with ABIE to further develop the organization's role within the international education sector in Alberta. The University of Calgary will also continue to work on the international learning toolkit, including engagement with employers across Alberta.

Internationally Educated Nurses

As part of government's broader strategy to build capacity in the health care system, Advanced Education is supporting internationally educated nurses to obtain a licence to practice in Alberta by creating new and expanding bridging programs. The Bursary for Internationally Educated Nurses provide funding for education costs, living expenses and certification costs to internationally educated nurses as they complete bridging training to practice as a Licensed Practical Nurse or a Registered Nurse, in exchange for a period of time spent working in rural Alberta.

In 2024-25, Advanced Education provided more than \$5 million to continue to support seat creation in new and existing bridging programs to assist internationally educated nurses with obtaining a nursing license to practice in Alberta's health care system. This funding was split with over \$2 million supporting year three of the seat expansion, and nearly \$3 million supporting year two of the program expansion. Although the grant year runs from July 2024 to June 2025, quarterly reporting from participating institutions indicates there are approximately 188 new enrolments in funded programs in 2024-25, which is 40 per cent of the combined target of about 471. There were changes to the combined seat target for 2024-25 resulting from grant funding reallocations. Results for the seat expansion will be available once the 2024-25 grant year ends, and results for the program expansion will be available after the 2025-26 grant year, with the exception of some nursing expansions funded through grant reallocations that will extend beyond these dates.

Advanced Education entered into an agreement with the Rural Health Professions Action Plan to administer the Bursary for Internationally Educated Nurses and the associated rural return in service starting January 1, 2023. From August 1, 2023, to July 31, 2024, 134 students were funded at a total cost of more than \$3.5 million, or \$26,234 per student. The current academic year began on August 1, 2024, and the final reports will be available after the end of the academic year on July 31, 2025. Since August 1, 2024, 123 students have been approved for bursary with the total amount committed totaling nearly \$3 million, or \$23,978 per student. From the bursary's inception on January 1, 2023, more than 330 students have been funded and signed return in service agreements to work in rural locations. The 2024-25 allocation for the bursary was \$7.8 million, but the actual spending is expected to be lower due to reduced uptake of bridging programs. Final expenditure reporting will not be available until after July 31, 2025.

Grant funding in the amount of \$97,967 was provided to the College of Registered Psychiatric Nurses of Alberta (CRPNA) for exploratory work on improving the registration pathway for internationally educated nurses from the United Kingdom, Nigeria, and Ireland. These three countries represent approximately 96 per cent of the applicants applying to the CRPNA. The grant project consists of two parts: the first will engage curriculum experts to create a framework identifying educational gaps in psychiatric nursing programs in the three source countries; the second will establish an online portal allowing applicants from these

countries to self-assess their educational gaps and streamline document submission prior to arrival. Reporting on the CRPNA grant funding will be provided in 2025.

Overall, Alberta has experienced an increase in the number of registered nurses licensed to practice in the province. Advanced Education will continue working with regulatory bodies in expediting registration pathways in Alberta. The ministry is also closely monitoring the progress of internationally educated nurses enrolment expansion initiatives and is working with institutions to support them in reaching their targets, or to redirect funding to other nursing/health care programs with higher student demand where needed. To date, the ministry has approved five requests to reallocate funds under the two grants and may receive more requests if low enrolment continues.

Aligning with Canada's International Student Program

Under the Government of Canada's International Student Program, post-secondary institutions must be designated to accept and enrol international students. Alberta designates learning institutions under the Alberta Designation Requirements policy, which outlines the designation process and eligibility requirements for designation in Alberta, in alignment with the Federal government's International Student Program. Publicly funded post-secondary institutions are designated by institution, and private learning institutions by specific programs. Institutions sign five-year designation agreements that require them to comply with governing legislation(s) in respect to their institution or program type, such as the *Post-secondary Learning Act* or the Private Vocational Training Regulation, and only to enroll international students in programs that are ministry-approved or accredited by a ministry-recognized, third-party, quality oversight body. Institutions must also adopt policies and put procedures in place that provide financial protection of international students, establish appropriate admission requirements, and provide services and supports to international students. Alberta established a Memorandum of Understanding with the federal government in 2014 to carry out obligations of the Alberta Designation Requirements. In December 2024, the memorandum was extended to December 31, 2026.

Advanced Education currently has 120 designated learning institutions in both public and private sectors including:

- 26 universities, colleges, and polytechnics subject to the *Post-secondary Learning Act* (PSLA),
- 59 private career colleges,
- 12 faith-based institutions,
- 10 flight training schools,
- nine language programs and schools,
- two professional schools,
- one international provider operating under a public-private partnership, and
- one other private institution.

In 2024, 53 designation agreements were set to expire and required renewal, two of these agreements were not renewed by the learning institution's choice, and the remaining 51 agreements were renewed throughout April and May 2024. The designation process ensures that all international students coming to study in Alberta have adequate support and receive a quality education and safeguards Alberta's reputation internationally.

International Students Program Changes

On January 22, 2024, Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada (IRCC) announced a national cap on international study permit applications, due to rapid increases in the number of international students arriving in certain provinces and territories, which increased pressure on visa processing systems, housing availability, health care, and other services. The cap that will be in effect from 2024 to at least 2026 is divided among

provinces and territories, and each province and territory will be responsible for distributing its allocation among its public and private designated learning institutions. This shift in federal policy required Advanced Education to focus efforts on implementing the federal cap in Alberta. As a result of the cap, which was extended in 2025, international applications declined across all post-secondary institutions. As a result of this shift, coupled with changes announced to the Post-Graduate Work Permit Program, Canada is now a less attractive destination for international students due to uncertainty in the sector. Interest in studying in Canada and its jurisdictions has also declined.

As of January 22, 2024, in addition to a Letter of Acceptance from a designated learning institution, every study permit application submitted to IRCC requires a Provincial Attestation Letter issued by the province or territories. These letters are the method by which each province and territory confirms that a study permit applicant falls within its allocation of international students, as determined by the federal government. In response, Advanced Education launched the Provincial Attestation Letter Portal in partnership with the Ministry of Technology and Innovation in April 2024. The portal provides a self-serve option for most designated learning institutions to submit requests for provincial attestation letters. The portal generates the letters based on the information provided by the institution. Through the portal, institutions can download the letters and provide them to their prospective international students to be included in their study permit applications to the federal government. In 2024-25, the portal issued 26,089 provincial attestation letters to designated learning institutions. Frequent changes to provincial attestation letter requirements made by IRCC often requires updates to the portal, which can be time sensitive as they are responding to newly announced federal requirements. Advanced Education has prioritized making the updates quickly to ensure there is no disruption for institutions, and for prospective international students who need a letter to apply for a study permit. From April 1, 2024 to July 8, 2024, Advanced Education spent a total of \$200,000 towards the development of the Provincial Attestation Letter Portal. Alberta was the first jurisdiction in Canada to have a functioning Provincial Attestation Letters system. The ministry's expedient system development and implementation worked to limit the impact to Alberta institutions caused by new federal requirements.

2.3 Increase and accelerate auto-credentialing for workers from national and international jurisdictions with similar standards, particularly for those in professions with high labour market demand.

Acceleration of Registration Processes

Advanced Education is committed to increasing and accelerating credentialling for workers from national and international jurisdictions with similar standards and is working with the Ministry of Health to develop streamlined credentialing for front-line health care workers, doctors, nurses, and paramedics.

On October 2, 2024, the Promising Practices for Alberta Regulatory Bodies event took place in Edmonton, Alberta. Several Alberta regulatory bodies also shared how they have implemented and enhanced registration practices in their organizations and continue to build on credentialling and other registration process enhancements ([see page 51 for additional details](#)).

Advanced Education will continue collaborating with the Ministries of Health, and Immigration and Multiculturalism, as well as Alberta regulatory bodies to streamline and speed up registration processes. The ministry will continue to advance credentialing efforts and support the committee by reviewing the recommendations report for registration improvements in Summer 2025, hosting the 2025 Promising Practices and Premier's Summit on Fairness for Newcomers events, and exploring limiting the use of Canadian work experience in Alberta's registration and assessment processes for regulated occupations.

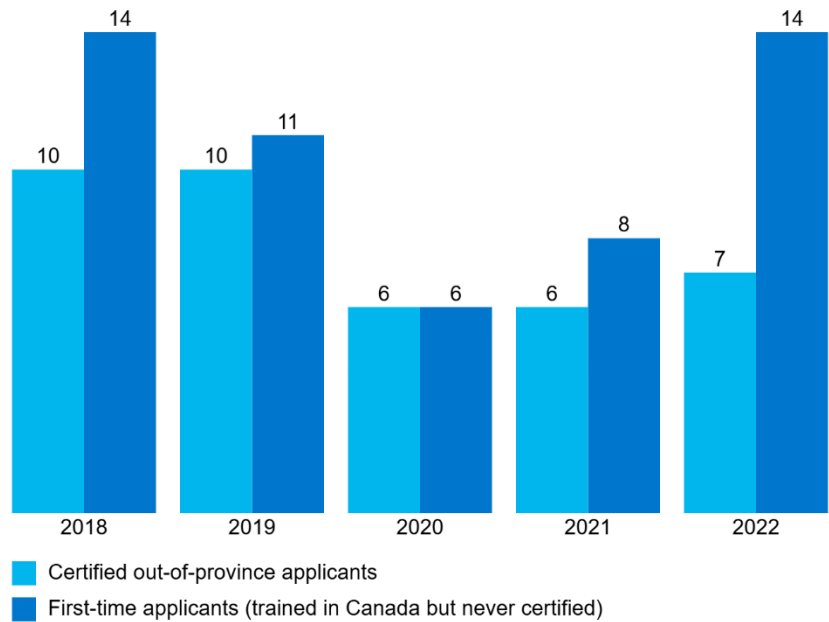
International Credential Recognition and Post-journey person Certification MOU

In 2024-25, Advanced Education shared information and research with the Province of Ontario on programs in other countries for the purposes of certificate recognition and credentialling. The objective of the International Credential Recognition and Post-journey person Certification Memorandum of Understanding is to reduce barriers for individuals coming to Canada from international destinations to work in the skilled trades in Alberta, and to support journeypersons who wish to upskill in other areas to continue their career journey. Advanced Education will continue to reach out to other countries to assess willingness and viability of reciprocal credential recognition for high demand trades. The ministry has also identified potential partners and will be working with them to initiate the recognition process. The ministry will also work closely with the Canadian Council of Directors of Apprenticeship as they roll out a similar project in July 2025.

Performance Metrics

Performance Indicator 2.a:

Average processing time (business days) for domestic applicants who apply to a regulatory body in Alberta



This metric shows the average number of business days it takes for regulatory bodies in Alberta to process applications, from an applicant submitting a complete application to receiving certification/licensure. The results are presented for two groups of applicants:

- certified out-of-province applicants: applicants who applied to obtain Alberta certification/licence based on their existing certification/licence from another province/territory in Canada, and
- first-time applicants: applicants who were trained in Canada but have never been previously certified/licensed in this occupation anywhere in Canada and are applying to Alberta for first-time certification.

Results exclude those in trades occupations as data on out-of-province trades workers is not collected by the regulatory body for trades in Alberta. Internationally trained/certified applicants, licence renewals, students, and other applicant types (e.g., interns, provisional or in-training applicants) are also excluded.

The metric speaks to the efficacy and efficiency of the certification/licensing process with the goal of ensuring out-of-province credentials are recognized in a timely manner to address the province’s labour market demand. However, processing time is heavily influenced by the volume of applications received.

Results Analysis

In 2022 (latest data available), Alberta’s regulatory bodies reported that the average processing time was seven business days for certified out-of-province applications and 14 business days for first time applications. The average processing time in 2022 increased for both groups in comparison to 2021. Specifically, it increased by one business day (about 17 per cent) for certified out-of-province applicants and increased by six business days (about 75 per cent) for first-time applicants.

Major factors that affected the amount of time it takes to process out-of-province applications include:

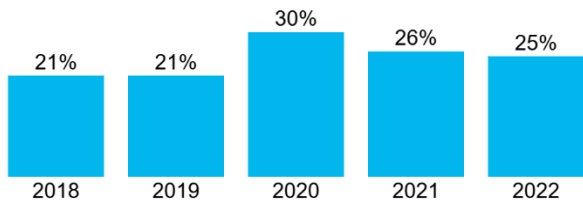
- confirmation/completion of supporting documents,
- verification of certificate/licence and standing from the home jurisdiction,
- availability of staff, volunteers, and/or committee members to process and make application decisions,
- volume of applications received for processing,
- time required to receive criminal background and vulnerable sector checks,
- confirmation of the applicant's scope of practice, and
- scheduling and marking of jurisprudence exams.

The *Labour Mobility Act* and Regulation were proclaimed and came into force on April 6, 2023, enabling highly skilled certified professional workers, in regulated occupations, from across Canada to bring their expertise to Alberta. The 2023 Alberta Labour Mobility Survey will include new questions to capture data on processing times in accordance with the timelines for registration identified in the *Labour Mobility Act*. Monitoring of these timelines will assist the Labour Mobility Office in identifying any remaining impediments to registration. Alberta's regulatory bodies are processing applications for certified out-of-province applicants and first-time applicants trained in Canada well within service standards. In 2022, application processing time for out-of-province certified workers in 18 occupations took two days or less on average.

Notes

- The 2023 results will be reported in the 2025-26 Advanced Education Annual Report.
- For more detail on the results, see Alberta Labour Mobility Survey Reports.
<https://open.alberta.ca/publications/alberta-labour-mobility-survey>

Performance Indicator 2.b:
Certified out-of-province applicants applying to a regulatory body in Alberta

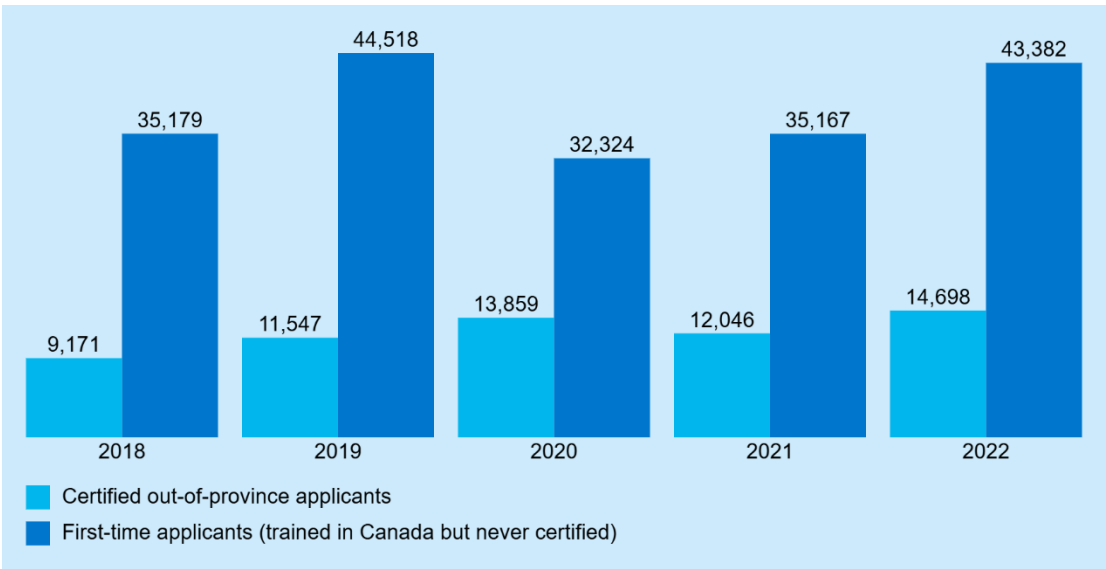


This metric (also referred to as the labour mobility rate) shows the total number of certified out-of-province applicants in regulated occupations who applied to obtain Alberta certification/licence based on their existing certification/licence from another province/territory in Canada, as a percentage of the total number of domestic applicants applying to a regulatory body in Alberta. Domestic applicants include both certified out-of-province applicants and first-time applicants who were trained in Canada but have never been previously certified/licensed in this occupation anywhere in Canada. Results exclude applicants in trades occupations, as data on out-of-province trades workers is not collected by the regulatory body for trades in Alberta. Internationally trained/certified applicants, licence renewals, students, and other types of applicants (e.g., interns, provisional or in-training applicants) are also excluded.

This metric provides insight into the proportion of certified out-of-province workers in regulated occupations applying for registration in Alberta and the composition of the labour market supply for domestic skilled workers in the province. It speaks to the ministry’s effort in improving labour mobility and recognition of out-of-province qualifications to enable highly skilled certified professional workers, in regulated occupations, from across Canada to bring their expertise to Alberta, no matter where in the country they received their certification.

Results Analysis

In 2022 (latest data available), Alberta’s regulatory bodies reported that 25 per cent of the total domestic applicants in regulated occupations were certified out-of-province applicants. This result was one percentage point lower than the result in 2021 and five percentage points lower than the result in 2020. However, it was higher than the results observed in 2018 and 2019.



The change between 2021 and 2022 represented an increase in the number of certified out-of-province applicants and an increase in the number of first-time applicants at the aggregate level. In 2022, the number of certified out-of-province applicants increased by 22 per cent from 2021 and was the highest over the last five reporting years. The number of first-time applicants increased by approximately 23 per cent from 2021, second from the peak in 2019.

The COVID-19 pandemic hindered the movement of certified workers, which might have impacted the 2020 and 2021 results. In 2022, results showed a significant increase due to the recovery from the COVID-19 pandemic.

Notes

- The 2023 results will be reported in the 2025-26 Advanced Education Annual Report.
- For more detail on the results, see Alberta Labour Mobility Survey Reports.
<https://open.alberta.ca/publications/alberta-labour-mobility-survey>

Performance Measure and Indicator Methodology

Performance Measure 1.a

Total domestic learners enrolled in approved programs offered by Alberta's publicly funded post-secondary institutions

Source

- Learner Enrolment Reporting System, Advanced Education

Total domestic enrolment (headcount) is defined as the total number of unique (unduplicated) domestic learners who are actively enrolled (either full-time or part-time) in an approved program offered by a publicly funded post-secondary institution in Alberta at any point during an academic year. Domestic learners are defined as those with the following legal status values at some point during the academic year: Canadian, permanent resident, refugee, and unknown/not reported. These are all grouped as domestic, as all learners with these legal status values would be treated as residents with regard to many matters such as loan eligibility, tuition, and fees.

Enrolment data is submitted to Advanced Education by each of the publicly funded post-secondary institutions. Data is reviewed and validated until both the department and the institution are in agreement. Apprenticeship data, related to the classroom instruction portion of the enrolment, is then added to each institutional submission. Apprenticeship data is derived from the Apprenticeship, Trade and Occupation Management System. Prior to appending this data, it is validated and confirmed as accurate.

Advanced Education completes a final review prior to sending a sign-off package to the institutions. The package is then signed off by each institution's vice president before being considered final. Enrolment data is used for reporting and publications after all institutions have finalized their submissions.

Unique counts are calculated using the Alberta Student Number (ASN), so that students attending more than one institution will be counted only once at the system level. For records without ASN values, a combination of the provider and institutional student ID is used. Total enrolment (headcount) is calculated by taking a unique count of the number of ASN values (including proxy values for records without ASNs) with active enrolment records at all institutions during the academic year.

Enrolment data includes only provincially approved programming at publicly funded post-secondary institutions in Alberta. The enrolment headcount at Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity is excluded from this metric, as it does not offer any ministry approved programming.

Performance Indicator 1.b

Percentage of post-secondary graduates who report being employed approximately two years after graduation (biennial survey)

Source

- Graduate Outcomes Survey, Advanced Education

This survey is conducted biennially with graduates approximately two years after their graduation from a publicly funded post-secondary institution in Alberta (except Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity). The 2024 survey was conducted with 2021-22 graduates. An independent consultant (CCI Research Inc.) was hired to conduct and report on the 2024 survey.

The target participants for this metric are graduates (both domestic and international) from publicly funded post-secondary institutions (credit parchment programs only) in Alberta. Apprenticeship students who completed the classroom instruction portion of their apprenticeship program at a publicly funded post-secondary institution are excluded.

A census approach was used for publicly funded post-secondary institutions with fewer than 1,500 graduates and a stratified sampling approach was used for institutions with 1,500 graduates or more. Data was collected through telephone or an online survey, based on participants' preference. Based on the sampling population of 46,385 (after removing duplicates), 15,761 surveys were completed, including 1,594 by telephone and 14,167 online. The gross response rate was 34 per cent. At the system level, the survey's margin of error was ± 0.63 per cent at the 95 per cent confidence level.

Results for this metric are determined using multiple survey questions regarding respondents' employment status, studying status, and job seeking activities. Excluded from the calculation of results are graduates who were not looking for jobs at the time of the survey, those who reported being full-time students or unsure of their student status, and those who responded, "Don't know" or "Prefer not to say." The percentage is calculated by dividing the number of respondents who reported being employed (including self-employment) by the total number of respondents who reported being in the labour force at the time of the survey.

For more detail on the methodology, see the Alberta Graduate Outcomes Survey Report for the Publicly Funded Post-secondary Institutions, Class of 2021-22. <https://open.alberta.ca/publications/results-of-gos-and-ess-publicly-funded-post-secondary-institutions-class-of-2021-2022>

Performance Indicator 1.c

Percentage of apprenticeship graduates who report being employed (biennial survey)

Source

- Apprenticeship Education Survey, Advanced Education

Results for this metric are obtained from the Apprenticeship Education Survey. This is a biennial survey conducted with first-period apprentices and recent apprenticeship graduates who are asked about their perceptions and experiences regarding various aspects of their apprenticeship program. Survey results are used to evaluate and inform apprenticeship policy, programming, and processes. An independent consultant (Advanis) was hired to conduct the survey.

The target respondents are apprenticeship graduates who completed all the requirements to become a certified journeyperson in a trade between August 1, 2022 and July 31, 2023.

The survey population provided to the contractor was extracted from the Apprenticeship, Trade and Occupation Management System. A census approach was used for apprenticeship graduates, meaning that all graduates of 2022-23 were invited to participate.

The 2024 survey was conducted both online and by telephone between October 11, 2023, and January 17, 2024 (with a break for the telephone survey during Christmas and New Year). In total, 2,364 graduates were surveyed (820 by telephone and 1,544 online), resulting in a response rate of 47 per cent. The margin of error was ± 1.5 percentage points at the 95 per cent confidence level. For the 2024 survey cycle, the graduates' response rate has rebounded to pre COVID-19 levels.

The percentage of recent apprenticeship graduates employed is determined using the survey question "Which of the following categories best describes your current employment status?" Answers provided in the survey included: "Employed," "Not employed, but looking for work," "Not employed, and not looking for work," "Don't know," and "Refused/prefer not to answer." The result is calculated by dividing the total number of respondents who answered "Employed" by the combined total of "Employed" and "Not employed, but looking for work" responses. The "Not employed, and not looking for work," "Don't know" and "Refused/prefer not to answer" responses are excluded from the calculation.

For more detail on the methodology, see the 2024 Apprenticeship Education Survey Summary Report. <https://open.alberta.ca/publications/apprenticeship-education-survey-summary-report>

Performance Indicator 2.a:**Average processing time (business days) for domestic applicants who apply to a regulatory body in Alberta**

Source

- Alberta Labour Mobility Survey, Advanced Education

This survey is conducted annually by the Ministry of Advanced Education (formerly the Ministry of Labour and Immigration) with regulatory bodies in Alberta. The 2022 survey was emailed to all regulatory bodies in Alberta, representing more than 100 regulated occupations, of which 100 per cent responded. The survey collected information related to fully certified workers for the period January 1 to December 31, 2022. Interns, provisional or in-training applicants, students, renewals, trades occupations, and internationally certified applicants are excluded.

Results for this metric are determined based on survey questions asking about the average number of business days to process complete applications for the following applicants:

- Alberta/Canada-trained first-time applicants who have never been previously certified/licensed anywhere in Canada, and
- certified out-of-province applicants who have already been certified/licensed in another province or territory in Canada and are seeking to become registered in Alberta.

The results are calculated by taking the average number of business days for first-time applicants and out-of-province applicants separately and then removing any outliers that did not fall within three standard deviations from the average. In a normal distribution, 99.7 per cent of the population falls within three standard deviations.

For more detail on the methodology, see Alberta Labour Mobility Survey Reports.

<https://open.alberta.ca/publications/alberta-labour-mobility-survey>

Performance Indicator 2.b:

Certified out-of-province applicants applying to a regulatory body in Alberta

Source

- Alberta Labour Mobility Survey, Advanced Education

This survey is conducted annually by the Ministry of Advanced Education (formerly the Ministry of Labour and Immigration) with regulatory bodies in Alberta. The 2022 survey was emailed to all regulatory bodies in Alberta, representing over 100 regulated occupations, of which 100 per cent responded. The survey collected information related to fully certified workers for the period January 1 to December 31, 2022. Interns, provisional or in-training applicants, students, renewals, trades occupations, and internationally certified applicants are excluded.

Results for this metric are determined based on survey questions asking about:

- the number of certified out-of-province applicants who applied to obtain Alberta certification/licence based on their existing certification/licence from another province/territory in Canada, and
- the number of first-time applicants who were trained in Canada but have never been previously certified/licensed in this occupation anywhere in Canada.

The results are calculated by dividing the total number of certified out-of-province applicants by the total number of domestic applicants, which include both certified out-of-province and first-time applicants applying to the regulatory body in Alberta.

For more detail on the methodology, see Alberta Labour Mobility Survey Reports.

<https://open.alberta.ca/publications/alberta-labour-mobility-survey>

Financial Information

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Reporting Entity and Method of Consolidation

The financial information is prepared in accordance with government's stated accounting policies, which are based on Canadian Public Sector Accounting Standards.

The reporting entity is the Ministry of Advanced Education, for which the Minister is accountable. The accounts of the ministry, which includes the department and the entities making up the ministry, are consolidated using the line-by-line method, except those designated as government business enterprises (GBEs).

Under this method, accounting policies of the consolidated entities are adjusted to conform to those of the government and the results of each line item in their financial statements (revenue, expense, assets, and liabilities) are included in government's results. Revenue and expense, capital, investing and financing transactions and related asset and liability balances between the consolidated entities have been eliminated.

GBEs are accounted for on a modified equity basis, with the equity being computed in accordance with the accounting standards applicable to those entities. Under the modified equity method, the accounting policies of the GBEs are not adjusted to conform to those of the government. Inter-entity revenue and expense transactions and related asset and liability balances are not eliminated.

A list of the individual entities making up the ministry are shown on the "Management's Responsibility for Reporting" statement included in this annual report.

Ministry Financial Highlights

Statement of Revenues and Expenses (unaudited)

Year Ended March 31, 2025

(in thousands)

	2025		2024	Change From	
	Budget	Actual	Actual	Budget	Actual
Revenues					
Government Transfers					
Internal Government Transfers	\$ 358,263	\$ 379,422	\$ 369,935	\$ 21,159	\$ 9,487
Federal Government Grants	686,339	666,071	654,192	(20,268)	11,879
Investment Income	416,188	599,708	495,161	183,520	104,547
Net Loss from Government Business Enterprises	—	(9,043)	(1,614)	(9,043)	(7,429)
Premiums, Fees and Licences	4,085	5,191	4,711	1,106	480
Tuition and Non-Credit Courses	1,998,965	2,058,264	1,835,513	59,299	222,751
Sales, Rentals and Services	532,958	758,559	700,361	225,601	58,198
Donations, Grants and Contributions	439,567	529,611	507,046	90,044	22,565
Other Revenue	173,312	229,857	62,724	56,545	167,133
Ministry Total	4,609,677	5,217,640	4,628,029	607,963	589,611
Inter-ministry Consolidation Adjustments	(419,343)	(441,285)	(422,708)	(21,942)	(18,577)
Adjusted Ministry Total	4,190,334	4,776,355	4,205,321	586,021	571,034
Expenses Directly Incurred					
Public Post-Secondary Institutions	6,427,356	6,654,287	6,219,504	226,931	434,783
Department					
Ministry Support Services	14,936	14,612	13,985	(324)	627
Support for Adult Learning	55,297	56,056	52,086	759	3,970
Private Career Colleges and Student Aid	393,677	351,490	430,123	(42,187)	(78,633)
Regulated Professions	1,658	2,258	2,124	600	134
Apprenticeship	57,303	63,410	43,952	6,107	19,458
Foundational Learning	139,638	98,564	122,483	(41,074)	(23,919)
Ministry Total	7,089,865	7,240,677	6,884,257	150,812	356,420
Inter-ministry Consolidation Adjustments	(87,340)	(91,485)	(101,860)	(4,145)	10,375
Adjusted Ministry Total	7,002,525	7,149,192	6,782,397	146,667	366,795
Annual Deficit	(2,480,188)	(2,023,037)	(2,256,228)	457,151	233,191
Inter-ministry Consolidation Adjustments	(332,003)	(349,800)	(320,848)	(17,797)	(28,952)
Adjusted Annual Deficit	\$ (2,812,191)	\$ (2,372,837)	\$ (2,577,076)	\$ 439,354	\$ 204,239

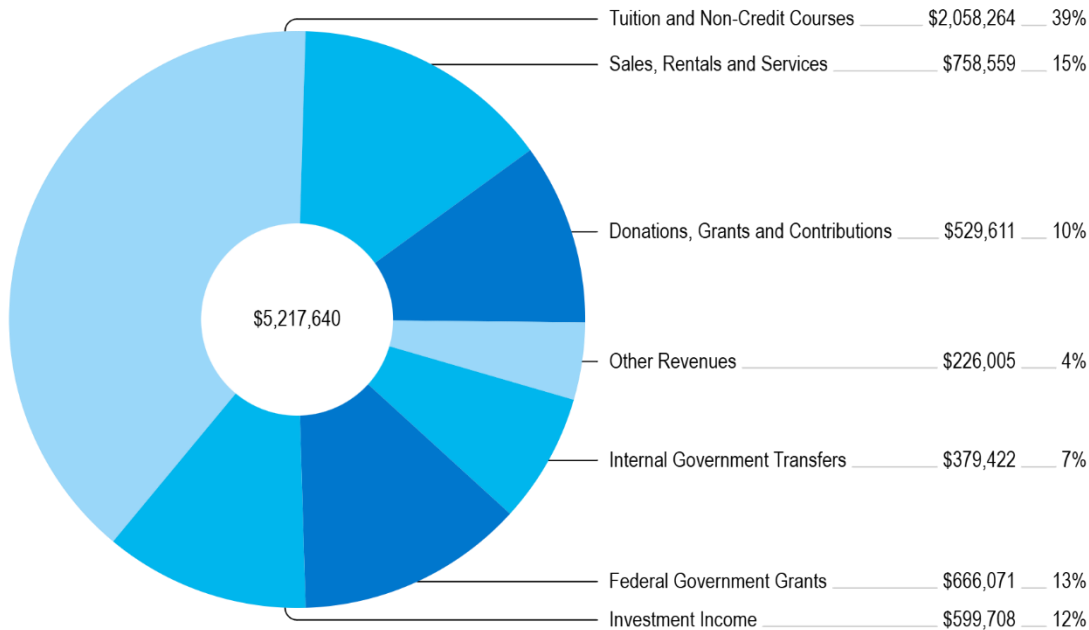
Revenue and Expense Highlights

Revenues (unaudited)

- Total revenue for the year was \$5,217 million, an increase of \$590 million or 13 per cent from the prior year and \$608 million or 13 per cent more than budget.

2025 Actual

(in thousands)



- **Tuition and Non-Credit Courses** revenue is the single largest source of revenue representing 39 per cent of total revenue. The \$223 million or 12 per cent increase from the prior year and \$59 million or 3 per cent higher than budget were primarily due to tuition rate increases and an increase in enrolment, as well as additional program offerings.
- **Sales, Rentals and Services** revenue accounts for 15 per cent of total revenue and is the second largest source of revenue. The \$58 million or 8 per cent increase from the prior year and \$226 million or 42 per cent higher than budget were primarily due to increased ancillary services revenue, clinical trial revenue and rental income driven by growth in the student and employee populations.
- **Federal Government Grants** revenue accounts for 13 per cent of total revenue, which represents the third largest source of revenue. The \$12 million or 2 per cent increase from the prior year was primarily due to the increase in restricted research funding for the Post-Secondary Institutions which was partially offset by a decrease in Labour Market Development Agreement and Workforce Development Agreement funding received from the Government of Canada compared to the prior year. Federal Government Grants revenue was \$20 million or 3 per cent less than budget primarily due to reduction in Labour Market Transfer Agreement funding received from the Government of Canada.

- **Investment Income** accounts for 12 per cent of total revenue. The \$105 million or 21 per cent increase from the prior year and \$184 million or 44 per cent more than budget were primarily due to higher Post-Secondary Institutions' realized gains on sale of investments.
- **Donations, Grants and Contributions** revenue accounts for 10 per cent of total revenue. The \$23 million or 4 per cent increase from the prior year was due to increased restricted research donations. Donations, grants and contributions was \$90 million or 20 per cent more than budget, primarily due to higher than expected donations for research.
- **Internal Government Transfers** revenue accounts for 7 per cent of total revenue. The change from prior year was relatively insignificant. Internal Government Transfers was \$21 million or 6 per cent more than budget, primarily due to higher than estimated transfers from Alberta Innovates to Post-Secondary Institutions mostly for research related activities.
- **Other Revenues** account for 4 per cent of total revenue and includes premiums, fees and licenses, net loss from Government Business Enterprises, refunds of prior year expenditures, endowment contributions and reinvested income, and other miscellaneous revenues. The \$160 million or 243 per cent increase from the prior year was primarily due to increased endowment contribution and re-invested income. Other Revenues were \$49 million or 27 per cent higher than budget, primarily due to higher than expected endowment contributions and re-invested income.

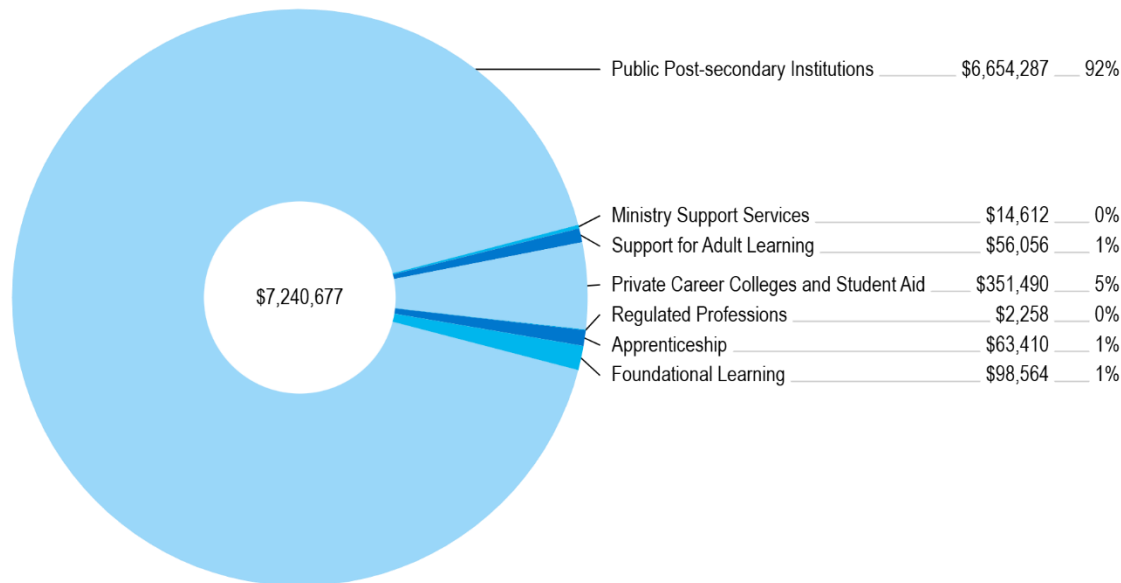
Expenses (unaudited)

- Total expenses for the year was \$7,241 million, an increase of \$356 million or 5 per cent from the prior year and \$151 million or 2 per cent more than budget.

Expenses by Program (unaudited)

2025 Actual

(in thousands)



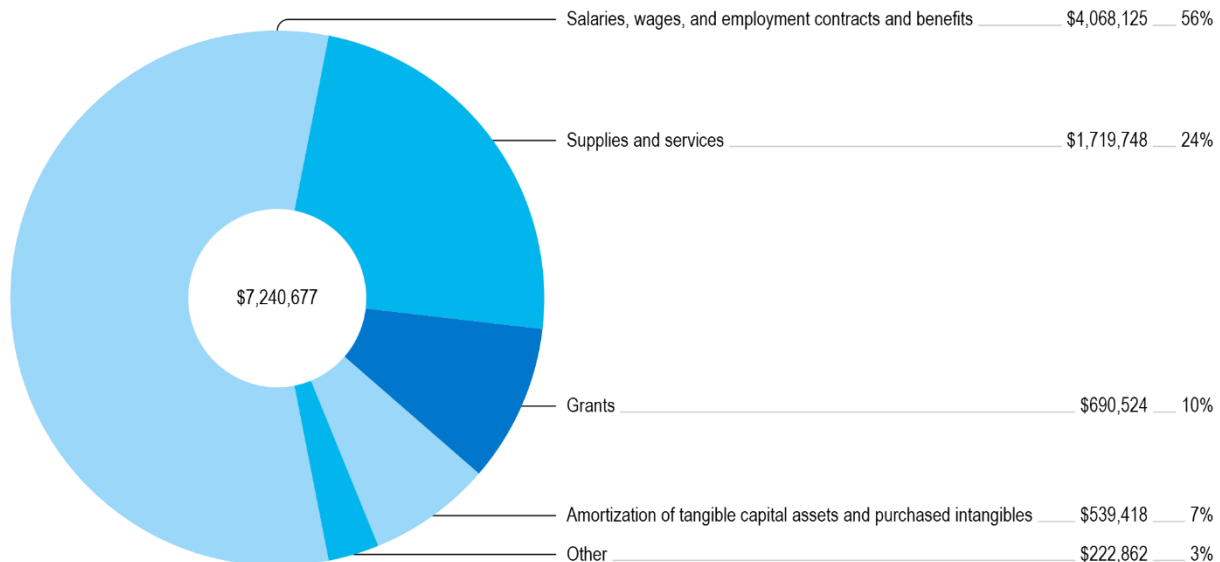
- **Public Post-Secondary Institutions** expenses account for 92 per cent of total expenses and increased by \$435 million or 7 per cent from the prior year. The increase was primarily due to higher salaries and wages, and supplies and services expenses. Public post-secondary institution expenses were \$227 million or 4 per cent more than budget, primarily due to an increase in research related expenses and program expansion costs due to enrolment growth.
- **Private Career Colleges and Student Aid** expenses represent the program delivery costs as well as grants, scholarships and awards to students enrolled in the private and public post-secondary institutions. These expenses are the second largest category of spending and account for 5 per cent of total expenses. The \$79 million or 18 per cent decrease from the prior year and \$42 million or 11 per cent less than budget were primarily due to a decrease in Student Loans Provisions expense and lower than expected utilization of scholarships and awards.
- **Foundational Learning** expenses are the third largest category of spending and account for 1 per cent of total expenses. The \$24 million or 20 per cent decrease from the prior year and \$41 million or 29 per cent less than budget were primarily due to reduced expenses in Foundational Learning Support benefits resulting from decreased funding from the Government of Canada Labour Market Transfer Agreement and a decline in demand from high school learners.

- **Apprenticeship** expenses account for 1 per cent of total expenses. The \$19 million or 44 per cent increase from the prior year and \$6 million or 11 per cent more than budget were primarily due to the early disbursement of many 2025 partnership grants.
- **Other** expenses include Ministry Support Services, Support for Adult Learning, Regulated Professions which are relatively small and the changes from the prior year and budget were not significant.

Expenses – Directly Incurred Detailed by Object (unaudited)

2025 Actual

(in thousands)



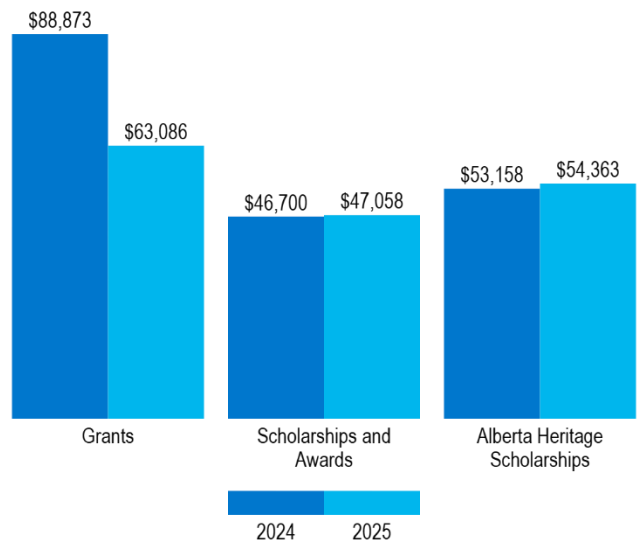
- **Salaries, wages and employee benefits** represents the single largest expense, which accounts for 56 per cent of total expenses. The \$279 million or 7 per cent increase from the prior year and \$49 million or 1 per cent more than budget were mainly due to salary increases, decreased vacant positions and an increase in the number of new positions.
- **Supplies and services** accounts for 24 per cent of total expenses. The \$148 million or 9 per cent increase from the prior year was primarily due to an increase in computing support and services, professional services including investment management fees and research activities. Supplies and services was \$300 million or 21 per cent more than budget primarily due to an increase in research related expenses and program expansion costs resulting from growth in student enrolment.
- **Grants** expense accounts for 10 per cent of total expenses. The \$9 million or 1 per cent decrease from the prior year was primarily due to decreased Student Aid grants. Grants expense was \$38 million or 5 per cent less than budget, primarily due to reduced expenses in Foundational Learning Support benefits resulting from decreased funding from the Government of Canada Labour Market Transfer Agreement and a decline in demand from high school learners.
- **Amortization of tangible capital assets and purchased intangibles** expense accounts for 7 per cent of total expenses. Changes from prior year and budget were relatively insignificant.
- **Other** expenses account for 3 per cent of total expenses and include interest on long-term debt, provision for student aid and other miscellaneous expenses. The \$75 million or 25 per cent decrease from the prior year was primarily due to a decrease in student loans

provision and pension provision. Other expenses were \$151 million or 40 per cent less than budget, primarily due to lower than expected inventory consumption and cost of goods sold.

Supplemental Financial Information

Student Aid (unaudited)

(in thousands)



There was a decrease of 29.0 per cent in the Grants mainly due to fewer eligible students resulting from an operational policy change. An increase of 0.8 per cent in Scholarship and Awards and 2.3 per cent in Alberta Heritage Scholarship respectively were mainly due to an increase in eligible students, offset by changes in award program and an increase in eligible recipients.

Loans Disbursement, Loans Receivable and Provision Expense

- Total loans disbursed were \$905,328 (2024 - \$1,091,406)
- Loans repayment was \$458,379 (2024 - \$343,679)
- Total provision expense was \$163,086 (2024 – \$220,990)

	2025	2024
Loans Receivable	\$ 5,945,142	\$ 5,547,338
Less:		
Allowance for Impaired Loans	(857,540)	(759,307)
Allowance for Loan Subsidy	(133,826)	(130,965)
Allowance for Repayment Assistance	(17,592)	(16,781)
	\$ 4,936,184	\$ 4,640,285

The department has made certain estimates for the recovery rate, the recall rate, the rehabilitation rate, the default rate, the blended student lending rate, the annual average provincial borrowing rate, the average repayment period, and the repayment assistance rate in the determination of the provision expense.

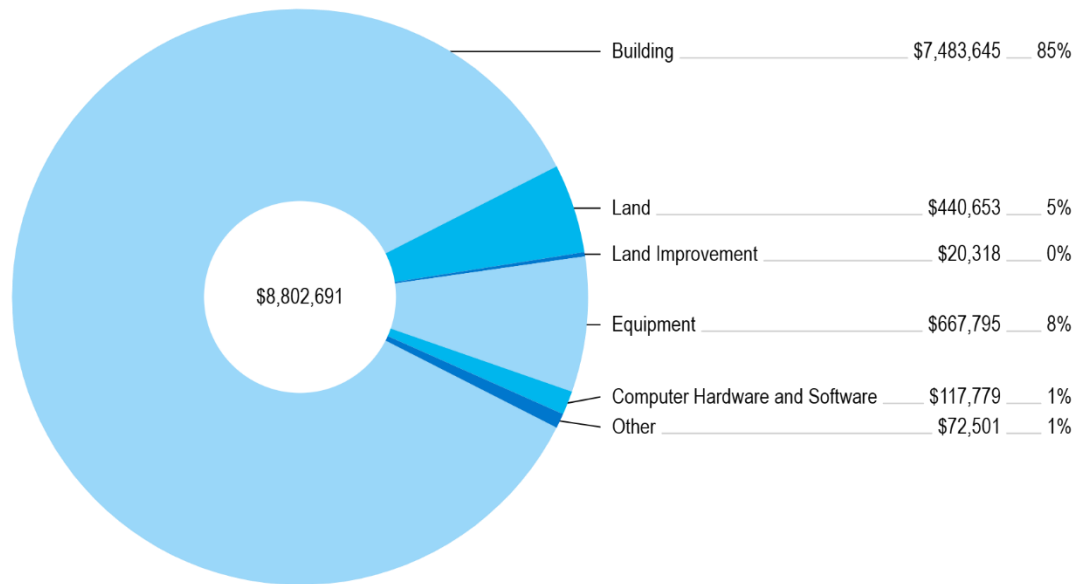
The impact of changes in estimates would affect the total student loan provision as follows:

- An increase or decrease of 0.25 per cent to the default rate would respectively increase or decrease the provision by \$13,638 (8.36 per cent).
- An increase or decrease of 0.25 per cent in the provincial borrowing rate would increase or decrease the loan subsidy provision by \$14,432 (8.85 per cent). An increase or decrease of 0.25 per cent in the student lending rate would decrease or increase the loan subsidy provision by \$10,524 (6.45 per cent).
- An increase or decrease of 1 per cent in the repayment assistance amounts or loan forgiveness rate would have a minimal impact on the calculated provision.

Tangible Capital Assets (unaudited)

Net Book Value as of March 31, 2025

(in thousands)



- Total net book value for the year was \$8,803 million, which increased slightly from the prior year.
- Buildings represent the single largest balance and account for 85 per cent of total tangible capital assets.
- Tangible capital assets of the Ministry are recognized at historical cost less accumulated amortization and are amortized on a straight-line basis over the estimated useful lives of the assets. Historical cost of total tangible capital assets was \$18,629 million and total accumulated amortization was \$9,826 million for the year.

Portfolio Investments (unaudited)

(in thousands)

	2025		2024	
	Cost	Fair Value	Cost	Fair Value
Interest-Bearing Securities				
Deposits and Short-Term Securities	\$ 401,494	\$ 402,769	\$ 441,274	\$ 442,096
Bonds and Mortgages	2,203,216	2,177,528	2,083,112	1,994,100
	2,604,710	2,580,297	2,524,386	2,436,196
Equities				
Canadian Equities	823,658	978,716	785,789	920,868
Global Developed Equities	1,985,066	2,666,799	1,894,606	2,564,296
Emerging Markets Equities	126,591	159,582	135,124	152,335
Private Equities	507,492	639,109	403,296	497,099
Hedge Funds	389,775	615,718	429,185	605,996
	3,832,582	5,059,924	3,648,000	4,740,594
Inflation Sensitive and Alternative Investments				
Real Estate	126,155	178,413	111,638	163,582
Infrastructure	73,342	94,398	—	—
Other Investments	78,925	90,260	166,473	180,790
	278,422	363,071	278,111	344,372
Total	\$ 6,715,714	\$ 8,003,292	\$ 6,450,497	\$ 7,521,162

Breakdown of Portfolio Investments

(in thousands)

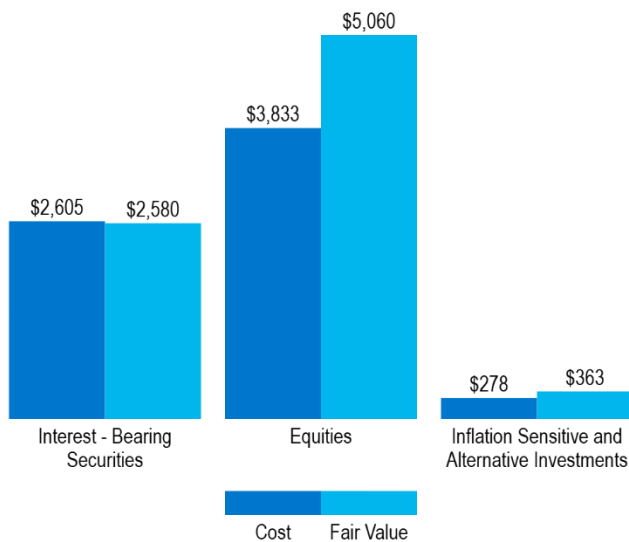
	2025		2024	
	Cost	Fair Value	Cost	Fair Value
Operating				
Internal Designated Assets ¹	\$ —	\$ —	\$ —	\$ —
Other Funds and Agencies	\$ 3,592,056	\$ 3,912,913	\$ 3,548,893	\$ 3,786,212
	3,592,056	3,912,913	3,548,893	3,786,212
Endowments	3,123,658	4,090,379	2,901,604	3,734,950
Total Portfolio Investments	\$ 6,715,714	\$ 8,003,292	\$ 6,450,497	\$ 7,521,162

¹ Internally designated assets are designated in legislation of specific purposes.

- The total portfolio investments for 2025 was \$6,716 million at cost and \$8,003 million at fair market value. Interest-bearing securities and equities are the two largest types of portfolio investments. The two combined accounts for 96 per cent of the total portfolio investments.
- Interest-bearing securities include deposits, short-term securities, bonds and mortgages. Equities include Canadian and global equities, emerging market equities, private equities and hedge funds. Inflation sensitive and alternative investments include real estate, infrastructure, and other investments.

Comparison of Cost to Fair Value as of March 31, 2025

(in thousands)



- In 2025, the fair market value of interest bearing securities was lower than cost by \$25 million or 1 per cent, while the fair market value of equities was significantly greater than cost by \$1,227 million or 32 per cent. The fair market value of inflation sensitive and alternative investment was greater than cost by \$85 million or 30 per cent.

Financial Statements of Other Reporting Entities

Summary of Subsidiaries Financial Statements (unaudited)

Comprehensive Academic and Research Universities	82
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Comprehensive Community Colleges	90
Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity	94

Comprehensive Academic and Research Universities

Summary Financial Statements (Unaudited)¹

for March 31, 2025 _____ (in thousands)

	University of Alberta	University of Calgary	University of Lethbridge	Athabasca University	2025 Totals	2024 Totals
Statement of Financial Position						
Financial Assets excluding Portfolio Investments Restricted for Endowments						
Cash and Cash Equivalents	\$ 67,400	\$ 670,249	\$ 22,467	\$ 15,134	\$ 775,250	\$ 522,635
Portfolio Investments – Non-Endowments	1,546,017	869,535	237,144	77,624	2,730,320	2,749,973
Investment in Government Business Enterprises	(504)	(22,774)	—	—	(23,278)	(14,296)
Accounts Receivable	208,585	199,982	5,119	1,773	415,459	345,467
Inventories for Resale	2,287	6,871	547	617	10,322	17,481
	1,823,785	1,723,863	265,277	95,148	3,908,073	3,621,260
Liabilities						
Accounts Payable and Accrued Liabilities	219,026	214,290	17,765	15,871	466,952	431,969
Employee Future Benefit Liabilities	169,203	57,559	25,176	5,935	257,873	311,777
Debt	336,502	137,415	4,420	—	478,337	504,594
Deferred Operating Contributions	814,495	915,924	50,457	28,313	1,809,189	1,668,391
Unspent Deferred Capital Contributions	87,243	69,334	26,170	—	182,747	191,868
Asset Retirement Obligation	187,159	76,994	5,685	—	269,838	265,844
	1,813,628	1,471,516	129,673	50,119	3,464,936	3,374,443
Net Financial Assets (Net Debt) excluding Portfolio Investments Restricted for Endowments	10,157	252,347	135,604	45,029	443,137	246,817
Portfolio Investments – Restricted for Endowments	1,912,949	1,540,467	109,910	5,268	3,568,594	3,240,186
Net Financial Assets	\$ 1,923,106	\$ 1,792,814	\$ 245,514	\$ 50,297	\$ 4,011,731	\$ 3,487,003
Non-Financial Assets						
Tangible Capital Assets	\$ 2,671,098	\$ 2,094,883	\$ 476,973	\$ 36,658	\$ 5,279,612	\$ 5,302,485
Purchased Intangibles	102,222	35,009	—	—	137,231	139,658
Inventories of Supplies	—	—	41	—	41	76
Prepaid Expenses	14,750	18,879	2,318	3,767	39,714	38,116
	2,788,070	2,148,771	479,332	40,425	5,456,598	5,480,335
Net Assets before Spent Deferred Capital Contributions	4,711,176	3,941,585	724,846	90,722	9,468,329	8,967,338
Spent Deferred Capital Contributions	1,849,192	1,428,072	378,839	24,633	3,680,736	3,672,389
Net Assets	2,861,984	2,513,513	346,007	66,089	5,787,593	5,294,949
Net Assets is comprised of:						
Accumulated Surplus	\$ 2,237,052	\$ 2,020,908	\$ 308,584	\$ 59,347	\$ 4,625,891	\$ 4,328,657
Accumulated Remeasurement Gains	624,932	492,605	37,423	6,742	1,161,702	966,292
	\$ 2,861,984	\$ 2,513,513	\$ 346,007	\$ 66,089	\$ 5,787,593	\$ 5,294,949

¹ Financial statements for these entities are prepared in accordance with Canadian Public Sector Accounting Standards. Full audited financial statements for these entities are available on their websites.

Comprehensive Academic and Research Universities (continued)

Summary Financial Statements (Unaudited)¹

for March 31, 2025 _____ (in thousands)

	University of Alberta	University of Calgary	University of Lethbridge	Athabasca University	2025 Totals	2024 Totals
Statement of Operations						
Revenue	\$ 2,098,367	\$ 1,766,994	\$ 251,219	\$ 170,416	\$ 4,286,996	\$ 4,014,838
Expenses	2,091,576	1,703,278	220,731	164,573	4,180,158	3,945,535
Endowment Contributions and Capitalized Investment Income	85,504	101,830	2,888	174	190,396	51,755
Annual Surplus	\$ 92,295	\$ 165,546	\$ 33,376	\$ 6,017	\$ 297,234	\$ 121,058
Statement of Cash Flows						
Cash and Cash Equivalents, Beginning of Year	\$ 40,127	\$ 459,451	\$ 11,120	\$ 11,937	\$ 522,635	\$ 118,430
Cash Provided by Operating Transactions	8,693	265,087	8,094	9,357	291,231	221,728
Cash Provided by (Applied to) Organizational Activities	18,580	(54,289)	3,253	(6,160)	(38,616)	182,477
Cash and Cash Equivalents, End of Year	\$ 67,400	\$ 670,249	\$ 22,467	\$ 15,134	\$ 775,250	\$ 522,635
Statement of Changes in Net Financial Assets						
Annual Surplus	\$ 92,295	\$ 165,546	\$ 33,376	\$ 6,017	\$ 297,234	\$ 121,058
Changes to Accounts Relating to Non-Financial Assets	50,098	171,605	(1,171)	6,962	227,494	291,786
Increase in Net Financial Assets in the Year	142,393	337,151	32,205	12,979	524,728	412,844
Net Financial Assets, Beginning of Year	1,780,713	1,455,663	213,309	37,318	3,487,003	3,074,159
Net Financial Assets, End of Year	\$ 1,923,106	\$ 1,792,814	\$ 245,514	\$ 50,297	\$ 4,011,731	\$ 3,487,003
Salary and Benefits of President Positions						
Base Salary	\$ 459	\$ 473	\$ 397	\$ 329		
Other Cash Benefits ²	6	107	6	28		
Non-Cash Benefits ³	194	93	220	215		
	\$ 659	\$ 673	\$ 623	\$ 572		

¹ Financial statements for these entities are prepared in accordance with Canadian Public Sector Accounting Standards. Full audited financial statements for these entities are available on their websites.

² Other Cash Benefits include vacation payouts and bonuses (where applicable).

³ Non-Cash Benefits include the employer portions of such items as pension contributions, medical and dental benefits, disability insurance, etc.

Undergraduate Universities

Summary Financial Statements (Unaudited)¹

for June 30, 2024 and March 31, 2025 (in thousands)

	Alberta University of the Arts June 30, 2024	Alberta University of the Arts June 30, 2023	MacEwan University March 31, 2025	Mount Royal University March 31, 2025	March 31, 2025 Totals	March 31, 2024 Totals
Statement of Financial Position						
Financial Assets excluding Portfolio Investments Restricted for Endowments						
Cash and Cash Equivalents	\$ 12,472	\$ 14,965	\$ 58,880	\$ 66,025	\$ 124,905	\$ 149,261
Portfolio Investments – Non-Endowments	9,542	7,992	50,111	130,862	180,973	180,268
Accounts Receivable	1,882	533	66,443	13,451	79,894	38,858
Inventories for Resale	295	275	1,341	1,077	2,418	2,580
	24,191	23,765	176,775	211,415	388,190	370,967
Liabilities						
Accounts Payable and Accrued Liabilities	3,356	3,061	48,052	40,154	88,206	75,644
Employee Future Benefit Liabilities	190	71	6,580	4,065	10,645	10,101
Debt	64	84	45,925	32,830	78,755	87,530
Deferred Operating Contributions	7,066	6,587	70,462	50,961	121,423	105,560
Unspent Deferred Capital Contributions	7,049	6,225	1,922	49,644	51,566	47,794
Environmental Liability	—	—	7,379	—	7,379	11,693
Asset Retirement Obligations	—	—	835	27,407	28,242	27,702
	17,725	16,028	181,155	205,061	386,216	366,024
Net Financial Assets (Net Debt) excluding Portfolio Investments Restricted for Endowments	6,466	7,737	(4,380)	6,354	1,974	4,943
Portfolio Investments – Restricted for Endowments	11,035	9,764	77,971	91,700	169,671	174,511
Net Financial Assets	\$ 17,501	\$ 17,501	\$ 73,591	\$ 98,054	\$ 171,645	\$ 179,454
Non-Financial Assets						
Tangible Capital Assets	\$ 12,935	\$ 11,756	\$ 448,097	\$ 336,938	\$ 785,035	\$ 733,588
Purchased Intangibles	—	—	3,170	978	4,148	3,524
Inventories of Supplies	274	287	—	57	57	58
Prepaid Expenses	560	365	7,219	3,907	11,126	10,207
	13,769	12,408	458,486	341,880	800,366	747,377
Net Assets before Spent Deferred Capital Contributions	31,270	29,909	532,077	439,934	972,011	926,831
Spent Deferred Capital Contributions	10,268	10,431	132,795	243,406	376,201	365,460
Net Assets	\$ 21,002	\$ 19,478	\$ 399,282	\$ 196,528	\$ 595,810	\$ 561,371
Net Assets is comprised of:						
Accumulated Surplus	\$ 19,447	\$ 18,474	\$ 380,504	\$ 181,378	\$ 561,882	\$ 527,783
Accumulated Remeasurement Gains	1,555	1,004	18,778	15,150	33,928	33,588
	\$ 21,002	\$ 19,478	\$ 399,282	\$ 196,528	\$ 595,810	\$ 561,371

¹ Financial statements for these entities are prepared in accordance with Canadian Public Sector Accounting Standards. Full audited financial statements for these entities are available on their websites.

Undergraduate Universities (continued)

Summary Financial Statements (Unaudited)¹

for June 30, 2024 and March 31, 2025 (in thousands)

	Alberta University of the Arts June 30, 2024	Alberta University of the Arts June 30, 2023	MacEwan University March 31, 2025	Mount Royal University March 31, 2025	March 31, 2025 Totals	March 31, 2024 Totals
Statement of Operations						
Revenue	\$ 27,222	\$ 25,808	\$ 299,005	\$ 281,355	\$ 580,360	\$ 556,361
Expenses	26,407	24,295	282,544	270,906	553,450	511,713
Endowment Contributions and Capitalized Investment Income	158	242	975	6,214	7,189	3,680
Annual Surplus	\$ 973	\$ 1,755	\$ 17,436	\$ 16,663	\$ 34,099	\$ 48,328
Statement of Cash Flows						
Cash and Cash Equivalents, Beginning of Year	\$ 14,965	\$ 16,613	\$ 87,033	\$ 62,228	\$ 149,261	\$ 108,917
Cash Provided by (Applied to) Operating Transactions	779	577	(10,608)	36,792	26,184	73,790
Cash Applied to Organizational Activities	(3,272)	(2,225)	(17,545)	(32,995)	(50,540)	(33,446)
Cash and Cash Equivalents, End of Year	\$ 12,472	\$ 14,965	\$ 58,880	\$ 66,025	\$ 124,905	\$ 149,261
Statement of Changes in Net Financial Assets (Net Debt)						
Annual Surplus	\$ 973	\$ 1,755	\$ 17,436	\$ 16,663	\$ 34,099	\$ 48,328
Changes to Accounts Relating to Non-Financial Assets	(973)	60	(40,820)	(1,088)	(41,908)	(10,677)
Increase (Decrease) in Net Financial Assets in the Year	—	1,815	(23,384)	15,575	(7,809)	37,651
Net Financial Assets, Beginning of Year	17,501	15,686	96,975	82,479	179,454	141,803
Net Financial Assets, End of Year	\$ 17,501	\$ 17,501	\$ 73,591	\$ 98,054	\$ 171,645	\$ 179,454
Salary and Benefits of President Positions						
Base Salary	\$ 241	\$ 237	\$ 324	\$ 356		
Other Cash Benefits ²	6	6	6	14		
Non-Cash Benefits ³	37	35	147	158		
	\$ 284	\$ 278	\$ 477	\$ 528		

¹ Financial statements for these entities are prepared in accordance with Canadian Public Sector Accounting Standards. Full audited financial statements for these entities are available on their websites.

² Other Cash Benefits include vacation payouts and bonuses (where applicable).

³ Non-Cash Benefits include the employer portions of such items as pension contributions, medical and dental benefits, disability insurance, etc.

Polytechnic Institutions

Summary Financial Statements (Unaudited)¹

for June 30, 2024 and March 31, 2025 _____ (in thousands)

	Lethbridge Polytechnic June 30, 2024 ²	Red Deer Polytechnic June 30, 2024	June 30, 2024 Totals	June 30, 2023 Totals
Statement of Financial Position				
Financial Assets excluding Portfolio Investments Restricted for Endowments				
Cash and Cash Equivalents	\$ 19,913	\$ 8,869	\$ 28,782	\$ 21,741
Portfolio Investments – Non-Endowments	51,988	61,617	113,605	102,538
Accounts Receivable	1,298	4,954	6,252	5,656
Inventories for Resale	576	—	576	523
	<u>73,775</u>	<u>75,440</u>	<u>149,215</u>	<u>130,458</u>
Liabilities				
Accounts Payable and Accrued Liabilities	9,721	16,851	26,572	24,816
Employee Future Benefit Liabilities	—	2,076	2,076	2,233
Debt	4,231	50,273	54,504	59,339
Deferred Operating Contributions	31,185	36,377	67,562	57,758
Unspent Deferred Capital Contributions	2,844	4,348	7,192	6,965
Asset Retirement Obligations	6,435	1,741	8,176	7,894
	<u>54,416</u>	<u>111,666</u>	<u>166,082</u>	<u>159,005</u>
Net Financial Assets (Net Debt) excluding Portfolio Investments Restricted for Endowments	<u>19,359</u>	<u>(36,226)</u>	<u>(16,867)</u>	<u>(28,547)</u>
Portfolio Investments – Restricted for Endowments	<u>16,530</u>	<u>30,358</u>	<u>46,888</u>	<u>42,971</u>
Net Financial Assets (Net Debt)	<u>\$ 35,889</u>	<u>\$ (5,868)</u>	<u>\$ 30,021</u>	<u>\$ 14,424</u>
Non-Financial Assets				
Tangible Capital Assets	\$ 120,453	\$ 164,809	\$ 285,262	\$ 292,105
Purchased Intangibles	—	68	68	—
Inventories of Supplies	6	115	121	78
Prepaid Expenses	2,293	1,549	3,842	4,271
	<u>122,752</u>	<u>166,541</u>	<u>289,293</u>	<u>296,454</u>
Net Assets before Spent Deferred Capital Contributions	<u>158,641</u>	<u>160,673</u>	<u>319,314</u>	<u>310,878</u>
Spent Deferred Capital Contributions	<u>93,881</u>	<u>93,875</u>	<u>187,756</u>	<u>192,576</u>
Net Assets	<u>64,760</u>	<u>66,798</u>	<u>131,558</u>	<u>118,302</u>
Net Assets is comprised of:				
Accumulated Surplus	\$ 60,243	\$ 67,189	\$ 127,432	\$ 119,281
Accumulated Remeasurement Gains and Losses	4,517	(391)	4,126	(979)
	<u>\$ 64,760</u>	<u>\$ 66,798</u>	<u>\$ 131,558</u>	<u>\$ 118,302</u>

¹ Financial statements for these entities are prepared in accordance with Canadian Public Sector Accounting Standards. Full audited financial statements for these entities are available on their websites.

² Lethbridge College changed name to Lethbridge Polytechnic.

Polytechnic Institutions (continued)

Summary Financial Statements (Unaudited)¹

for June 30, 2024 and March 31, 2025 _____ (in thousands)

	Northwestern Polytechnic March 31, 2025	Northern Alberta Institute of Technology March 31, 2025	Southern Alberta Institute of Technology March 31, 2025	March 31, 2025 Totals	March 31, 2024 Totals
Statement of Financial Position					
Financial Assets excluding Portfolio Investments Restricted for Endowments					
Cash and Cash Equivalents	\$ 4,774	\$ 26,974	\$ 231,619	\$ 263,367	\$ 296,648
Portfolio Investments – Non-Endowments	52,944	260,916	146,533	460,393	368,471
Investment in Government Business Enterprises	—	468	147	615	647
Accounts Receivable	4,279	19,666	20,367	44,312	28,609
Inventories for Resale	391	2,011	—	2,402	2,385
	62,388	310,035	398,666	771,089	696,760
Liabilities					
Accounts Payable and Accrued Liabilities	11,362	41,613	78,214	131,189	108,621
Employee Future Benefit Liabilities	1,080	21,789	9,440	32,309	31,995
Debt	9,733	114,350	90,627	214,710	225,215
Deferred Operating Contributions	17,834	98,669	128,727	245,230	253,357
Unspent Deferred Capital Contributions	315	4,458	22,141	26,914	32,907
Asset Retirement Obligations	4,758	8,311	22,196	35,265	34,671
	45,082	289,190	351,345	685,617	686,766
Net Financial Assets excluding Portfolio Investments Restricted for Endowments	17,306	20,845	47,321	85,472	9,994
Portfolio Investments – Restricted for Endowments	9,031	66,415	69,032	144,478	134,607
Net Financial Assets	\$ 26,337	\$ 87,260	\$ 116,353	\$ 229,950	\$ 144,601
Non-Financial Assets					
Tangible Capital Assets	\$ 83,073	\$ 541,593	\$ 689,177	\$ 1,313,843	\$ 1,227,131
Inventories of Supplies	110	—	—	110	83
Prepaid Expenses	1,480	5,217	7,947	14,644	12,796
	84,663	546,810	697,124	1,328,597	1,240,010
Net Assets before Spent Deferred Capital Contributions	111,000	634,070	813,477	1,558,547	1,384,611
Spent Deferred Capital Contributions	44,176	278,510	399,869	722,555	674,164
Net Assets	66,824	355,560	413,608	835,992	710,447
Net Assets is comprised of:					
Accumulated Surplus	\$ 67,088	\$ 355,371	\$ 408,085	\$ 830,544	\$ 706,858
Accumulated Remeasurement Gains and Losses	(264)	189	5,523	5,448	3,589
	\$ 66,824	\$ 355,560	\$ 413,608	\$ 835,992	\$ 710,447

1 Financial statements for these entities are prepared in accordance with Canadian Public Sector Accounting Standards. Full audited financial statements for these entities are available on their websites.

Polytechnic Institutions (continued)

Summary Financial Statements (Unaudited)¹

for June 30, 2024 and March 31, 2025 _____ (in thousands)

	Lethbridge Polytechnic June 30, 2024	Red Deer Polytechnic June 30, 2024	June 30, 2024 Totals	June 30, 2023 Totals
Statement of Operations				
Revenue	\$ 107,161	\$ 121,275	\$ 228,436	\$ 205,162
Expenses	103,237	118,541	221,778	202,513
Endowment Contributions and Capitalized Investment Income	150	1,342	1,492	1,539
Annual Surplus	\$ 4,074	\$ 4,076	\$ 8,150	\$ 4,188
Statement of Cash Flows				
Cash and Cash Equivalents, Beginning of Year	\$ 17,827	\$ 3,914	\$ 21,741	\$ 26,386
Cash Provided by Operating Transactions	7,384	15,545	22,929	7,450
Cash Applied to Organizational Activities	(5,298)	(10,590)	(15,888)	(12,095)
Cash and Cash Equivalents, End of Year	\$ 19,913	\$ 8,869	\$ 28,782	\$ 21,741
Statement of Changes in Net Financial Assets				
Annual Surplus	\$ 4,074	\$ 4,076	\$ 8,150	\$ 4,188
Changes to Accounts Relating to Non-Financial Assets	251	7,196	7,447	7,137
Increase (Decrease) in Net Financial Assets in the Year	4,325	11,272	15,597	11,325
Net Financial Assets (Net Debt), Beginning of Year	31,564	(17,140)	14,424	3,099
Net Financial Assets (Net Debt), End of Year	\$ 35,889	\$ (5,868)	\$ 30,021	\$ 14,424
Salary and Benefits of President Positions				
Base Salary	\$ 264	\$ 273		
Other Cash Benefits ²	21	34		
Non-Cash Benefits ³	36	47		
	\$ 321	\$ 354		

¹ Financial statements for these entities are prepared in accordance with Canadian Public Sector Accounting Standards. Full audited financial statements for these entities are available on their websites.

² Other Cash Benefits include vacation payouts and performance based payments (where applicable).

³ Non-Cash Benefits include the employer portions of such items as pension contributions, medical and dental benefits, disability insurance, etc.

Polytechnic Institutions (continued)

Summary Financial Statements (Unaudited)¹

for June 30, 2024 and March 31, 2025 (in thousands)

	Northwestern Polytechnic March 31, 2025	Northern Alberta Institute of Technology March 31, 2025	Southern Alberta Institute of Technology March 31, 2025	March 31, 2025 Totals	March 31, 2024 Totals
Statement of Operations					
Revenue	\$ 87,649	\$ 449,061	\$ 513,722	\$ 1,050,432	\$ 954,261
Expenses	77,253	391,708	465,931	934,892	876,464
Endowment Contributions and Capitalized Investment Income	1,246	2,840	4,060	8,146	4,244
Annual Surplus	\$ 11,642	\$ 60,193	\$ 51,851	\$ 123,686	\$ 82,041
Statement of Cash Flows					
Cash and Cash Equivalents, Beginning of Year	\$ 8,520	\$ 48,233	\$ 239,895	\$ 296,648	\$ 186,080
Cash Provided by Operating Transactions	9,028	77,731	50,868	137,627	183,945
Cash Applied to Organizational Activities	(12,774)	(98,990)	(59,144)	(170,908)	(73,378)
Cash and Cash Equivalents, End of Year	\$ 4,774	\$ 26,974	\$ 231,619	\$ 263,367	\$ 296,647
Statement of Changes in Net Financial Assets					
Annual Surplus	\$ 11,642	\$ 60,193	\$ 51,851	\$ 123,686	\$ 82,041
Changes to Accounts Relating to Non-Financial Assets	(11,927)	(5,049)	(21,361)	(38,337)	(44,181)
Increase (Decrease) in Net Financial Assets in the Year	(285)	55,144	30,490	85,349	37,860
Net Financial Assets, Beginning of Year	26,622	32,116	85,863	144,601	106,741
Net Financial Assets, End of Year	\$ 26,337	\$ 87,260	\$ 116,353	\$ 229,950	\$ 144,601
Salary and Benefits of President Positions					
Base Salary	\$ 245	\$ 379	\$ 378		
Other Cash Benefits ²	21	6	—		
Non-Cash Benefits ³	39	117	179		
	\$ 305	\$ 502	\$ 557		

¹ Financial statements for these entities are prepared in accordance with Canadian Public Sector Accounting Standards. Full audited financial statements for these entities are available on their websites.

² Other Cash Benefits include vacation payouts and performance based payments (where applicable).

³ Non-Cash Benefits include the employer portions of such items as pension contributions, medical and dental benefits, disability insurance, etc.

Comprehensive Community Colleges

Summary Financial Statements (Unaudited)¹

for June 30, 2024 and March 31, 2025² (in thousands)

	Bow Valley College June 30, 2024	Keyano College June 30, 2024	Medicine Hat College June 30, 2024	NorQuest College June 30, 2024	Northern Lakes College June 30, 2024	Olds College June 30, 2024
Statement of Financial Position						
Financial Assets excluding Portfolio Investments Restricted for Endowments						
Cash and Cash Equivalents	\$ 11,614	\$ 45,670	\$ 16,254	\$ 48,984	\$ 11,116	\$ 8,559
Portfolio Investments – Non-Endowments	156,279	6,134	23,165	64,905	32,944	12,802
Accounts Receivable	4,977	3,360	1,370	9,163	2,105	4,470
Inventories for Resale	—	273	315	454	—	1,925
	172,870	55,437	41,104	123,506	46,165	27,756
Liabilities						
Accounts Payable and Accrued Liabilities	13,204	12,124	3,996	20,815	4,094	7,337
Employee Future Benefit Liabilities	187	—	27	1,415	316	—
Debt	22	10,251	853	8,278	—	30,053
Deferred Operating Contributions	41,456	22,151	8,950	53,730	7,502	18,155
Unspent Deferred Capital Contributions	1,800	17,404	9,644	2,363	2,265	35
Environmental Liability	—	1,174	—	—	167	—
Asset Retirement Obligations	92	5,014	490	288	1,396	7,206
	56,761	68,118	23,960	86,889	15,740	62,786
Net Financial Assets (Net Debt) excluding Portfolio Investments Restricted for Endowments	116,109	(12,681)	17,144	36,617	30,425	(35,030)
Portfolio Investments – Restricted for Endowments	22,924	9,267	11,505	7,093	3,349	20,802
Net Financial Assets (Net Debt)	\$ 139,033	\$ (3,414)	\$ 28,649	\$ 43,710	\$ 33,774	\$ (14,228)
Non-Financial Assets						
Tangible Capital Assets	\$ 245,327	\$ 107,346	\$ 63,464	\$ 170,824	\$ 61,552	\$ 148,715
Inventories of Supplies	—	—	—	—	189	—
Prepaid Expenses	4,784	932	1,182	3,961	848	561
	250,111	108,278	64,646	174,785	62,589	149,276
Net Assets before Spent Deferred Capital Contributions	389,144	104,864	93,295	218,495	96,363	135,048
Spent Deferred Capital Contributions	183,578	44,866	39,908	143,190	47,374	94,946
Net Assets	\$ 205,566	\$ 59,998	\$ 53,387	\$ 75,305	\$ 48,989	\$ 40,102
Net Assets is comprised of:						
Accumulated Surplus	\$ 201,474	\$ 59,373	\$ 52,011	\$ 75,098	\$ 48,557	\$ 40,094
Accumulated Remeasurement Gains	4,092	625	1,376	207	432	8
	\$ 205,566	\$ 59,998	\$ 53,387	\$ 75,305	\$ 48,989	\$ 40,102

¹ Financial statements for these entities are prepared in accordance with Canadian Public Sector Accounting Standards. Full audited financial statements for these entities are available on their websites.

² NorQuest College changed their fiscal year end to March 31, 2025 to coincide with that of the Government of Alberta.

Comprehensive Community Colleges (continued)

Summary Financial Statements (Unaudited)¹

for June 30, 2024 and March 31, 2025² (in thousands)

	Portage College June 30, 2024	June 30, 2024 Totals	June 30, 2023 Totals (Restated)	Lakeland College March 31, 2025	Lakeland College March 31, 2024	NorQuest College March 31, 2025 (9 Months)
Statement of Financial Position						
Financial Assets excluding Portfolio Investments Restricted for Endowments						
Cash and Cash Equivalents	\$ 19,609	\$ 161,806	\$ 116,732	\$ 20,022	\$ 28,678	\$ 32,325
Portfolio Investments – Non-Endowments	11,833	308,062	276,899	55,773	46,705	69,349
Investment in Government Business Enterprises	—	—	22,928	—	—	—
Accounts Receivable	14,903	40,348	28,359	2,187	2,114	11,482
Inventories for Resale	208	3,175	4,391	272	272	305
	46,553	513,391	449,309	78,254	77,769	113,461
Liabilities						
Accounts Payable and Accrued Liabilities	5,287	66,857	51,560	9,528	7,710	21,477
Employee Future Benefit Liabilities	107	2,052	1,926	—	—	1,472
Debt	—	49,457	47,774	12,365	13,407	8,050
Deferred Operating Contributions	15,319	167,263	148,521	17,963	15,424	46,617
Unspent Deferred Capital Contributions	1,315	34,826	33,515	9,577	15,746	1,856
Environmental Liability	—	1,341	1,091	189	189	—
Asset Retirement Obligations	557	15,043	15,731	6,776	6,679	291
	22,585	336,839	300,118	56,398	59,155	79,763
Net Financial Assets (Net Debt) excluding Portfolio Investments Restricted for Endowments	23,968	176,552	149,191	21,856	18,614	33,698
Portfolio Investments – Restricted for Endowments	5,854	80,794	72,210	16,601	14,760	8,875
Net Financial Assets	\$ 29,822	\$ 257,346	\$ 221,401	\$ 38,457	\$ 33,374	\$ 42,573
Non-Financial Assets						
Tangible Capital Assets	\$ 43,146	\$ 840,374	\$ 823,986	\$ 152,704	\$ 144,099	\$ 179,911
Inventories of Supplies	33	222	227	3,594	2,736	—
Prepaid Expenses	1,140	13,408	11,266	1,889	1,776	4,769
	44,319	854,004	835,479	158,187	148,611	184,680
Net Assets before Spent Deferred Capital Contributions	74,141	1,111,350	1,056,880	196,644	181,985	227,253
Spent Deferred Capital Contributions	34,366	588,228	600,458	84,189	78,438	140,723
Net Assets	\$ 39,775	\$ 523,122	\$ 456,422	\$ 112,455	\$ 103,547	\$ 86,530
Net Assets is comprised of:						
Accumulated Surplus	\$ 39,677	\$ 516,284	\$ 457,627	\$ 107,777	\$ 101,009	\$ 84,556
Accumulated Remeasurement Gains and Losses	98	6,838	(1,205)	4,678	2,538	1,974
	\$ 39,775	\$ 523,122	\$ 456,422	\$ 112,455	\$ 103,547	\$ 86,530

¹ Financial statements for these entities are prepared in accordance with Canadian Public Sector Accounting Standards. Full audited financial statements for these entities are available on their websites.

² NorQuest College changed their fiscal year end to March 31, 2025 to coincide with that of the Government of Alberta.

Comprehensive Community Colleges (continued)

Summary Financial Statements (Unaudited)¹for June 30, 2024 and March 31, 2025² (in thousands)

	Bow Valley College June 30, 2024	Keyano College June 30, 2024	Medicine Hat College June 30, 2024	NorQuest College June 30, 2024	Northern Lakes College June 30, 2024	Olds College June 30, 2024
Statement of Operations						
Revenue	\$ 149,020	\$ 79,735	\$ 61,763	\$ 183,790	\$ 44,042	\$ 85,202
Expenses	144,738	71,618	58,284	170,825	40,529	77,077
Endowment Contributions and Capitalized Investment Income	1,236	43	641	1,323	55	1,212
Annual Surplus	\$ 5,518	\$ 8,160	\$ 4,120	\$ 14,288	\$ 3,568	\$ 9,337
Statement of Cash Flows						
Cash and Cash Equivalents, Beginning of Year	\$ 6,948	\$ 14,480	\$ 11,018	\$ 62,231	\$ 10,873	\$ (362)
Cash Provided by Operating Transactions	18,655	29,590	8,776	7,429	4,655	6,774
Cash Provided by (Applied to) Organizational Activities	(13,989)	1,600	(3,540)	(20,676)	(4,412)	2,147
Cash and Cash Equivalents, End of Year	\$ 11,614	\$ 45,670	\$ 16,254	\$ 48,984	\$ 11,116	\$ 8,559
Statement of Changes in Net Financial Assets						
Annual Surplus	\$ 5,518	\$ 8,160	\$ 4,120	\$ 14,288	\$ 3,568	\$ 9,337
Changes to Accounts Relating to Non-Financial Assets	3,378	(15,824)	904	(8,140)	(518)	(394)
Increase (Decrease) in Net Financial Assets in the Year	8,896	(7,664)	5,024	6,148	3,050	8,943
Net Financial Assets (Net Debt), Beginning of Year	130,137	4,250	23,625	37,562	30,724	(23,171)
Net Financial Assets (Net Debt), End of Year	\$ 139,033	\$ (3,414)	\$ 28,649	\$ 43,710	\$ 33,774	\$ (14,228)
Salary and Benefits of President Positions						
Base Salary	\$ 274	\$ 268	\$ 234	\$ 280	\$ 229	\$ 249
Other Cash Benefits ³	18	39	6	9	19	14
Non-Cash Benefits ⁴	73	21	42	55	31	34
	\$ 365	\$ 328	\$ 282	\$ 344	\$ 279	\$ 297

¹ Financial statements for these entities are prepared in accordance with Canadian Public Sector Accounting Standards. Full audited financial statements for these entities are available on their websites.

² NorQuest College changed their fiscal year end to March 31, 2025 to coincide with that of the Government of Alberta.

³ Other Cash Benefits include vacation payouts and bonuses (where applicable).

⁴ Non-Cash Benefits include the employer portions of such items as pension contributions, medical and dental benefits, disability insurance, etc.

Comprehensive Community Colleges (continued)

Summary Financial Statements (Unaudited)¹

for June 30, 2024 and March 31, 2025² (in thousands)

	Portage College June 30, 2024	June 30, 2024 Totals	June 30, 2023 Totals (Restated)	Lakeland College March 31, 2025	Lakeland College March 31, 2024	NorQuest College March 31, 2025 (9 Months)
Statement of Operations						
Revenue	\$ 53,779	\$ 657,331	\$ 559,716	\$ 82,144	\$ 76,918	\$ 144,835
Expenses	40,279	603,350	535,876	76,321	69,640	135,767
Endowment Contributions and Capitalized Investment Income	168	4,678	4,567	945	662	390
Annual Surplus	\$ 13,668	\$ 58,659	\$ 28,407	\$ 6,768	\$ 7,940	\$ 9,458
Statement of Cash Flows						
Cash and Cash Equivalents, Beginning of Year	\$ 11,544	\$ 116,732	\$ 99,123	\$ 28,678	\$ 24,090	\$ 48,984
Cash Provided by (Applied to) Operating Transactions	11,652	87,531	62,255	6,572	25,684	(1,910)
Cash Applied to Organizational Activities	(3,587)	(42,457)	(44,646)	(15,228)	(21,096)	(14,749)
Cash and Cash Equivalents, End of Year	\$ 19,609	\$ 161,806	\$ 116,732	\$ 20,022	\$ 28,678	\$ 32,325
Statement of Changes in Net Financial Assets						
Annual Surplus	\$ 13,668	\$ 58,659	\$ 28,407	\$ 6,768	\$ 7,940	\$ 9,458
Changes to Accounts Relating to Non-Financial Assets	(2,119)	(22,713)	6,168	(1,685)	(9,588)	(10,595)
Increase (Decrease) in Net Financial Assets in the Year	11,549	35,946	34,575	5,083	(1,648)	(1,137)
Net Financial Assets, Beginning of Year	18,273	221,400	186,826	33,374	35,022	43,710
Net Financial Assets, End of Year	\$ 29,822	\$ 257,346	\$ 221,401	\$ 38,457	\$ 33,374	\$ 42,573
Salary and Benefits of President Positions						
Base Salary	\$ 228			249	\$ 239	\$ 207
Other Cash Benefits ³	—			—	—	7
Non-Cash Benefits ⁴	31			13	11	69
	\$ 259			262	\$ 250	\$ 283

¹ Financial statements for these entities are prepared in accordance with Canadian Public Sector Accounting Standards. Full audited financial statements for these entities are available on their websites.

² NorQuest College changed their fiscal year end to March 31, 2025 to coincide with that of the Government of Alberta.

³ Other Cash Benefits include vacation payouts and bonuses (where applicable).

⁴ Non-Cash Benefits include the employer portions of such items as pension contributions, medical and dental benefits, disability insurance, etc.

Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity

Summary Financial Statements (Unaudited)¹

for March 31, 2025 _____ (in thousands)

Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity	
2025	2024

Statement of Financial Position

Financial Assets excluding Portfolio Investments Restricted for Endowments

Cash and Cash Equivalents	\$ 18,489	\$ 20,633
Portfolio Investments – Non-Endowments	12,756	15,294
Accounts Receivable	4,062	3,409
Inventories for Resale	270	179
	<u>35,577</u>	<u>39,515</u>

Liabilities

Accounts Payable and Accrued Liabilities	5,563	5,020
Employee Future Benefit Liabilities	1,645	1,804
Debt	11,240	11,769
Deferred Operating Contributions	27,939	28,305
Unspent Deferred Capital Contributions	5,268	9,232
Asset Retirement Obligations	4,323	4,323
	<u>55,978</u>	<u>60,453</u>

Net Debt excluding Portfolio Investments Restricted for Endowments

Portfolio Investments – Restricted for Endowments	<u>47,979</u>	<u>47,280</u>
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Net Financial Assets

Non-Financial Assets

Tangible Capital Assets	\$ 142,296	\$ 136,696
Inventories of Supplies	210	179
Prepaid Expenses	1,231	859
	<u>143,737</u>	<u>137,734</u>

Net Assets before Spent Deferred Capital Contributions

Spent Deferred Capital Contributions

Net Assets

Net Assets is comprised of:

Accumulated Surplus	\$ 62,297	\$ 60,702
	<u>\$ 62,297</u>	<u>\$ 60,702</u>

¹ Financial statements for these entities are prepared in accordance with Canadian Public Sector Accounting Standards. Full audited financial statements for these entities are available on their websites.

Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity (continued)

Summary Financial Statements (Unaudited)¹

for March 31, 2025 _____ (in thousands)

	Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity	
	2025	2024
Statement of Operations		
Revenue	\$ 61,700	\$ 54,849
Expenses	60,802	53,304
Endowment Contributions and Capitalized Investment income	697	739
Annual Surplus	<u>\$ 1,595</u>	<u>\$ 2,284</u>
Statement of Cash Flows		
Cash and Cash Equivalents, Beginning of Year	\$ 20,633	\$ 11,977
Cash Provided by Operating Transactions	1,851	3,488
Cash Provided by (Applied to) Organizational Activities	(3,995)	4,468
Cash and Cash Equivalents, End of Year	<u>\$ 18,489</u>	<u>\$ 20,633</u>
Statement of Changes in Net Financial Assets		
Annual Surplus	\$ 1,595	\$ 2,284
Changes to Accounts Relating to Non-Financial Assets	(359)	783
Increase in Net Financial Assets in the Year	<u>1,236</u>	<u>3,067</u>
Net Financial Assets, Beginning of Year	<u>26,342</u>	<u>23,275</u>
Net Financial Assets, End of Year	<u>\$ 27,578</u>	<u>\$ 26,342</u>
Salary and Benefits Expenses of Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity		
Salaries, Wages and Non-Pension Benefits	\$ 31,365	\$ 28,099
Pension Benefits	2,226	1,290
	<u>\$ 33,591</u>	<u>\$ 29,389</u>

¹ Financial statements for these entities are prepared in accordance with Canadian Public Sector Accounting Standards. Full audited financial statements for these entities are available on their websites.

Other Financial Information

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Statement of Credit or Recovery (unaudited)

Department of Advanced Education

Year Ended March 31, 2025

(in thousands)

	Authorized Spending	Actual Revenue Recognized	Unearned Revenue/ Deferred Contributions	Total Amount Received/ Receivable	(Shortfall)/ Excess
Expense Amounts					
French Language Program ⁽¹⁾	\$ 5,911	\$ 7,570	\$ —	\$ 7,570	\$ 1,659
Canada Student Loan Administration ⁽²⁾	9,013	9,020	—	9,020	7
Red Seal Secretariat ⁽³⁾	454	436	—	436	(18)
NAP Gender-Based Violence	—	1,050	—	1,050	1,050
	<u>\$ 15,378</u>	<u>\$ 18,076</u>	<u>\$ —</u>	<u>\$ 18,076</u>	<u>\$ 2,698</u>
Capital Investments Amounts					
French Language Program	\$ 775	\$ 1,075	\$ —	\$ 1,075	\$ 300
	<u>\$ 775</u>	<u>\$ 1,075</u>	<u>\$ —</u>	<u>\$ 1,075</u>	<u>\$ 300</u>

(1) Funding is received from the federal government to support French minority language and second language education programs. Program 2.2

(2) Funding is received from the federal government to administer Canada student loans and grants to Alberta students on a cost-recovery basis. Program 3.1

(3) Funding from the federal government for the Red Seal Secretariat functions. The Red Seal Program helps to develop a highly qualified, productive, and mobile skilled trades workforce by developing high-quality Red Seal products, including Red Seal occupational standards and interprovincial examinations for Red Seal trades in collaboration with industry. Program 5.1

Statement of Remissions, Compromises and Write-offs
(unaudited)

Department of Advanced Education

Year Ended March 31, 2025

(in thousands)

The following statement has been prepared pursuant to Section 23 of the *Financial Administration Act*. This statement includes all remissions, compromises and write-offs made or approved during the fiscal period.

Compromises under Section 22 of the <i>Financial Administration Act</i>	\$ 76
Write-offs:	
Implemented Guarantees, Indemnities, Loans and Advances – Section 20 of the <i>Student Financial Assistance Act</i>	38,946
Income Support	864
	<u>39,810</u>
Total remissions, compromises and write-offs	<u>\$ 39,887</u>

Write-offs consists of all debts such as Statute Barred, Bankruptcies, Deceased and Severely Handicapped.

Statement of Guarantees and Indemnities given by the Crown and Provincial Corporations (unaudited)

Department of Advanced Education

Year Ended March 31, 2025

(in thousands)

The following has been prepared pursuant to Section 75 of the *Financial Administration Act*. The statement summarizes the amounts of all guarantees given by the Crown through the Ministry of Advanced Education under the *Student Loan Act* for the year ended March 31, 2025, the amounts paid to financial institutions as a result of the guaranteed loan program, and the amounts recovered on debts owing as a result of payments under guarantees.

	Amount of Guarantee	Payments	Recoveries
Crown Guarantees	\$ —	\$ —	\$ 5

Lapse / Encumbrance (unaudited)

Department of Advanced Education

Year Ended March 31, 2025

(in thousands)

	Restated Voted Estimate ⁽¹⁾	Supplementary Estimate ⁽²⁾	Adjustments ⁽³⁾	Adjusted Voted Estimate	Voted Actuals ⁽⁴⁾	Over Expended (Unexpended)
Operating Expense Vote by Program						
Ministry Support Services						
1.1 Minister's Office	\$ 845	\$ —	\$ —	\$ 845	\$ 852	\$ 7
1.2 Deputy Minister's Office	654	—	—	654	486	(168)
1.3 Strategic and Corporate Services	12,832	—	—	12,832	13,229	397
	14,331	—	—	14,331	14,567	236
Support for Adult Learning						
2.1 Adult Learning Program Delivery Support	10,074	—	—	10,074	10,196	122
2.2 Operating Support for Post-Secondary Institutions	2,010,152	—	1,209	2,011,361	2,012,110	749
2.3 Indigenous Education	6,640	—	—	6,640	6,559	(81)
2.4 Adult Learning System Initiatives	16,613	—	(200)	16,413	12,866	(3,547)
	2,043,479	—	1,009	2,044,488	2,041,731	(2,757)
Private Career Colleges and Student Aid						
3.1 Private Career Colleges and Student Aid Program Delivery Services	40,674	—	—	40,674	49,969	9,295
3.2 Student Aid Grants	68,954	—	—	68,954	63,086	(5,868)
3.3 Scholarships and Awards	53,754	—	—	53,754	47,058	(6,696)
	163,382	—	—	163,382	160,113	(3,269)
Regulated Professions						
4.1 Professional Governance	1,041	—	—	1,041	1,710	669
4.2 Labour Mobility	127	—	—	127	134	7
4.3 Fairness for Newcomers Office	490	—	—	490	468	(22)
	1,658	—	—	1,658	2,312	654
Apprenticeship						
5.1 Apprenticeship Program Delivery Support	31,980	—	—	31,980	24,297	(7,683)
5.2 Apprenticeship Grants	85,393	—	—	85,393	93,304	7,911
5.3 Adult Learning Initiatives	17,884	—	—	17,884	32,853	14,969
	135,257	—	—	135,257	150,454	15,197
Foundational Learning Support						
6.1 Foundational Learning Delivery Support	3,487	—	—	3,487	3,979	492
6.2 Foundational Learning Assistance Grants	116,920	—	—	116,920	75,602	(41,318)
6.3 Community Adult Learning Programs	21,114	—	—	21,114	21,114	—
	141,521	—	—	141,521	100,695	(40,826)
Capital Payments to Related Parties						
Post-secondary Infrastructure						
7.1 Capital Expansion and Upgrading	116,718	—	600	117,318	111,510	(5,808)
7.2 Capital Maintenance and Renewal	133,129	—	—	133,129	133,129	—
	249,847	—	600	250,447	244,639	(5,808)
Total	2,749,475	—	1,609	2,751,084	2,714,511	(36,573)
Credit or Recovery Shortfall	—	—	—	—	—	—
Lapse	\$ 2,749,475	\$ —	\$ 1,609	\$ 2,751,084	\$ 2,714,511	\$ (36,573)
						\$ (36,573)

Lapse / Encumbrance (unaudited) (continued)

Department of Advanced Education

Year Ended March 31, 2025

(in thousands)

	Restated Voted Estimate ⁽¹⁾	Supplementary Estimate ⁽²⁾	Adjustments ⁽³⁾	Adjusted Voted Estimate	Voted Actuals ⁽⁴⁾	Over Expended (Unexpended)
Capital Investment Vote by Program						
Department Capital Acquisitions						
1.3 Strategic and Corporate Services	\$ 25	\$ —	\$ —	\$ 25	\$ 9	\$ (16)
2.1 Adult Learning Program Delivery Support	—	—	200	200	199	(1)
5.1 Apprenticeship Delivery Support	25	—	—	25	5	(20)
Total	50	—	200	250	213	(37)
Credit or Recovery Shortfall	—	—	—	—	—	—
	\$ 50	\$ —	\$ 200	\$ 250	\$ 213	\$ (37)
Lapse						\$ (37)
Financial Transactions Vote by Program						
3.4 Student Loan Disbursements	\$ 1,240,200	\$ —	\$ —	\$ 1,240,200	\$ 905,328	\$ (334,872)
Total	1,240,200	—	—	1,240,200	905,328	(334,872)
Credit or Recovery Shortfall	—	—	—	—	—	—
	\$ 1,240,200	\$ —	\$ —	\$ 1,240,200	\$ 905,328	\$ (334,872)
Lapse						\$ (334,872)

(1) As per "Expense Vote by Program", "Capital Investment Vote by Program" and "Financial Transaction Vote by Program".

(2) Per the Supplementary Supply Estimates approved on date of Royal Assent of the Appropriations Acts.

(3) Adjustments include encumbrances, capital carry over amounts, transfers between votes and credit or recovery increases approved by Treasury Board and credit or recovery shortfalls. An encumbrance is incurred when, on a vote-by-vote basis, the total of actual disbursements in the prior year exceed the total adjusted estimate. All calculated encumbrances from the prior year are reflected as an adjustment to reduce the corresponding voted estimate in the current year.

(4) Actuals exclude non-voted amounts as no cash disbursement is required (non-cash amounts), or because the Legislative Assembly has already provided the funding authority pursuant to a statute other than an appropriation act. Non-cash amounts (such as amortization, accretion, valuation adjustments, and other provisions) are excluded as these amounts do not require any expenditure or payment of public money. Year-end expense accruals and payables which will immediately require a cash outlay (payment of public money) to settle or otherwise extinguish the liabilities are included in Actuals.

Funding to Post-Secondary Institutions (unaudited)

(in thousands)

		Operating Grants ⁽¹⁾		Grants for Infrastructure	
		2025	2024	2025	2024
Post-Secondary Institutions					
Comprehensive Academic and Research Universities	Athabasca University	\$ 42,491	\$ 42,529	\$ 1,793	\$ 1,793
	University of Alberta	513,060	494,198	42,989	43,161
	University of Calgary	451,228	428,673	60,466	55,747
	University of Lethbridge	93,357	93,701	8,240	8,540
Undergraduate Universities	Alberta University of the Arts	14,570	14,793	658	3,586
	MacEwan University	110,587	109,897	14,297	9,523
	Mount Royal University	99,503	98,086	16,026	21,626
Polytechnical Institutions	Lethbridge Polytechnic	45,631	44,989	3,187	2,029
	Northern Alberta Institute of Technology	176,271	164,326	12,163	7,440
	Northwestern Polytechnic	44,236	41,878	14,541	5,435
	Red Deer Polytechnic	51,864	48,568	4,668	2,805
	Southern Alberta Institute of Technology	164,847	156,654	27,404	25,365
Comprehensive Community Colleges	Bow Valley College	45,757	44,777	987	—
	Keyano College	34,811	33,617	5,193	9,784
	Lakeland College	34,935	33,552	2,456	15,957
	Medicine Hat College	34,566	34,148	4,498	3,580
	NorQuest College	46,722	47,670	1,142	1,142
	Northern Lakes College	28,581	28,394	1,450	3,567
	Olds College	28,689	27,402	15,314	2,456
	Portage College	23,520	22,638	2,240	2,270
Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity	Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity	16,161	17,040	4,927	2,537
Total Public Post-Secondary Institutions		2,101,387	2,027,530	244,640	228,343
Independent Academic Institutions	Ambrose University College	3,282	3,340	—	—
	Burman University	3,808	3,578	—	—
	Concordia University of Edmonton	15,088	14,975	—	—
	St. Mary's University College	4,554	4,026	—	—
	The King's University College	5,208	5,215	—	—
Other Colleges		5,840	5,750	—	—
Total Funding Provided to Post-Secondary Institutions		\$ 2,139,168	\$ 2,064,414	\$ 244,640	\$ 228,343

(1) Include funding to these entities from all department programs.

Annual Report Extracts and Other Statutory Reports

Public Interest Disclosure (Whistleblower Protection) Act

Chief officer's annual report

- 32 (1) Every chief officer must prepare a report annually on all disclosures that have been made to the designated officer of the department, public entity or office of the Legislature for which the chief officer is responsible.
- (2) The report under subsection (1) must include the following information:
- (a) the number of disclosures received by the designated officer, the number of disclosures acted on and the number of disclosures not acted on by the designated officer;
 - (b) the number of investigations commenced by the designated officer as a result of disclosures;
 - (c) in the case of an investigation that results in a finding of wrongdoing, a description of the wrongdoing and
 - (i) any recommendations made or corrective measures taken in relation to the wrongdoing, and
 - (ii) if the department, public entity or office to which the recommendations relate has not taken corrective measures in relation to the wrongdoing, the reasons provided.
- (3) The report under subsection (1) must be included in the annual report of the department, public entity or office of the Legislature if the annual report is made publicly available, and if the annual report is not made publicly available, the chief officer must make the report under subsection (1) available to the public on request.

Summary of inquiries, disclosures, investigations, and reports made under the *Public Interest Disclosure (Whistleblower Protection) Act* for the Department of Advanced Education during 2024-25.

There were no disclosures of wrongdoing for the Department of Advanced Education between April 1, 2024 and March 31, 2025.

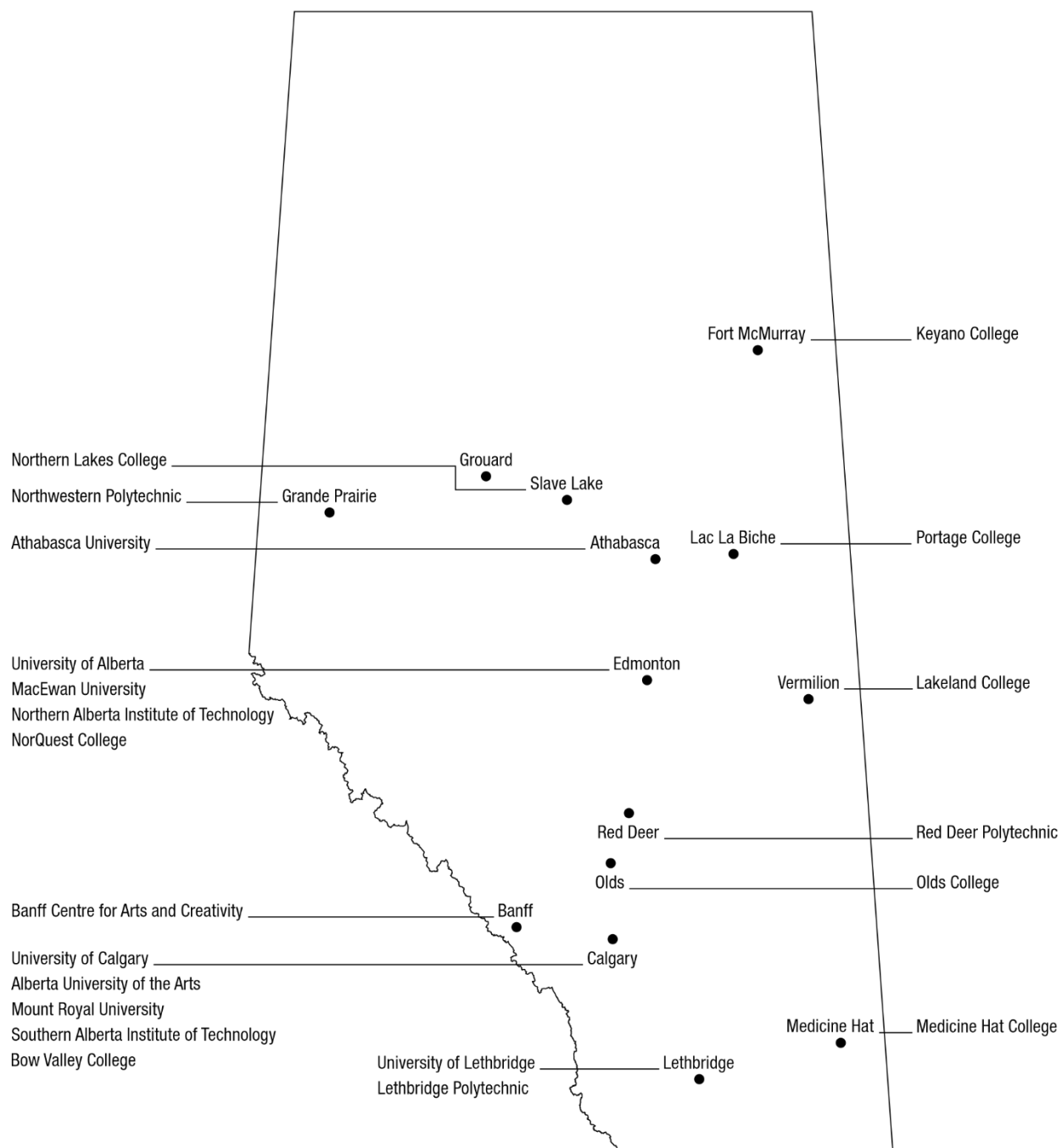
The department's agencies make whistleblower disclosures in their own annual reports. Full information for these agencies are available on their websites.

Appendix

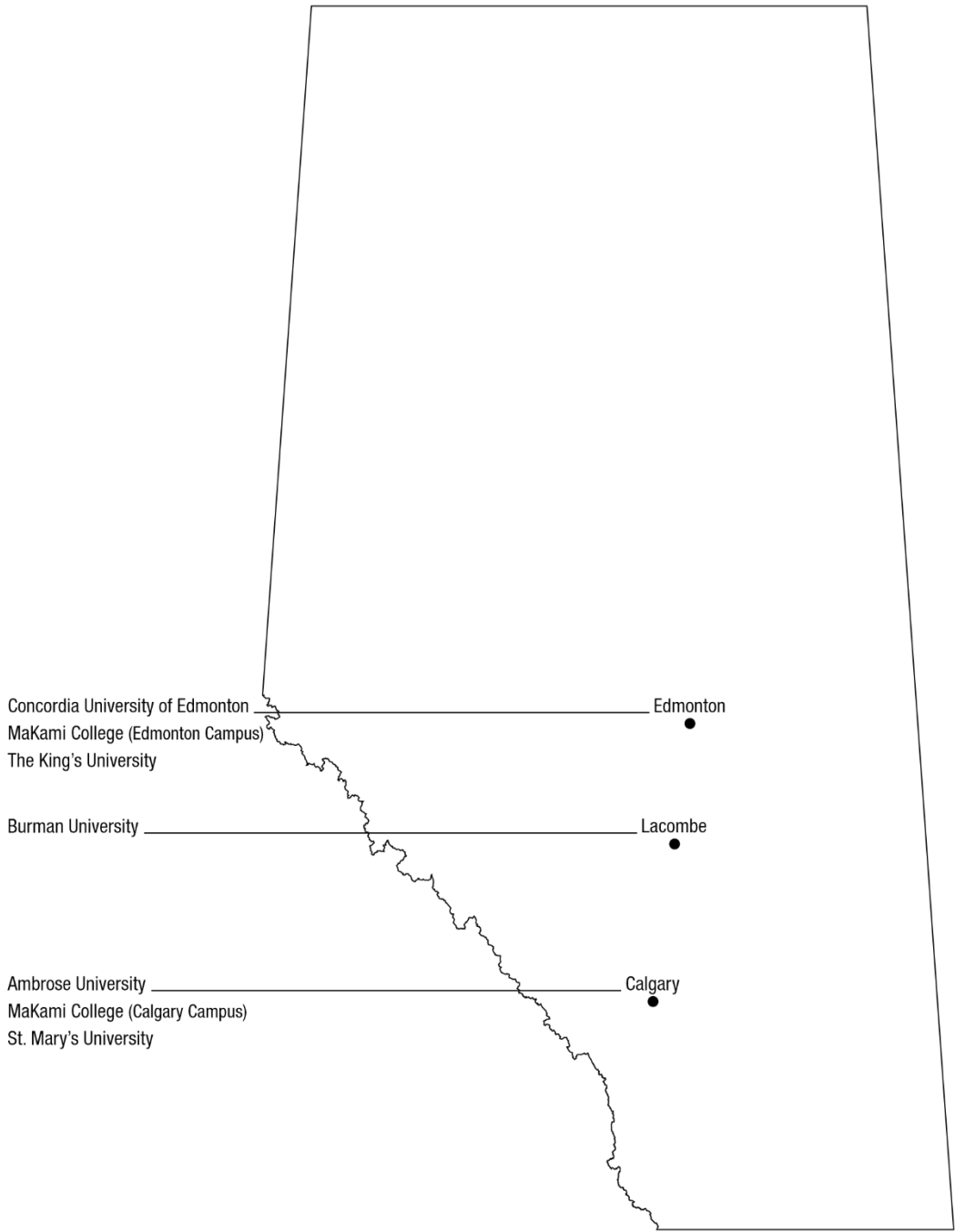
Post-Secondary Institutions by Institution Type

Institution Type	Post-secondary Institutions
Comprehensive Academic and Research Universities These universities provide undergraduate and graduate degrees and undertake comprehensive research activities. While instruction remains the core business, research activity is primarily conducted in this sector.	Athabasca University University of Alberta University of Calgary University of Lethbridge
Undergraduate Universities These universities provide undergraduate programming and offer certificate, diploma, applied degree, and baccalaureate degree programs in specified areas.	Alberta University of the Arts MacEwan University Mount Royal University
Polytechnic Institutions These institutes provide apprenticeship, certificate, and diploma programs geared predominantly to technical careers, and some applied and baccalaureate degrees in specified areas (limited to undergraduate programs).	Lethbridge Polytechnic Northern Alberta Institute of Technology Northwestern Polytechnic Red Deer Polytechnic Southern Alberta Institute of Technology
Comprehensive Community Colleges These colleges provide a broad range of programming including apprenticeship, certificate, diploma, foundational learning, and upgrading. They also provide university transfer (years one and two) and applied degrees. Baccalaureate degrees are provided, when feasible, primarily in collaboration with a degree-granting institution.	Bow Valley College Keyano College Lakeland College Medicine Hat College NorQuest College Northern Lakes College Olds College Portage College
Independent Academic Institutions These universities primarily provide liberal arts, science, and education baccalaureate programs.	Ambrose University Burman University Concordia University of Edmonton MaKami College St. Mary's University The King's University
Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity This institution concentrates on the fine arts, cultural programming, and professional development.	Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity
First Nations Colleges First Nations Colleges (FNCs) are institutions that provide programs and courses that are characterized by teachings and research grounded in Indigenous worldviews. FNCs are mandated, owned, and governed by the First Nations they serve, and serve as centres of post-secondary education for Indigenous students, communities, and Nations. FNCs provide essential physical access points to post-secondary education and training for those in urban centres as well as Indigenous rural and remote communities. Additionally, FNCs are post-secondary leaders in providing culturally-responsive post-secondary education programs and student supports.	Maskwacis Cultural College Red Crow Community College Old Sun Community College University nuhelot'ine thaiyots'i nistameyimâkanak Blue Quills Yellowhead Tribal College

Map of Public Post-Secondary Institutions



Map of Independent Academic Institutions



Map of First Nations Colleges

